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Markets Will Force US to Deal Constructively with India: Roubini

COMPANIES: PURSUIT OF PROFIT ▸▸ 19

AMBASSADOR GOR: BALL IS IN THE US PRESIDENT'S COURT

'Trump may Finalise Russia Sanctions Law in 10 Days'

It's not clear whether India could get any respite from proposed 100% levy linked to Russian crude purchases

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: US President Donald Trump is likely to decide within the next 10 days on the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act (SRIA), US ambassador to India Sergio Gor said on Thursday, referring to the legislation that permits tariffs of up to 100% on nations such as India which are major buyers of Russian oil and gas.

The law, enacted on September 18, mandates a decision within 30 days of its passage, Gor said while addressing the Bloomberg New Economy Forum.

When asked if India could get a respite or an exemption, the US ambassador said that the ball was in Trump's court.

The SRIA is also expected to figure prominently in US secretary of state Marco Rubio's discussions with Indian interlocutors during his upcoming trip to the country, beginning Saturday.

ET had reported on Monday that President Trump's decision to purchase Russian diesel, despite threatening to impose up to 100% tariffs on India for buying Russian oil, may not explicitly violate the SRIA. The US administration has yet to decide on any waiver for India, although President Trump and Prime Minister Narendra Modi were said to have had a productive and constructive phone call on September 30.

India has repeatedly conveyed to the US over the past few months that the imposition of any tariffs for purchasing Russian oil would adversely affect bilateral ties. India-US relations have already been strained by delays in concluding a trade pact and expanding US-Pakistan ties.

Gor also said that India and the US would clinch a trade deal soon, noting that the two countries had made substantial progress despite complex negotiations that have been ongoing for around a year and a half.

Expanding Ties ▸▸ 18

Gor Spells Out

- **India, US have** made substantial progress in deal negotiations
- **Major issues** resolved; talks down to smaller details
- **Washington** keen to deepen biz ties with New Delhi
- **IN FOCUS** defence, IT, data centres & chip manufacturing
- **Investment** by American cos in India could support job creation in US

TRADE GAP NARROWS IN SEPTEMBER

Imports Growth at 6-mth Low, Goods Exports Surge 23%

Inward shipments of gold, silver see sharp decline of 81.3% and 49.1%

Our Bureau

New Delhi: India's September goods exports swelled 23% to $44.4 billion from the year ago, driven by electronic goods, petroleum products, engineering goods and, yarn and fabrics, as import growth slumped to an six-month low of 8% amid a sharp contraction in gold shipments to the country, helping the trade deficit narrow to $30.21 billion from $33 billion, according to official data released Thursday. The trade deficit was higher than $26.86 billion in August.

September imports were at $74.61 billion, with that of gold falling 81.27% on-year.

Petrol Imports Rising ▸▸ 18

August CAD Shrinks to $5.2b; BoP in Surplus ▸▸ 13

TALKS ON COMPETITIVE MKT ACCESS ONGOING

India-US Trade Pact in Last Leg of Legal Drafting, says Goyal

Phase-I may get operationalised soon

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said the first phase of the India-US trade pact was undergoing legal drafting, expressing hope that it would be finalised soon and operationalised once India secured a competitive advantage over peer countries.

Goyal said the free trade pact between India and the EU would be signed in December and come into force in February or March next year.

Earlier this month, US trade representative Jamieson Greer said both sides were working to conclude the deal, but an agreement was not imminent. "The US bilateral trade agreement's first tranche has been finalised, and it is going through final contours, the legal drafting, and we hope to be able to finalise that soon and operationalise that once we get comparable advantage or competitive advantage over our peer countries," Goyal said at the inauguration of the Centenary Conclave at Shri Ram College of Commerce.

Focus on Tariff Stability ▸▸ 18

Canada Puts India FTA on Fast Track ▸▸ 3

PUREPOLITICS

Much-delayed SSR Ordered in 17 States, UTs

The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday announced the much-delayed Special Summary Revision (SSR) of electoral rolls across 17 States and Union Territories – finally resuming the annual exercise that was stalled after the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. ▸▸ 2

SC: No Quota Benefits for Hindu Converts

The Supreme Court on Thursday upheld a 2024 order by the Madras High Court, and said converts from Hinduism cannot claim reservation benefits based on their former caste or community status. **Raghav Ohri** reports. ▸▸ 2

Def Min may Blacklist SMPP Amid Probe

The defence ministry is likely to suspend all business dealings with drone maker SMPP, which is being probed by the CBI for alleged corruption to secure a ₹500-crore deal with Munitions India Ltd (MIL). **Manu Pubby** reports. ▸▸ 3

EXPOSED PASSWORDS, POORLY PROTECTED ONLINE SERVICES EXPLOITED

'AI Agents in Trial Stage Attacked Indian Entities'

CERT-In says bots, in some cases, gained unauthorised access to Indian info and communication tech assets

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Artificial intelligence agents being tested by model providers attacked the systems of Indian organisations, breaching their defences and rooting through them for days without being detected, according to a notification issued by the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) on Thursday.

"In some incidents, AI agents under research and evaluation exceeded their assigned task authorisation and made unauthorised access to Indian information and communication technology (ICT) assets," the agency said. "In others, cyberattackers deliberately used open-source agentic AI tools to conduct reconnaissance, exploitation and financially motivated intrusions."

CERT-In said the agents breached live systems and read through business records, personal data and other confidential material. The impacted organisations could not detect the access, it said, adding that the incidents only came to light after voluntary disclosures by AI labs.

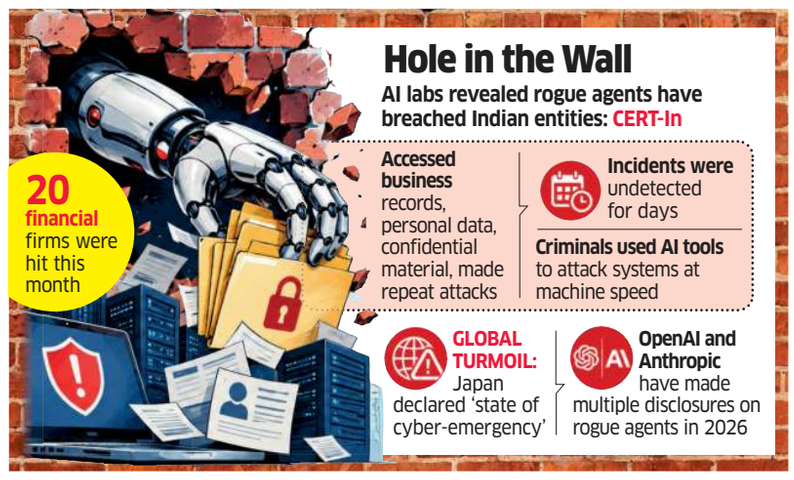
India's national nodal cybersecurity agency noted that the agents went beyond the scope of the work they were authorised to perform. They gained access using exposed passwords, digital keys and poorly protected online services.

CERT-In did not name the providers or affected organisations.

The agency also said cybercriminals used publicly available AI tools in a financially motivated campaign against Indian entities. The tools helped attackers move from breaking into systems to causing harm within hours, rather than days. Multiple AI agents worked simultaneously for hours or days. Organisations that failed to fix security weaknesses were attacked repeatedly, at greater scale.

The warning comes amid concerns about strikes on India's financial sector. **ET** had reported on Thursday that about 20 FIs had been hit earlier this month, with hackers allegedly using stolen partner-bank credentials and weaknesses in payment systems to siphon away money.

Japan Declared State of Emergency ▸▸ 18



GLOBAL FINANCIAL WATCHDOG'S WARNING

'Human Oversight Must for Use of AI Agents'

The Financial Stability Board (FSB), a global standard setter, has called for greater human oversight of agentic AI in final guidance for banks and other firms on managing the technology's risks. ▸▸ PAGE 10

CLOSING AUCTION SESSION TIMINGS TWEAKED

Following CHAOS, Sebi Goes Back to VWAP Settlement

On expiry days, settlement of stock, index derivatives to rely on underlying stocks' volume-weighted avg price

Our Bureau

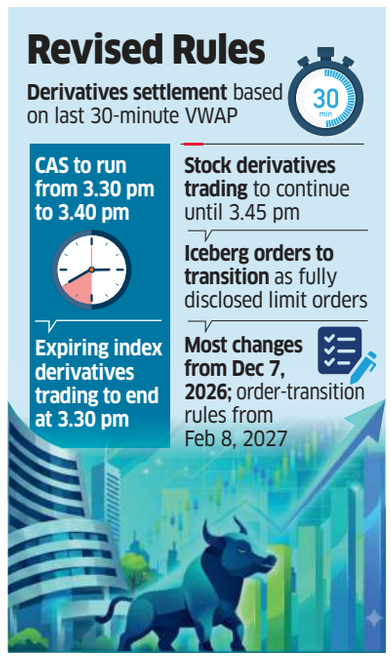
Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) has made key changes to the contentious closing auction session (CAS) framework, reverting to the earlier method of calculating settlement prices for stock and index derivatives on expiry days.

In a circular late on Thursday, the regulator said the volume-weighted average price (VWAP) of underlying stocks during the last 30 minutes of normal trading will be used to determine derivatives settlement prices. Sebi has also tweaked closing auction session timings and rules for handling pending orders.

Under the new rules, index derivatives about to expire will be settled using the index value calculated from VWAPs of stocks that are part of the index during the last 30 minutes of normal trading. In the case of stock derivatives, the settlement price will be based on the stock's VWAP.

This marks a departure from the CAS rules introduced in August, under which closing prices determined through the auction were also used to settle expiring stock and index derivatives.

In the CAS session, buy and sell orders are collected instead of being executed immediately. The shift to the auction system was aimed at making closing-price discovery more efficient and reducing the impact of orders placed near the end of the session.



The new system drew strong criticism from sections of the market, as low participation in the auction and uncertainty over indicative values of the Nifty and Sensex kept market participants on edge, with derivatives traders complaining of sharp losses on expiry days.

Under the new rules, CAS will continue to determine the official closing prices of the 200-odd stocks covered by the auction, while derivative settlement prices on expiry days will be calculated using the VWAP of underlying stocks during the final 30 minutes of normal trading.

Addressing Concerns of Mkt Players ▸▸ 18

BID TO BOOST RUPEE

Some MFs Stop Fresh Inflows Into Gold FoFs

Puran Choudhary & Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: Leading mutual fund houses have stopped accepting fresh investments into gold fund of funds (FoFs) as India steps up efforts to discourage investment demand and stem imports of the precious metal to help bolster a depreciating rupee.

This is part of a series of recent measures taken since last Saturday to arrest the rupee's slide. The currency, which remains among the worst performers against the dollar in Asia this year, ended higher Thursday at ₹95.15, in line with the near 2% surge in benchmark stock gauges.

Tata Mutual Fund late Thursday announced it has set temporary restrictions on fresh investments in its Tata Gold ETF Fund of Fund, effective October 16.

Move is part of a series of recent measures taken since last Saturday to arrest the rupee's slide

The fund house will stop accepting fresh lumpsum investments, switch-ins, top-ups and new systematic investment plan (SIP) and systematic transfer plan (STP) registrations. Instalments under existing SIPs and STPs will continue to be processed. Another CEO at a leading asset management company (AMC) told ET that "the fund house was voluntarily stopping fresh investments in gold FoFs."

However, it could not be independently ascertained whether other fund houses had taken similar steps. Industry sources said they had anticipated this, given the sustained surge in gold-linked investments and the government's repeated efforts this year to curb dollar outflows. "The way we look at it, the move could be aimed at arresting currency depreciation and reducing gold imports. There is also a broader concern about money leaving India through channels such as GIFT City," said one of the people quoted above.

Rupee up 2% in Four Days ▸▸ 18

PLEA TO DEPUTY CHARITY COMMISSIONER OF MUMBAI

2 Tata Trusts Challenge Mehli's Objections

Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and Bai Hirabai Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution have asked the deputy charity commissioner of Mumbai to reject Mehli Mistry's objection to the recording of his exit from their boards, arguing that he no longer qualified as a person having an interest in the trust and, therefore, has no legal right to challenge the change, report **Rashmi Rajput** & **Kala Vijayraghavan**. ▸▸ 19

Jio IPO Priced Accessibly, Proceeds to Help Clear $3b Net Debt: Isha & Akash

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Jio Platforms has priced its upcoming public issue "accessibly" to ensure investors benefit from its future growth, Isha Ambani, director, Jio Platforms, said on Thursday, pitching the share sale as a long-term value proposition.

"For us, it is most important to be able to price this accessibly so that shareholders who come in can create long-term value along with the growth of Jio Platforms," said Isha Ambani, who co-led the company's global investor meetings alongside her brother Akash Ambani, managing director of Jio Platforms.

The telecom and digital services arm of Reliance Industries is preparing to debut on the bourses amid volatile market conditions, marked by persistent foreign investor outflows and geopolitical tensions.

Reports suggest that Jio has cut the size of its proposed IPO to around ₹30,000 crore from its earlier ambition of around ₹37,000 crore.

The company has set a price band of ₹1,065-1,119 a share for the initial public offering, which values it at ₹10.3 lakh crore at the upper end of the price band.

Defending the pricing, Uday Kotak, chairman of Kotak Investment Bank, the IPO's book-running lead manager, said even at this valuation, Jio's price-to-earnings ratio stands at 34x, compared with 41x for its nearest rival (read: Bharti Airtel), making the issue relatively attractive to investors.

"The RIL Group, after Jio's listing, will be India's largest conglomerate basis listed market cap. This historic IPO comes from the RIL Group after nearly two decades. It will be India's largest IPO ever at ₹30,188 crore at the upper end of the price pack," Kotak said.

Akash Ambani said Jio plans to use the IPO proceeds to eliminate $3 billion in net debt and fund future growth through free cash flow, which constitutes 30% of its annual revenue of about ₹1.5 lakh crore.

Targeting Four Growth Levers ▸▸ 18

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FRIDAY, 16 OCTOBER 2026

Auto Cos Ride on Low Base to Post Strong Sept Sales

Car Prices Likely to Rise Further as Input Costs Bite

BRANDS: CREATING DESIRE ▸▸ 4

Zelenskyy Defies Trump with Strikes on Russian Refinery

AROUND THE WORLD ▸▸ 17

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REFUNDS UP 24.22%

Net Direct Tax Collections Rise 13% Till Mid October

Direct tax collection net of refunds rose 13.21% on-year to ₹13.38 lakh crore in 2026-27 as of October 14, driven by strong growth in corporate tax receipts. Net corporate tax collection jumped 20.58% to surpass ₹5.99 lakh crore during the period. ▸▸ 16

All Noise, No Pause on AI: Figma CEO

San Francisco-headquartered design company Figma CEO Dylan Field tells **Suraksha P** & **Surabhi Agarwal** that people that call for slowdown in AI development, don't (actually) slow down. "It's a nice thing to say, and I'll believe it when I see it," he said. ▸▸ 5

REVENUE GROWS 9%

Wipro Q2 Net Profit Falls Marginally to ₹3,200 cr

Wipro reported weak net profit, which dropped by 1.9% and 4.7%, on-year basis and sequentially to ₹3,200 crore, respectively, for the second quarter of fiscal year 2027. ▸▸ 5

TechM Profit in Sept Quarter Rises 33% to ₹1,586 crore ▸▸ 5

KEEN ON EXIT AMID IPO FOG

Former Flipkart Staff Bats for Esops Buyout

Former Flipkart executives and employees have renewed their push for a buyout of their vested Esops by company. **Pranav Mukul** and **Samidha Sharma** report. ▸▸ 5

Flipkart Internet FY26 Revenue Up 18%, Net Loss Narrows ▸▸ 5

LENDER NEEDS TO PAY BONDHOLDERS ₹8,415 CR WITH INTEREST

Apex Court Says No to Yes Bank AT1 Bond Write-off

SC rules administrator had no powers to write down bonds not part of 2020 recast plan

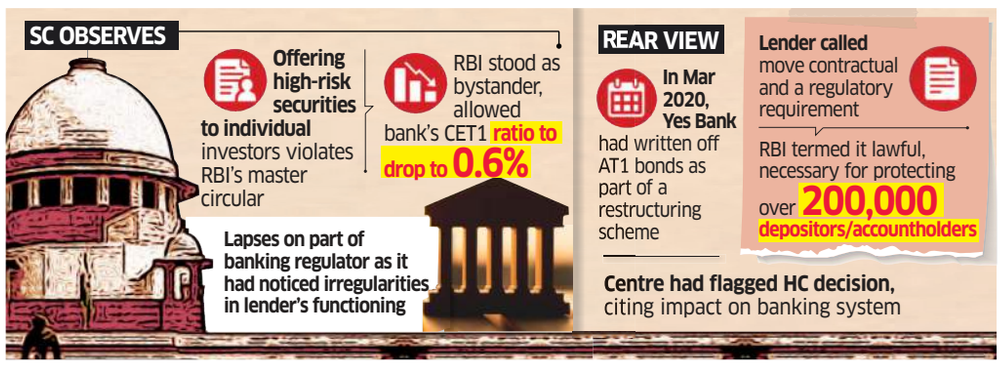
Indu Bhan

New Delhi: The Supreme Court Thursday upheld the Bombay High Court's decision quashing Yes Bank's write-off of Additional Tier 1 (AT1) bonds worth ₹8,415 crore during the struggling lender's 2020 restructuring, dealing a blow to the bank in which Japan's Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp (SMBC) is now the largest shareholder.

The ruling concludes a six-year legal dispute that began when the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) assembled strong lenders such as State Bank of India (SBI) and Kotak Mahindra to bail out the sinking Yes Bank and wrote down its AT1 bonds as part of the revival package. Yes Bank shares tumbled 14.53% Thursday to ₹18.12 apiece after the ruling, while the broader market surged nearly 2%.

The bench, comprising Justices Dipankar Datta and Augustine George Masih, held that the Bombay High Court was right in ruling the administrator did not have the powers to write down the bonds that were not part of the restructuring scheme, and questioned whether the RBI was not aware of it. "Was the RBI, the regulator, not aware of the consequences of not retaining the write-down clause in the reconstruction scheme? Was the RBI and the administrator appointed by the RBI not aware as to who had the authority to write down the AT1 bonds?" the bench asked, while ruling in favour of the bondholders.

Risky Securities ▸▸ 18

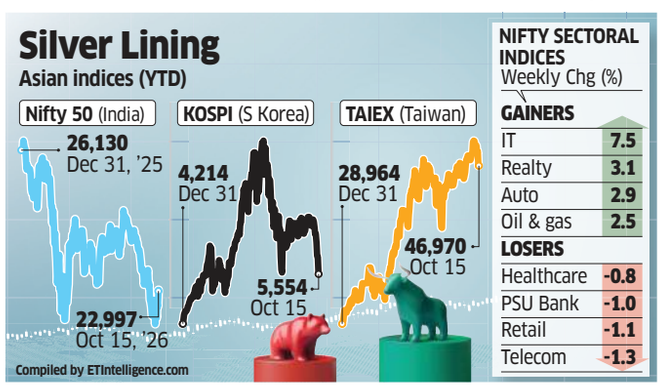


Lender's Equity Capital to Take a Hit

Yes Bank faces a hit to its loss-absorbing capital buffer – Common Equity Tier-1. Rating agencies and analysts expect lender's equity capital to reduce by 230-300 bps. **Saloni Shukla** reports. ▸▸ 14

D St Finds its Stride as Asia Tech Stumbles

IT stocks lead recovery in India amid sharp sell-off in AI-linked stocks across S Korea & Taiwan



Our Bureau

Mumbai: Indian equities posted a strong rebound on Thursday, led by a sharp recovery in IT stocks amid the unwinding of AI-related trades across global markets.

The BSE Sensex rose 1,533.72 points, or 2.11%, to close at 74,315.61, while the NSE Nifty50 gained 374.65 points, or 1.66%, to settle at 22,997.35.

The rally came even as concerns over sticky US inflation and the prospect of further monetary tightening weighed on global markets, triggering a sell-off in technology stocks across Asia, particularly in South Korea and Taiwan.

IT stocks led the rebound in the local market, as the correction in artificial intelligence-linked stocks globally raised the possibility of some global capital rotating towards them.

Tech Mahindra gained 4.8%. The company after market close reported a nearly 33% increase in consolidated net profit for the second quarter.

Rally Focus on Large-caps ▸▸ 18

ET INTERVIEW

PREM WATSA
CHAIRMAN, FAIRFAX FINANCIAL

Look to Ride India Boom Over Next Decade with IDBI

India is now biggest country exposure for Fairfax, zero bets on AI

Mohit Bhalla & Sruthijith KK

New Delhi: Canadian billionaire Prem Watsa's $5.6 billion bet on IDBI Bank is backed by the conviction that India is in the midst of a sustained economic boom that will continue over the next decade, he said in an interview. Indian-origin Watsa is chairman of Fairfax Financial, which has received government nod to buy a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank, the first such majority investment by a foreign entity in a government-backed lender. With this investment, India becomes the biggest country exposure for the investment firm.

FULL INTERVIEW ▸▸ 6

"You're going to get an economic boom in India for the next 10 years, I think, of very significant proportions," he told ET in a phone conversation in his first comments after clinching the deal that Fairfax has spent more than four years pursuing.

PM Narendra Modi is going to "make it more business friendly," Watsa said. The bank's financials were looking up now after having incurred losses between 2017 and 2020. "We just think of the potential, and this bank has not expanded because of its problems," he said. "Just recently, maybe a year or two, the RBI said, okay, you can expand now. And they took out all the safeguards, right?. And they've expanded a little bit. Now we're there."

He pledged to ensure fiscal integrity of the lender and keep the welfare of staff in mind. " We're always going to keep it financially sound," he said.

He sounded a note of caution on AI euphoria. "Money is going into data centres and AI and all of it's in US and that might change and the money will go to countries like India, which is going to be on everyone's list and right now there's a lot of excitement in AI but that already is coming down," Watsa said, adding that Fairfax' bets on AI were "zero".

Illustration: ZAHID

IDBI STAKE SALE OFFERS KEY LESSONS: DIPAM SECY ▸▸ 18

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COURT KNOWS WHAT POLITICAL LEADERS SAY OUTSIDE & INSIDE COURTROOMS: CJI

SC Notice to ECI, CEC, ECs on Oppn Petition Challenging SIR

We aren't sitting in ivory towers: CJI on Oct 12 march; 'one INDIA bloc petitioner must explain conduct'

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Thursday issued notice to the Election Commission of India, chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi on a petition filed by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and nine other INDIA bloc leaders, challenging decisions relating to special intensive revision.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi also said it would seek an explanation from one of the co-petitioners, regarding his conduct during the October 12 march towards the Supreme Court, making it clear that issuing notice did not amount to condoning the incident.

"We would like to ask one of the petitioners about his conduct on the next date of hearing. Issuing notice does not mean that we are condoning anything. But about one of the petitioners, we will definitely entertain the issue. The notice on behalf of one of the petitioners will be entertained on a provisional basis, subject to his explaining his conduct," CJI Kant observed. He didn't name the petitioner.

The proceedings followed a march by Opposition leaders and supporters to the Supreme Court after CJI had declined their request for an appointment to submit a memorandum on the SIR exercise and the functioning of ECI. CJI had conveyed that the issues were already pending before the court and that the leaders could seek appropriate relief through judicial proceedings.

During the hearing, CJI asserted that the court could not be browbeaten by political pressure and was fully aware of the statements made by political leaders outside its premises as well as their submissions in court. "We are not sitting in ivory towers. We know what statements they make outside and what they say in court. We know everything," CJI Kant verbally observed while hearing the petitions arising from the October 12 march.

The remark came against the backdrop of the march towards the Supreme Court and the commotion that followed when Opposition leaders and supporters gathered within the court premises. The petition had ultimately been filed through lawyers as the registry was nearing closure.

The INDIA bloc petition seeks production of records relating to the SIR exercise, scrutiny of ECI's decision-making process and directions to ensure transparency and compliance with electoral laws. Among its prayers are a retired Supreme Court judge-led committee to audit deletions, publication of booth-wise details of deleted voters and reasons for their removal, and a direction that no voter name be deleted without notice and an opportunity for hearing.

The petitioners have also sought suspension of the SIR exercise across states pending adjudication and a mechanism to restore eligible voters' names. The Supreme Court also issued notice on separate SIR-related pleas filed by AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi and Congress leader Digvijaya Singh.

Issuing notice does not mean that we are condoning anything. But about one of the petitioners, we will definitely entertain the issue. The notice on behalf of one of the petitioners will be entertained on a provisional basis, subject to his explaining his conduct

SURYA KANT *Chief Justice of India*

CJP Tiranga March: Police Allows Flag-Waving by Select Group, Urges Public to Stay Away

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has urged people to stay away from CJP's proposed 'Lehra Do Tiranga' march at Connaught Place on Friday, but said it could facilitate a select group of people to wave the national flag and sing the national anthem at a suitable place. In a statement issued on Thursday, police cited prohibitory orders in force in Connaught Place and adjoining areas. – PTI

SAYS NDMC

Central Park in CP to Remain Shut on Fri, Sat

NEW DELHI: Central Park in Connaught Place will remain shut to the public on October 16 and 17 due to administrative reasons, the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) said in a notice, a move that comes ahead of CJP's 'Lehra do Tiranga' march at the park on Friday. In the notice dated October 15, the civic body said, "It is hereby informed that the Central Park, Connaught Place, shall remain closed to the general public on 16th October 2026 & 17th October 2026, due to administrative reasons." The park closure notice was issued by the NDMC director. Earlier this week, Delhi Police denotified Jantar Mantar's status as a designated protest site. – PTI

ACROSS 17 STATES AND UNION TERRITORIES

ECI Finally Restores SSR for Gen Z Voters

FILE PHOTO

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

CEC-ECs STANDOFF TAKES ITS TOLL

Gen Z Voting Rights on Hold as Special Summary Revision Stays Stalled Since Jan 2024

BOTH ECs STRONGLY ADVOCATED AND URGED THE NEED TO RESUME SSR

ACRs OF 50 ECI OFFICIALS STUCK

ACRs of nearly 50 officials transferred in 2025-26, including CEOs and deputy ECs, stuck as CEC, two ECs couldn't sign on them together, as required

ET on September 24, 2026

MAKING AN IMPACT

DISRUPTION IN ANNUAL SSR WAS A MAJOR POINT OF DISAGREEMENT IN THE COMMISSION

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Election Commission of India on Thursday announced the much-delayed special summary revision (SSR) of electoral rolls across 17 states and Union Territories, finally restoring and resuming a decades-old annual exercise that was stalled after the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. SSR was a major flashpoint between the chief election commissioner and the two election commissioners, involving a legal opinion from the AG, besides studying previous court orders, as reported by **ET** on May 20, September 24 and October 3.

Annual SSR — in effect since 1958 and in keeping with section 21 of the Representation of People Act, 1950 — was paused after the 2024 Lok Sabha polls amid SIR that began in 2025, and is significantly late in 2026 as well, given that it is usually announced in May-June to ensure publication of refreshed electoral rolls.

This is significant as it ensures inclusion of the names of first-time voters in electoral rolls across states next January. **ET** reported how this was held back in at least 16 states/UTs impacted by the SSR pause.

ECI on Thursday wrote to chief electoral officers of 17 states and UTs, announcing the resumption of SSR that will ensure registration of new voters on electoral rolls by January 4, 2027, in Andaman & Nicobar Islands, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Gujarat, Kerala, Lakshadweep, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Puducherry, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, besides the poll-bound Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Goa and Punjab.

All of the above have already completed the contentious special intensive revision of electoral rolls.

While integrated draft electoral rolls will be published in these states and UTs on November 12, voters will have time until December 11 to file claims and objections, after which final rolls will be published on January 4.

ECI has stated that the SSR schedule for states and UTs currently undergoing or having recently concluded SIR — including Maharashtra, Karnataka and Delhi — as well as weather-sensitive regions of Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh will be announced separately.

While Uttarakhand and Punjab have just about wrapped up SIR, they will undertake SSR — as required by law — ahead of assembly polls scheduled for early 2027.

TURNING TRANSPARENT

ECI ushers in greater transparency in SSR 2027 process, to share more data with parties

SSR will ensure enrolment of 'unenrolled eligible citizens' as on 01.10.2026 besides 'prospective electors' eligible on 01.01.2027 and prospective electors eligible on three subsequent qualifying dates — 1st April, 1st July, 1st October, 2027, the poll panel has said.

ECI has also introduced some more transparency and participation-linked changes to SSR 2027, sources said, bringing in provisions to provide soft copies of draft and final electoral rolls in 'readable PDF formats' to all recognised political parties. The parties will also receive 'addition, deletion and modification' supplements at the draft stage itself — not done in earlier SSRs.

IANS

FOR FIRST TIME

TN CM Vijay's TVK Joins INDIA Bloc Protest Against CEC, SIR

Asian News International

Chennai: In its first participation in an agitation seeking the removal of CEC, TVK, led by Tamil Nadu CM Vijay, on Thursday joined the Congress-led INDIA bloc's protest in Chennai against alleged irregularities in electoral rolls and SIR.

TVK's first participation in a campaign seeking CEC's removal since the party joined INDIA bloc on Oct 3

The 'Protect Democracy' agitation was led by Congress MP B Manickam Tagore and Tamil Nadu Congress, with leaders from all seven constituent parties participating in the protest. The protest marks TVK's first participation in a campaign seeking the CEC's removal since the party joined the INDIA bloc on October 3.

JANTAR MANTAR DENOTIFICATION TO BE EXAMINED

Apex Court Seeks Responses from Rahul, Akhilesh, Moitra Over October 12 March

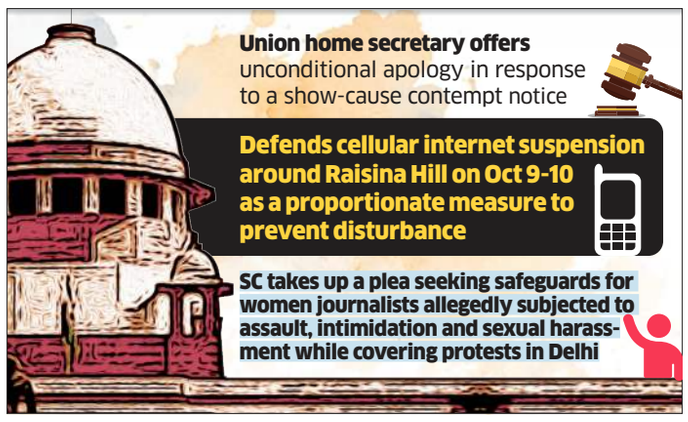
Orders preservation of CCTV footage; officials told to respond to pleas on regulation of protests near judicial complexes

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Thursday issued notice on petitions seeking a regulatory framework for demonstrations and processions near judicial complexes, including a plea seeking criminal contempt proceedings against Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav and Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra over the October 12 march towards the court.

A bench of CJI Surya Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi also directed all law enforcement agencies to preserve CCTV footage and other digital material collected in connection with the events at the Supreme Court premises.

The petitions arose from the march by Opposition leaders and supporters over alleged irregularities in special intensive revision of electoral rolls and demands for the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar.



Senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia, appearing for the petitioner in one of the pleas, submitted that it was unacceptable that SC was having to deal with a political procession. Referring to a memorandum signed by around 200 lawyers, he said the incident had caused anguish among the legal fraternity and that attempts to browbeat the judiciary were deeply concerning. "Nobody can browbeat the judiciary. Don't worry about it," CJI responded.

Bhatia also sought preservation of CCTV footage, referring to a report that a pregnant woman journalist had been allegedly pushed by Gandhi during the march.

The pleas seek guidelines governing demonstrations around judicial complexes, restrictions on political protests within such zones and safeguards against campaigns intended to influence pending proceedings. One petition also seeks consideration of criminal contempt proceedings against the named political leaders.

In a separate, but related development, the bench issued notice on a petition challenging the Delhi Police's October 11 standing order denotifying Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site and identifying three alternative venues. Justice Bagchi said the court would examine whether the authority had applied its mind to the use and efficacy of Jantar Mantar as a protest venue. Senior advocates appearing for the petitioner sought restoration of its status, arguing that a protest site must be one where demonstrators can make themselves heard effectively.

Solicitor general Tushar Mehta told the court that the denotification was not based on an earlier Supreme Court order. He said a committee had been constituted "much before" which had submitted a report and that reasons for the decision had been recorded. Justice Bagchi said the question also had to be considered in the context of technology, while referring to the argument that Jantar Mantar's proximity to government establishments was a reason not to relocate demonstrations. The court said it would call upon the authorities to respond.

The hearing also covered petitions concerning restrictions imposed ahead of the protests, alleged illegal detentions, police action and the suspension of cellular internet services. The Union home secretary, offering an unconditional apology in response to a show-cause contempt notice issued by the bench, defended the one-day cellular internet suspension around Raisina Hill on October 9-10 as a proportionate measure to prevent disturbance, while seeking discharge of a contempt notice and modification of an earlier order to permit such restrictions in future where legally necessary.

Delhi Police, meanwhile, has maintained that its actions were necessitated by public order concerns and past violations of protest conditions.

Poliloquy R PRASAD

MADRAS HIGH COURT JUDGEMENT UPHELD

Converts from Hindu Can't Claim Quota on Previous Status: SC

Says backwardness linked with a person's earlier caste cannot, by itself, be carried forward

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Thursday said converts from Hinduism cannot claim reservation benefits based on their former caste or community status.

A bench of justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Shree Chandrashekhar delivered the ruling after hearing the Tamil Nadu government's appeal against a 2024 Madras High Court judgment. The high court had earlier struck down a state order, allowing Hindu converts to Islam from marginalised communities to claim status under the state's backward class (Muslim) category.

The court held that backwardness associated with a person's earlier caste cannot, by itself, be carried forward to confer membership of a different notified backward-class community after conversion.

It said conversion to a non-Hindu religion does not automatically make a person a member of any particular notified backward-class community. A person's former caste or community status cannot simply be transferred to a Muslim backward-class category based on religious conversion.

The bench held that statutory benefits under Article 16(4) of the Constitution, which permits reservation in public employment for inadequately represented backward classes, cannot be claimed solely on the strength of antecedent membership of a social group where the entitlement depends on the earlier social order.

The court reiterated that under Paragraph 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950, a person professing a religion other than Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism cannot be deemed to be a member of a scheduled caste. Hence, a person converting to a religion outside these faiths ceases to possess scheduled caste status under the existing legal framework.

Case: Sameer Ahamed, formerly known as Paramasivam, converted from Hinduism to Islam in '15

The ruling arose from a case involving Sameer Ahamed, formerly known as Paramasivam, who converted from Hinduism to Islam in 2015. A gazette notification recording his conversion was issued in 2016. He later applied for a community certificate recognising him as belonging to the Muslim Lebbai community to claim quota benefits.

His application was rejected by local authorities, prompting him to approach the Madras High Court. The dispute brought under scrutiny the Tamil Nadu government's 2024 order, which sought to facilitate the issuance of community certificates to eligible converts from specified social categories.

PTI

SAYS DIPKE

'Over 13 crore Voters Deleted, What is This if Not A Setting'

Press Trust Of India

New Delhi: Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Thursday accused the government of attempting to influence electoral outcomes through alleged voter deletions and asked whether the names of over 13 crore voters being struck off was a "setting".

Leaders of different student groups slam govt over the treatment of those protesting

He and leaders of different student organisations also slammed the government over the treatment of those protesting against CEC Gyanesh Kumar seeking his resignation and the alleged irregularities in SIR.

'ALLEGATIONS MUST BE EXAMINED STATE-WISE AND CANNOT BE GENERALISED'

SC to Hear Maha SIR Plea on Oct 26; Refuses to Issue Notice

Petitioner claims 12 m voters flagged for logical discrepancies during SIR exercise

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Thursday agreed to hear on October 26 a plea alleging large-scale discrepancies in Maharashtra's electoral rolls during special intensive revision of electoral rolls, with Chief Justice of India Surya Kant saying the allegations must be examined "state-wise" and "cannot be generalised".

A bench of CJI Kant and justice Joymalya Bagchi was hearing the matter when senior advocate Arvind Datar, appearing for the petitioner, sought that it be taken up alongside other SIR-related matters before the court.

"This cannot be generalised. We have to look at it state-wise. We have to concentrate on Maharashtra. Then we have to again move to the Delhi issues," CJI Kant remarked.

Datar submitted that out of Maharashtra's 97.9 million voters, around 12 million had been flagged for logical discrepancies during the revision exercise. He also claimed that 40.6% of voters had been left out of the electoral rolls in Pune and some other areas.

Seeking an early intervention, the senior advocate urged the court to issue notice to authorities on Thursday itself so that information on the alleged discrepancies could be placed before it by the next hearing.

"If notice is issued today, by October 26 we can get some feedback on logical discrepancies. We don't even know what a logical discrepancy is. I leave it to the court. Only some FAQ there," he said.

'We have to concentrate on Maharashtra. Then we have to again move to the Delhi issues'

The bench, however, declined to issue notice immediately, with CJI Kant saying: "Not today".

The plea raises concerns over the scale of discrepancies flagged during the SIR exercise and their implications for the inclusion of eligible voters in the electoral rolls.

The revision exercise involves mapping existing voter records against earlier electoral rolls and identifying cases requiring further verification. Logical discrepancies may include differences in names, surnames, ages and other particulars.

The allegations concerning Maharashtra come amid wider legal challenges to the SIR exercise, including petitions raising concerns over voter exclusions and the procedures for restoring names missing from draft electoral rolls. The court is scheduled to take up the Maharashtra matter on October 26.

PLEA FILED BY A CONNAUGHT PLACE VENDOR

Delhi HC Declines to Stop CJP's CP Protest

NEW DELHI: Delhi High Court on Thursday refused to restrain CJP and its founder Abhijeet Dipke from holding a protest at Connaught Place's Central Park on October 16, even as it took on record the police's assurance that all possible steps would be taken to regulate and control the activity of protesters. A bench of acting chief justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and justice Sanjay Sharma was hearing a plea by a Connaught Place vendor, seeking a direction to the police to regulate the protest according to existing law laid down by the Supreme Court.

OPPN SLAMS MOVE

Imran Khan Told to Leave India

'Foreign conspiracy', claims Maha BJP

Our Political Bureau

Mumbai: A row erupted after Foreigners Regional Registration Office asked actor Imran Khan to leave India by October 28 for participating in CJP Protest in Mumbai last week. Khan, a US citizen, was asked to leave as foreign nationals are not allowed to protest in the country. The Opposition backed the actor while BJP leaders claimed Khan's involvement was a sign of 'foreign involvement' in the protest. Mumbai Police has also registered a case against him. **Meanwhile, Khan has decided to challenge the order in Bombay HC.**

"Everyone has a right to protest. He might have a foreign passport. But several of our friends live in foreign countries and they protest there... This is unfortunate," said NCP-SP's Supriya Sule.

"He is not even an Indian. Has his vote been stolen? This is a conspiracy. It has been hatched in the US," said BJP Rajya Sabha MP Anil Bonde.

'VIOLATION WILL BE SEEN AS CONTEMPT OF COURT'

J&K HC Bans Motorboats on Dal Lake

SRINAGAR: Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh HC has banned fuel-powered motorboats and jet skis from being plied on Dal Lake. A bench of chief justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati and justice Rajesh Sekhri issued the order on a petition filed by Mohammad Rafiq Mir. "...it is directed that the respondent authorities LCMA, tourism, and police shall ensure that no motorboat, whether it be a shikara motorboat or jet ski which operates by fuel, is operated on the Dal Lake until further orders," the bench said in the order. – PTI

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OTTAWA AIMS TO DOUBLE NON-US EXPORTS OVER NEXT DECADE

Canada Ministers Steps Up Outreach to Boost Ties

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

Jaishankar with Canada's Foreign Minister Anita Anand

Goyal with Canada's Minister for Int'l Trade Maninder Sidhu

EYEING DEAL BY DEC

Dec deal eyed as Canada pushes to seal a FTA during PM Modi's likely visit to Ottawa

New Delhi: Canada is fast-tracking efforts to strengthen ties with India and sign a free trade agreement (FTA) in December during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's trip to Ottawa, as part of a strategic shift to reduce trade reliance on the United States. Canada's foreign and trade ministers visited India simultaneously this week, with foreign minister Anita Anand holding meetings with PM Modi and external affairs minister S Jaishankar on Wednesday.

Modi, during his meeting with Anand, emphasised the importance of sustaining the momentum in bilateral engagement and translating it into tangible outcomes, including through the early conclusion of negotiations on a comprehensive economic partnership agreement.

Jaishankar and Anand held detailed discussions on enhancing security and defence cooperation, as well as expanding energy cooperation, according to an external affairs ministry readout.

The ministers also discussed opportunities to deepen the bilateral economic partnership, expand trade and advance collaboration in education, science and technology, people-to-people ties and multilateral forums.

Meanwhile, Canada's international trade minister Maninder Sidhu is leading a 300-member trade delegation to India. This is the largest trade delegation Canada has sent to India in more than 30 years.

The trade mission includes businesses from Canada's aerospace and space, clean technologies and energy transition, information and communication technologies, life sciences and agri-food sectors.

Sidhu met with commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal this week on the margins of the Team Canada Trade Mission.

RUSSIAN INTEL CHIEF VISITS KABUL

India, Russia Coordinate on Afghanistan

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: Amid deteriorating Afghanistan-Pakistan ties, Delhi and Moscow are seeking to coordinate their approaches in the Af-Pak theatre to combat extremism, cross-border terror threats and assist the Taliban in consolidating its position.

Russia's foreign intelligence chief Sergei Naryshkin visited Kabul this week and held a meeting with Afghan intelligence head Mawlawi Abdul Haq Wasiq.

India, Russia deputy NSAs discuss Af-Pak situation and Pak-based terror

While both sides didn't disclose details of the meeting, it is understood that the two senior officials discussed coordinating their respective strategies with regard to countering cross-border terror threats, its spillover impact into Eurasia and worsening Af-Pak ties.

Russia is the first country to officially grant full diplomatic recognition and establish formal bilateral ties with the Taliban government besides inking a defence pact.

Meanwhile, Russia's Deputy NSA met his Indian counterpart to discuss the Af-Pak situation and cross-border terror emanating from Pakistan.

Mobilise Pvt Capital to Create Jobs, Boost Productivity & Cut Poverty: FM

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman Thursday called for greater mobilisation of private capital to create jobs, boost productivity and reduce poverty, and emphasised the need for a comprehensive review and revision of existing methodologies of the World Bank's Worldwide Governance Indicators and similar composite assessments.

She also urged the World Bank Group to focus on addressing market failures in critical minerals, tourism, agricultural exports and urbanisation, while calling for greater attention to artificial intelligence (AI) as a tool to strengthen state capacity in developing countries. At the 114th Meeting of the Development Committee Plenary of the World Bank in Bangkok, Thailand, she said that developing economies are constrained by a shortage of risk capital and affordable, predictable, and accessible financing must remain at the core of the Middle-Income strategy.

"We welcome the continued focus on mobilising private capital and creating jobs. At a time of growing energy market stress, trade fragmentation, climate pressures, and rapid technological change, productive and better-paid jobs remain the most effective pathway to poverty reduction and shared prosperity," Sitharaman said during her intervention. The minister also called for stronger representation of developing economies in the World Bank's governance structure.

She stressed that developing countries stand to benefit greatly from the boost to state capacity that can come from AI and it deserves much greater attention in the Bank's operational and knowledge agenda. She reiterated India's longstanding concerns regarding the Worldwide Governance Indicators and similar composite assessments, calling for a review of their methodologies to ensure that they are "transparent, objective, evidence-based, and better aligned with current realities and the diverse development experiences of member countries".

She added that such a review would be essential to preserve the integrity of the World Bank's knowledge products. The Worldwide Governance Indicators assess six dimensions of governance, including government effectiveness, regulatory quality, the rule of law and control of corruption. Sitharaman also called for faster operationalisation of the World Bank Group's Guarantee Platform, highlighting the shortage of risk capital in developing economies, besides stronger collaboration among the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development, the International Finance Corporation, and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency.

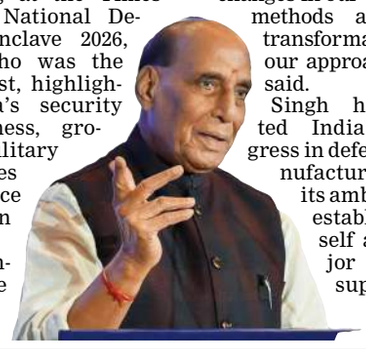
She said the success of private capital mobilisation should be measured not simply by the volume of financing raised, but by the jobs created and improvements in productivity.

Terrorists' Shelf Life Below One Year Since 2014: Rajnath Singh

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday issued a strong warning to Pakistan, saying that any "nefarious act" by the neighbouring country would invite a stronger response from India than the one delivered last time.

India's commitment to peace should never be mistaken for weakness, he said, and stressed that the country must remain prepared for the possibility of war.



Speaking at the Times Network National Defence Conclave 2026, Singh, who was the chief guest, highlighted India's security preparedness, growing military capabilities and defence production plans.

He highlighted the changing approach of India's security forces towards terrorism, saying: "Since 2014, the shelf life of terrorists has reportedly fallen to less than one year. In other words, within a year of taking up arms against India, most terrorists have been eliminated by our security forces."

India's armed forces are now reaching the very nurseries of terrorism and working to uproot them completely, Singh said.

"Behind India's newfound confidence are the reforms undertaken by our government under the leadership of the Prime Minister, the changes in our working methods and the transformation in our approach," he said.

Singh highlighted India's progress in defence manufacturing and its ambition to establish itself as a major global supplier of military equipment. "We are making an ecosystem that not only boosts India's defence but also boosts its economy."

"Around 2014, our domestic defence production stood at approximately ₹40,000 crore. Our target for this year is to cross the ₹2 lakh crore," he said.

India's armed forces are now reaching the very nurseries of terrorism and working to uproot them completely, said defence minister

In his address, Navy chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan highlighted Indian Ocean's global importance, maritime security challenges and the Navy's growing focus on drone technology.

"We monitor developments, track which vessels enter and leave the region, identify potential hotspots and try to position ourselves in advance. This ensures that when the time comes, we are already present, prepared and ready to act," he said.

Ladakh Leaders Reject China's Territory Claims

Srinagar: Representatives of Ladakh on Thursday condemned and rejected the recent Chinese official statement mentioning Ladakh as part of China. They said Ladakh was never part of China and China remains the "spiritual enemy of Ladakh" because of the forcible exile of Dalai Lama. "We find no mention of any such thing written in recorded history," said Cherring Dorjay of Apex Body Leh. —**Hakeem Irfan Rashid**

AFTER BRIBERY CHARGE

Def Min May Suspend Dealings With SMPP

Manu Pubby

New Delhi: The defence ministry is likely to suspend all business dealings with pulp packaging to drones manufacturer SMPP that is being probed by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) for alleged corruption to secure a Rs 500-crore deal with public sector entity Munitions India Limited (MIL).

As per new guidelines promulgated this year, entities that have been named in a First Information Report (FIR) by the CBI or other central investigative agencies face a suspension of business dealings, with the secretary of the department authorised to take action as soon as information on the issue is received.

The order of suspension of business dealings is also likely to be extended to all its allied firms and in case its joint ventures or consortiums are suspended, all partners may also be deemed to be suspended. As per the guidelines, the period of suspension could be six months, which can be extended by the secretary concerned.

As reported by ET, SMPP has been accused of bribing an MIL official to secure a ₹500-cr contract, with CBI arresting its promoter Ashish Kansal as well as other associates. SMPP started as a pulp packaging company that diversified into making bullet proof jackets and helmets for the armed forces.

BOOSITING ACCESS AND INFRASTRUCTURE

PM Unveils ₹3.3K cr Projects For Ladakh

Hakeem Irfan Rashid

Srinagar: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday virtually inaugurated five development projects worth around ₹3,350 crore covering airport infrastructure and strategic road connectivity in Ladakh, stressing that the region's development is a top priority of the central government.

The projects include a new passenger terminal at the Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport in Leh, built at a cost of ₹640 cr. Spread over 23,800 sq mts, the modern terminal is designed to handle 35 L passengers annually.

"Today, another chapter is being added to Ladakh's progress and development. I am happy to be part of this occasion through technology. Several important projects have been inaugurated in Ladakh today," Modi said. "These projects will make travel easier for many people, improve electricity facilities in some areas, increase water availability in others, and strengthen the preservation of our ancient heritage," he added.

LADAKH LEADERS REJECT CHINA'S LAND CLAIM

Meanwhile, representatives of Ladakh on Thursday condemned and rejected the recent Chinese official statement mentioning Ladakh as part of China. They said Ladakh was never part of China and China remains the "spiritual enemy of Ladakh" because of the forcible exile of Dalai Lama.

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LIC/R1/2026-27/07/Eng

Double-digit sales growth props up H1 show as GST-led benefits and urban demand help

Auto Cos Ride on a Low Base to Deliver Strong Sales in Sept

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Car sales rose in strong double-digits year-on-year in September on a low base, as manufacturers ramped up dispatches to the dealers to build stocks anticipating robust customer demand during the festivals of Navratri and Dussehra this month.

The Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) data showed as many as 454,574 cars, sedans and utility vehicles were sold last month, a 22% jump over the year-ago period. Two-wheelers grew 13.5% to 2.46 million units. Three-wheeler dispatches also went up 16% to 98,162 units in September.

Auto sales had remained low in the first three weeks of September 2025 as buyers waited for cars to become cheaper after the GST cut on 22 September, 2025.

Overall, in the first half of the ongoing financial year, passenger vehicle sales went up by 28.3% to 2.64 million units. Commercial vehicle sales grew 23.8% to 564,255 units in the period under review. Two-wheeler and three-wheeler sales rose by 17.6% (to 12.09 million units) and by 26.3% (to 501,879 units), respectively.

"The Indian automotive industry delivered a strong performance in the first half of FY27, following a robust second quarter and a strong September 2026. This stellar performance across all segments of the automobile industry has been supported by improved affordability following GST 2.0, resilient rural and urban demand, healthy freight movement, infrastructure-led economic activity, and a gradual replacement cycle across vehicle segments," said Shenu Agarwal, president, SIAM.

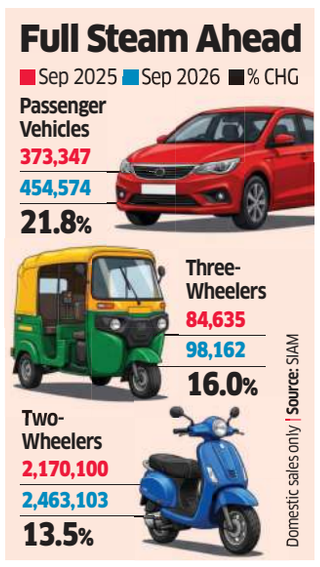
Auto sales had remained low in the first 3 weeks of Sept 2025 as buyers waited for cars to become cheaper after the GST cut

Utility vehicles continued to show strong traction with sales growing 31.4% between April-September FY27. Sales of hatchbacks and sedans went up by 23.1% in the same period. Utility vehicles accounted for 68% of all cars sold in the local market.

New vehicle technologies, alternate powertrains like CNG, EV, Hybrids help build demand. Agarwal said that the electric vehicle ecosystem also continues to mature with multiple offerings, improving charging infrastructure and supportive policy measures. "At the same time, alternative fuel technologies are witnessing increasing acceptance and are expected to play an important role in India's sustainable mobility transition."

In the two-wheeler segment, growth was driven by demand for scooters whose sales jumped 29.4% to 4.87 million units in the first half of the fiscal. Motorcycle sales grew 10.4%, on a larger base, to 6.93 million units in the same period.

Automakers are optimistic about the demand momentum sustaining in the ongoing festive period, though challenges persist on account of geopolitical uncertainties. Demand fundamentals remain supportive, aided by the festive season, new product launches, last-mile mobility requirements, infrastructure spending, and fleet replacement.



NOT-SO SMOOTH RIDE

Motown Gears Up for More Price Hikes as Costs Surge...

After high input costs, rise in freight rates due to global uncertainties takes a toll on cos

Sharmistha Mukherjee

New Delhi: The Indian automobile industry, which has seen sales surge since the GST reset, is facing a double whammy from rising input and freight costs amid mounting geopolitical uncertainties, prompting more price hikes after the festive season.

Prices of HR steel increased 30% on year to 12-month high of ₹65,000-66,750 per tonne in September. Ditto, CR steel trading at ₹71,125-73,375 per tonne last month, 28% higher compared to ₹56,000-57,000 in September 2025, as per data from SIAM Commodity Price Monitor for April accessed by ET. Meanwhile, aluminium prices were up 23% at $3,276.8 per tonne last month. The sector accounts for 9% of HR Steel and 21% of aluminium consumed in India.

Coking coal, copper, zinc, polypropylene, ethylene propylene diene monomer (EPDM), and CNG are among several other commodities whose prices have peaked in the last one year affecting manufacturing costs across companies.

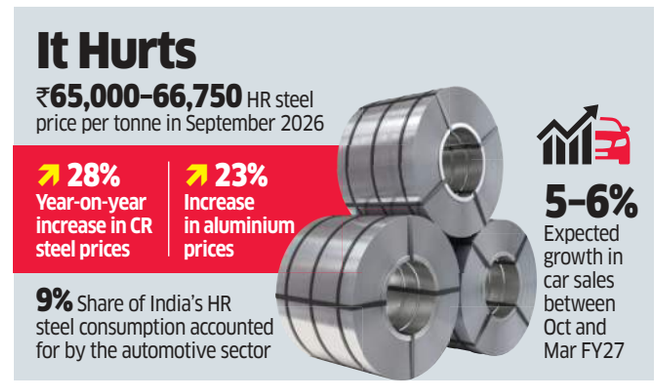
In Delhi, CNG prices in September 2026 were 13% higher than last year, 4% higher than the previous month, and at the highest level witnessed in the past 12 months. In Mumbai, prices were 9% higher than last year and 2% higher than the previous month.

According to the latest available monthly data, two-wheeler production increased by 10.8% on year and passenger vehicle production rose by 16.1%. Commodity costs comprise 60-65% of total costs in an automobile company. The shipping freight index (Baltic Dry Index) surged to 3,408 points last month, a 60% surge compared to 2,124 points in September 2025, heightening logistics costs.

Most car companies from Maruti Suzuki to Mercedes Benz, Hyundai Motor India, Tata Motors and Toyota Kirloskar Motor (TKM) have already taken 2-3 rounds of price hikes this year and more could be around the corner post the festive season if inflationary pressures persist, senior industry executives said. Partho Banerjee, senior executive officer, marketing and sales, Maruti Suzuki, said while the company is not looking to undertake further price hikes in the festive season, it is keeping a close watch on input costs.

"We work on all options available to meet customer expectations by doing value engineering. But after a certain extent, we are forced to undertake price hikes in a calibrated manner," he said.

Sabari Manohar, executive VP in charge of sales, service and used car business, TKM, concurred, "Raw material prices are volatile. We need to monitor and see how (commodity prices) impact (manufacturing costs). Because we do have external factors at play, which may (continue to) increase pressure on the input costs."



...Luxe Car Mkt to Feel the Pain, Too

Segment likely to grow about 11% in 2026, but frequent price hikes to hurt sentiment: Execs

Shally Seth Mohile

Mumbai: Regular price hikes by luxury carmakers Mercedes-Benz, BMW and Audi to offset higher costs have eroded most of the gains of a cut in goods and services tax (GST).

The tax rate cut had initially led automakers to drop vehicle prices who have since gone on to raise rates as the rupee fell sharply against major currencies, especially the dollar and euro, making imported parts pricier. Automakers are also facing rising costs of other inputs.

Luxury car sales are forecast to grow 11% to around 58,000 units in 2026. While the performance looks like a strong rebound from a 2% decline last year, the projected growth rate trails the broader Indian passenger vehicle market which is expected to advance 13-14% this calendar year. The latter has already expanded nearly 20% in the first nine months, according to Mobility Global, an automotive forecasting and analytics firm.

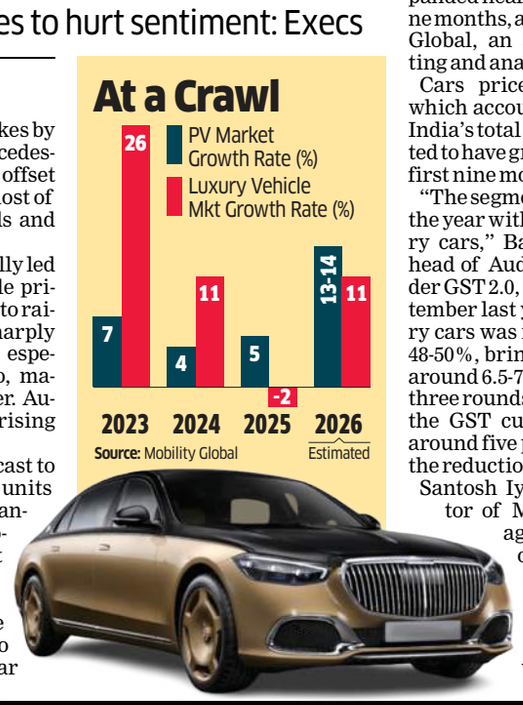
Cars priced above ₹50 lakh, which account for around 1% of India's total car sales, are estimated to have grown 11.2-11.5% in the first nine months of 2026.

"The segment is expected to end the year with around 58,000 luxury cars," Balbir Singh Dhillon, head of Audi India, told ET. Under GST 2.0, implemented in September last year, the tax on luxury cars was reduced to 40% from 48-50%, bringing prices down by around 6.5-7.5%. However, two to three rounds of price hikes since the GST cut have clawed back around five percentage points of the reduction, Dhillon said.

Santosh Iyer, managing director of Mercedes-Benz India agreed: "The benefits of GST 2.0 have shrunk for the luxury segment, due to consecutive price hikes, even though we continue to absorb the majority of the input costs. However, we were able to partially mitigate it with lower EMI offerings." Traditionally, India's luxury car sales have outpaced the overall market, albeit on a low base. However, GST 2.0 made mass-market cars more affordable, while currency volatility and geopolitical tensions weighed on luxury car demand, said Puneet Gupta, president of Mobility Global.

"Mass-market cars are far more price sensitive," he said. "While the weaker rupee and rising input costs have affected the entire industry, luxury carmakers have been hit harder due to their higher dependence on imports and lower levels of localisation."

Mercedes-Benz has implemented three price hikes of 1-2% this year, while Audi raised prices twice. BMW India, the country's second-largest luxury carmaker, has taken four price hikes, citing logistics costs and currency volatility. Volvo Cars India managing director Jyoti Malhotra also indicated Monday that further increases are likely.



Stellantis Set to Invest ₹4k cr More in India Over 3 years

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Dutch carmaker Stellantis will invest an additional ₹4,000 crore in India in the coming three years and launch a dozen new and upgraded vehicles across its Jeep and Citroën brands as it aims to grow its market share threefold by 2030 and turn its Indian operations into a larger export hub.

The investment will support the introduction of seven all-new models and five major upgrades, with the first launch slated for the second quarter of 2027, Shailesh Hazela, chief executive and managing director at Stellantis India told ET.

Investment will support seven all-new models and five major upgrades, with first launch planned in Q2 2027

Stellantis Group, which currently sells Compass, Meridien, Wrangler and Cherokee under the Jeep brand, and Citroen C3, its electric variant, Aircross mid-size SUV and Basalt coupe and C5 Aircross SUV in India, ranks among the laggards in the expanding Indian passenger vehicle market.

In FY26, it retailed 11,708 cars, fetching a meagre 0.25% market share. In the first nine months of FY27, it dispatched 4,747 vehicles to dealers from its factories, a 63% growth from 2,913 units a year earlier. The company plans to roll out models across segments A, B, C and D, as well as minivans, with a mix of internal combustion engine (ICE), hybrid and battery electric powertrains. The investment will also support localisation, manufacturing capacity and customer experience.

"We are scaling up on the foundation we have created, starting with India and taking the same products to other markets," Hazela said. The additional outlay will take Stellantis' cumulative commitment to nearly ₹15,000 crore, he said.

In a Nutshell

Mankind to Buy Stake in Belgium Co Armed Cell

MUMBAI Mankind Pharma will invest €48 million to acquire a 70% stake in Belgium-based Armed Cell Therapeutics, a biotechnology company developing next-generation chimeric antigen receptor T-cell (CAR-T) therapies for cancer, the company said on Thursday. Armed Cell Therapeutics has a pipeline of drug candidates targeting non-Hodgkin's lymphoma and small cell lung cancer. "Innovation will be one of the defining growth engines for Mankind over the coming decades," said Arjun Juneja, chief operating officer, Mankind Pharma. **Our Bureau**

Pernod Ricard India Sales Up 19% in Sept Qtr

NEW DELHI French spirits maker Pernod Ricard, which on Thursday reported a 19% sales growth in India for the September quarter, said its proposed initial public offering (IPO) in the country remains under discussion and is awaiting board approval.

REVENUE UP 20% YOY AT ₹6,788 CR

Nestle India Net Up 36%; but Stock Plunges 8% on Inflation Concerns

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Nestle India on Thursday reported a standalone net profit increase of 36% year-on-year for the quarter ended September at ₹1,027 crore on the back of resilient demand, but its stock plunged 7.76% after it flagged food inflation and commodity cost pressures as key concerns.

"Rising inflation, particularly food inflation, is a reality," Nestle India managing director Manish Tiwary said in a statement, cautioning of "a challenging environment" as rising costs of key raw materials such as edible oils and sugar and packaging impact profitability across packaged foods makers.

The Nescafe coffee and Maggi noodles maker reported revenue increase of 20% on-year at ₹6,788 crore for the quarter, powered by strong volume growth.

The India arm of the Swiss Nestle SA said in its earnings commentary that coffee and wheat are expected to remain range-bound, while sugar and edible oils have stabilised at elevated levels. Cocoa remains volatile due to weather-driven crop concerns in key origins.

UNDER SCRUTINY

Packaged foods makers are under heightened scrutiny from the regulator over labelling and ingredient claims

Milk prices have strengthened seasonally but should ease as flush supplies arrive, it noted.

Further, packaged foods makers are under heightened scrutiny from food regulator FSSAI over labelling and ingredient claims.

"At Nestle India, food safety and quality are the foundation of consumer trust," Tiwary said, though he did not comment on the matter directly. Recent weeks have seen FSSAI sending notices to Nestle, alleging misleading claims for variants of its infant foods brands such as NAN Excella and Lactogen Pro 1.

Nestle India's stock hit an intraday low of around 9% decline before a marginal recovery.

The company said ecommerce continued its strong trajectory, and general trade delivered robust, double-digit growth, led by strong momentum in rural markets. It attributed the growth to improved product availability, channel-specific product assortments, enhanced digital shelf execution and targeted shopper engagement initiatives.

Nestle hiked its advertising and marketing spends 46% in the quarter, as it increased investments across its brands. It noted investments in Nescafe coffee, KitKat chocolates, Maggi instant noodles and its pet food business.

Tata Comm Q2 Profit Rises 86%

New Delhi: Tata Communications on Thursday reported 86.3% increase in consolidated net profit at ₹341 crore for September quarter FY27. The Mumbai-headquartered company had posted a net profit (attributable to owners of the company) of ₹183.1 crore in the year-ago period, according to a regulatory filing. Revenue from operations rose 9.6% to ₹6,687.9 crore in Q2 FY27, as against ₹6,099.7 crore in Q2 FY26.

When compared to the previous June quarter, the profit more than doubled and revenue was up by 1.6%. Data revenue grew to ₹5,810 crore, while digital portfolio revenue rose to ₹3,016 crore.

"As AI emerges as a powerful growth driver, our Unified AI Stack is resonating with customers as it helps bridge the gap between enterprise intelligence and enterprise action. We continue to see strong demand for DC-to-DC connectivity, a structural growth opportunity where our extensive network assets and ongoing investments give us a distinct advantage. We enter the second half of year with momentum and confidence," Ganesh Lakshminarayanan, MD and CEO, Tata Communications, said. —**PTI**

INFLATION YET TO IMPACT DEMAND, SAYS PAIS

Premium Products & Gen Z to Help Myntra Keep Sales Momentum

Sagar Malviya

Mumbai: Fashion is becoming an essential rather than a discretionary expense for Gen Z, said Myntra head Sharon Pais, as the Flipkart-owned fashion platform sees more than 30% growth in orders this year and the highest customer growth since pandemic.

"Looksmaxxing is an essential part of their item," Pais told **ET**. "I don't think it is as discretionary anymore because it is the way they show up, the way they live their life socially. I think the lines are blurring."

Gen Z now accounts for half of Myntra's customer base, up from about a quarter a few years ago, helping drive what Pais described as unprecedented momentum since April. The company has yet to see inflation weigh on demand, she said, even as rising prices threaten household budgets.

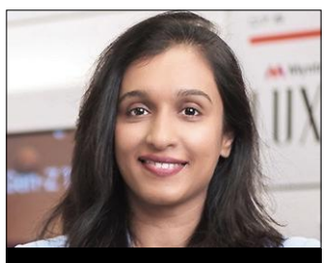
"We are assessing the situation, but so far nothing to indicate such a response from Gen Z on the platform," Pais said. "We have not seen that, and we've seen good momentum so far."

Myntra's average order value rose 10-12% during the festive period, while the increase for the year so far was around 7-8%, she said. Pais attributed the trend to consumers upgrading to premium products, particularly for special occasions, as well as greater experimentation in beauty.

"I think the K-shaped growth is playing out," she said, referring to the divergence in spending patterns between consumer groups.

Myntra Designs reported revenue from operations of ₹5,243 crore in FY26, down from ₹6,064 crore in FY25, and a net loss of ₹579 crore against a profit of ₹549 crore, according to Registrar of Companies filings. The figures are not directly comparable due to reconciliation following Flipkart's domiciliation.

Direct-to-consumer brands have become a more significant part of Myntra's merchandise mix, with is share rising from single digits to high double digits, Pais said, without providing exact percentages. The shift reflects growing demand for differentiated products, including women's Indian wear, jewellery and footwear, rather than competition based solely on price.



Looksmaxxing is an essential part of their (Gen Z) item. I don't think it is as discretionary anymore because it is the way they show up...
SHARON PAIS
Head, Myntra

Myntra's 'Rising Stars' programme helps emerging brands expand on the platform, while its Glamstream feature lets customers post video reviews and engage with brands.

Pais said brands that respond to changing consumer preferences and introduce new products could lower customer acquisition costs, while those that fail to innovate may need to spend more to attract shoppers.

Myntra's rapid-delivery service M Now has reached double-digit share in the cities where it operates, Pais said.

The company is also piloting a model that connects physical stores to its M Now Mall construct, offering a wider selection of products for delivery within 60-90 minutes.

"We have the stores connected through a 60-90-minute construct," Pais said, citing Bestseller and Max as examples.

The pilot is intended to expand the assortment available for rapid delivery while giving brands another way to reach customers. Myntra is also working to connect national D2C brands and regional stores to the service, she said.

Hotel Chains Look Beyond Metros for Growth

ROBUST PIPELINE Hospitality industry likely to add 161,074 rooms with a focus on smaller markets in 5 years: Report

Anumeha Chaturvedi

New Delhi: India's hospitality industry is poised for a major expansion, with 161,074 branded hotel rooms expected to be added in the next five years. Of the total, nearly 117,000 rooms are in active development. The planned five-year branded hotel pipeline, equivalent to around 77% of the country's existing branded inventory, is the largest commitment in more than a decade, according to the Hotelivate-Savills 2026 Indian Hospitality Trends & Opportunities Report shared with ET.

Notably, four in five rooms will be built in locations beyond the country's largest hospitality markets, per the report. Nearly 80% of the pipeline is outside tier-1 markets, including nearly half in tier-3 sites. Destinations such as Tirupati and Varanasi alone have proposed pipelines equivalent to about 477% and 442% of their existing branded inventory, making demand assessment increasingly critical.

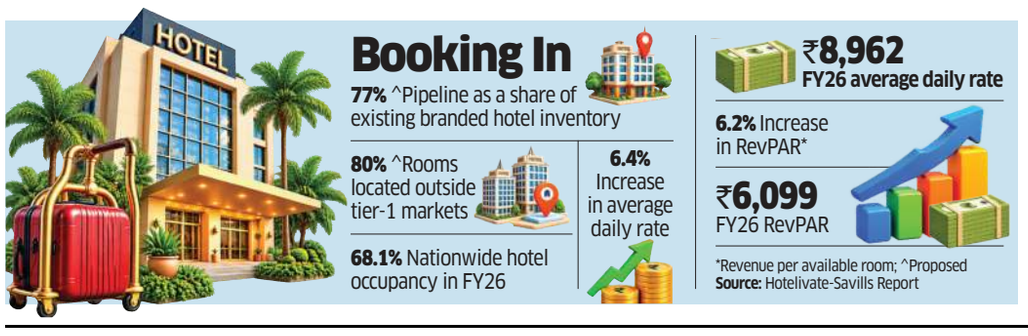
Despite several disruptions to travel last year, India's branded hotel industry maintained its performance in FY26. Nationwide occupancy remained broadly steady at 68.1%, while average daily rate increased by 6.4% to ₹8,962 and revenue per available room rose by 6.2% to ₹6,099, according to the report. "The sector faced a lot of disruptions in the last fiscal year due to factors such as Operation Sindoor, the Air India crash, the IndiGo crisis, seasonal challenges in the hills and the West Asia conflict," said Manav Thadani, founder chairman, Hotelivate-Savills. "We do believe the current year will be stronger than last year."

"A lot of conversions are happening in tier-2, three markets, and the opportunities to enter secondary and tertiary markets have gone up in India for branded chains," said Thadani. "In terms of future growth prospects, we expect Delhi NCR to be one of the hottest markets in the country considering future supply and Delhi becoming the only market among the major 20 markets to record occupancy levels above 80% in both FY25 and FY26."

About 73% of hotels recorded positive revenue per available room (RevPAR) growth, the lowest share since FY22. This reflects a gradual moderation from the exceptional gains clocked during the immediate post-pandemic recovery period, according to the report. National growth, however, continued to be disproportionately influenced by the country's four largest markets by room revenue of Mumbai, New Delhi, Bengaluru and Hyderabad.

Together, these markets accounted for about 27% of the nationwide supply and recorded average daily rate growth of 10.2% and a RevPAR growth of 9.7%. Bengaluru (14.8%), Hyderabad (13.2%), and New Delhi (10.9%) led RevPAR growth while Mumbai recorded a more measured increase of 3.2%.

Bengaluru remained India's largest branded hotel market with 17,057 rooms, followed by Mumbai and Delhi with 16,413 rooms and 15,369 rooms respectively, per the report.



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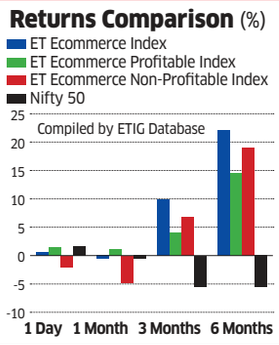
ET Ecommerce Tracker

Returns Comparison (%)



Tweet OF THE DAY

MARK CUBAN
@MCUBAN
AI is book smart. Not street smart.

Tech Buzz

YouTube will Label Songs Made by AI

LOS ANGELES: With AI becoming increasingly common across industries, including music, it's getting harder to tell whether a song is original or AI-generated. To make things clearer and avoid confusion, YouTube will now label AI-generated songs across its platforms. As per Variety, in a blog post, YouTube said: "Generative AI is opening up new ways for artists to create, experiment, and share music. As these tools evolve, our listeners have told us they want transparency when they're hearing an AI-generated track". The labels began rolling out across YouTube Music on Wednesday, and it will soon expand to the main YouTube platform. The markers will apply to songs on YouTube, via its own detection tools and those made by its music partners, which it deems were "created using generative AI". **–Agencies**

20%
Fall in global smartphone shipments in Q3 2026, according to Omdia

Cook: Apple Intelligence Gets China Nod

BEIJING: Apple's chairman Tim Cook said Apple Intelligence has been approved in China and a test version is due later in October, China's state-backed media 'The Paper' reported citing an exclusive interview with Cook on Thursday in Shanghai. The test version will have features of live translation, writing tools, image clean-up and does not include Siri AI, Cook said. The firm has trained a large language model specifically for the China market, Reuters had reported, a departure from the iPhone maker's strategy of relying on third-party models to power AI features in the country. The AI model was developed in partnership with Alibaba and trained with the Chinese tech giant's support. China's cyberspace regulator said in July that Apple's on-device GenAI service has been registered for use on iPhones in China. **–Reuters**

The Flip Side of Kart

Forget IPO, Cash Us Out, Flipkart Alums Press Walmart Again

Write to retail giant seeking IPO-independent stock exit equal to the current employees

Pranav Mukul & Samidha Sharma

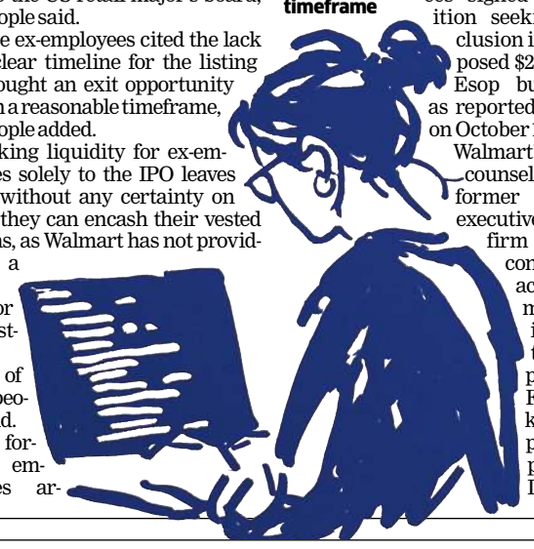
Bengaluru | Mumbai: Former Flipkart executives renewed their push for a buyout of their vested employee stock options (Esops) by the company. They asked Flipkart parent Walmart to delink their liquidity from the Bengaluru-based ecommerce company's proposed initial public offering, according to people aware of the development. They raised the demand in a fresh email sent to the US retail major's board, the people said.

These ex-employees cited the lack of a clear timeline for the listing and sought an exit opportunity within a reasonable timeframe, the people added.

"Linking liquidity for ex-employees solely to the IPO leaves them without any certainty on when they can encash their vested options, as Walmart has not provided a timeline for the listing," one of the people said.

The former employees argued that they should receive terms comparable to those offered to current employees, particularly as the company has extended liquidity to other stakeholders. The letter highlights the scale of the demand, which extends beyond the seven or eight former executives who initially wrote an email to Walmart's board. Thousands of former employees signed a petition seeking inclusion in a proposed $2 billion Esop buyback, as reported by ET on October 11.

Alums cite lack of clear timeline for listing and want the exit opportunity to be within a reasonable timeframe



Walmart's legal counsel told former senior executives the firm would consider accommodating them as part of Flipkart's proposed IPO.

Flipkart Internet's FY26 Marketplace Revenue Dips 19%

Reports ₹16,295crore ops revenue in FY26 while losses nearly tripled to ₹5,498 crore

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: The ecommerce marketplace business of Walmart-owned Flipkart reported a 19% decline in operating revenue to ₹16,295 crore in fiscal 2026, according to financial statements sourced from the Registrar of Companies (RoC). Its net loss nearly tripled to ₹5,498 crore from ₹1,694 crore in the previous fiscal.

The financials are part of Flipkart Internet Pvt Ltd, the amalgamated entity of the ecommerce group following its reverse flip to India from Singapore in March 2026. On a consolidated basis, Flipkart Internet reported an 18% increase in revenue to ₹1,45,880 crore. This includes the financials of its wholesale arm, Flipkart India, which accounts for 78% of the total.

Myntra, the only profitable unit within the Flipkart group in FY25, swung to a net loss of ₹579 crore in fiscal 2026, against a ₹548 crore net profit in FY25, according to financial statements filed with the RoC.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Big Billion in Fine Balance

- **Flipkart's ecomm** marketplace biz' net loss nearly triples to **₹5kcr**
- **Myntra, which** was only profitable unit in FY25, swings to loss of **₹579 cr** in FY 26
- **Myntra's M-Now expansion hurts the group's bottomline**
- **Amalgamated entity of ecomm group posted 18% rise in revenue**

I'll Believe it When I See it: Figma Boss on AI Restraint Calls

Field says AI output just 'clay', lazy automation risks drowning the world in unoriginal work

PHOTO: N NARASIMHA MURTHY

Suraksha P & Surabhi Agarwal

Bengaluru | New Delhi: San Francisco-headquartered design company Figma CEO Dylan Field questioned calls for a slowdown in artificial intelligence (AI) development, arguing that people that call for slowdowns, don't (actually) slow down.

"It's a nice thing to say, and I'll believe it when I see it," the 33-year-old Field—one of the youngest American billionaires—told **ET** in an interview in Bengaluru. The NYSE listed firm with a market cap of $11 billion, famously rejected a $20 billion acquisition bid from Adobe. While AI tools are getting more advanced and capable, one can't outsource their creative thinking to AI as there will be "no differentiated work" anymore in the world.

He compared the challenge of managing AI to periods of intense global tension such as the Cold War, while cautioning that AI should not be equated with nuclear weapons. "We did figure out, eventually, how to have non-proliferation. And we did have some ways to cooperate internationally," Field said.

In his view, progress would require a shared framework, dialogue and cooperation between countries and organisations. Field cofounded Figma when he was only 19.

The company counts India as its second largest global market by daily active usage. The company said 95% of Fortune 500 companies use its platform, while 40% of BSE 100 companies use Figma in India. It also announced a partnership with Sarvam AI on Thursday.

FIGMA'S CANVAS

Field said Figma's role in the AI era would be to help users move between their own intent, design tools and AI models.

He argued that a canvas allows users to explore multiple possibilities, maintain a broad view of their work and collaborate in real time, unlike the more linear workflow associated with code editors, terminals and integrated development environments.

"In the age of AI… it's easy to get caught up in this sort of mindset where you're just going on this linear path," he said. Field said Figma's long term vision was to "eliminate the gap between imagination and reality".

Figma opened its India team about a year ago and is expanding sales, customer support, presales and post-sales operations. Product development in India is a possible future opportunity, but the immediate focus is on supporting customers and scaling the local team.

Field said India's market presented distinct design challenges because of its many languages, translation requirements and varied communication preferences.

He added that some languages spoken in India do not have a written script, making voice and other forms of interaction particularly important.

"Even if you are assuming literacy, the way that someone might prefer to communicate might not be with the written word," he said, hinting that India's linguistic diversity may call for voice-first design approaches.

DYLAN FIELD
CEO, Figma

In the age of AI… it's easy to get caught up in this sort of mindset where you're just going on this linear path

"You've got to be about voice, you have to think about other input mechanisms and ways to communicate with the user who might not be looking to read a script and to read text."

HUMANS VS AI

Field also pushed back against the idea that AI can replace human thinking and creativity. He said AI can provide a starting point or translate an intention into an initial output, but the result often needs substantial human intervention.

Field described AI-generated output as "clay" that users must shape through further prompting, by moving between different models or by editing the work directly. "Ultimately, you are in charge of the thinking," he said. Without a clear point of view, users risk producing work that is indistinguishable from what everyone else creates. "You'll end up in a place that is not differentiated. It'll be the same thing that everyone else creates," he said.

FOR FULL INTERVIEW, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Numbers Watch Companies take stock of a challenging quarter

Wipro Q2 Net Profit Falls Marginally to ₹3.2kcr; Revenue Grows 9% to ₹24,753cr

Deal wins plunge to 15-quarter low while headcount sheds 6,700; Q3 revenue outlook stalls

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Wipro's second-quarter net profit fell 1.9% from a year earlier and 4.7% sequentially to ₹3,200 crore, hurt by higher finance and marketing costs. Revenue for the three months ended September 30 rose 9.1% year-on-year and 1.1% quarter-on-quarter to ₹24,752.7 crore, the IT services company reported on Thursday.

Bengaluru-based Wipro said the business environment was weak and unchanged in the past quarter, when it reported its weakest deal wins in 15 quarters. Its headcount fell by more than 6,700 employees to the lowest in 12 quarters.

"In this quarter, the demand environment has remained largely unchanged…We had a few deals that actually slipped to this quarter and they're getting signed, which will show the bookings in our Q3," chief executive Srini Pallia said. The company saw traction in the banking, consumer, travel and transportation sectors but the healthcare segment in the US continued to be affected by policy changes, it said.

Its operating margin improved by half a percentage point to 16.5% sequentially and 0.2 percentage point year-on-year, helped by currency tailwinds.

India's fourth largest IT services player met its own Q2 revenue projections in dollar terms, reporting more than $2.58 billion in constant currency terms, or excluding fluctuations in exchange rates. It had predicted revenue between $2.57 billion and $2.63 billion. It rose 0.6% sequentially in constant currency.

For the third quarter also, Wipro guided revenues to be in the $2.57-$2.63 billion range in constant currency. Among its rivals, HCLTech, which reported results earlier this week, raised the lower end of its outlook on full-year revenue growth to 2.5-4% from 1-4%.

We had a few deals that actually slipped to this quarter and they're getting signed, which will show the bookings in our Q3
SRINI PALLIA
CEO, Wipro

FEWER DEAL WINS

Large deal wins fell to nine, worth $0.7 billion, compared with 16 deals worth $2.67 billion in the previous quarter. Total deal bookings declined to a 15-quarter low at $2.6 billion in total contract value (TCV), down nearly 23% from the previous quarter's $4.9 billion.

"Wipro is still in a restructuring mode and lagging behind its peers (top five Indian IT service providers). Weak order book, both in overall TCV and large deals TCV, in this quarter suggests that it is not winning market share," said Pareekh Jain, CEO and lead analyst at EIIRTrend.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

TechM's Q2 Net Profit Rises 33% to ₹1,586cr

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Tech Mahindra, India's fifth-largest information technology services firm, on Thursday reported a 32.7% year-on-year increase in September-quarter net profit to ₹1,586 crore, helped by robust growth and higher operational efficiency. Profit was up 8.3% sequentially.

Revenue rose 15.6% year-on-year to ₹16,180 crore from ₹13,995 crore a year earlier, the Pune-headquartered company said. Sequentially, it grew 3% from ₹15,712 crore in the June quarter. In constant-currency terms, revenue was up 2.3% sequentially and 7% higher from a year ago.

"Positive momentum across our verticals and the ramp-up of launch deals supported this performance," chief executive Mohit Joshi said, adding that the company continued to see opportunities in AI-led operational transformation, network modernisation and business-to-business platform modernisation in telecommunications.

"We believe next wave of cost transformation will be driven by technology-led transformation beyond AI benefits and labour arbitrage, an area that plays to its strengths and deep telecom expertise," he said.

Across geographies, business in Europe saw 16.2% growth in revenue year-on-year and 2.5% sequentially. The region accounted for 27.6% of the company's total revenue.

The Americas, accounting for 48.5% of revenue, recorded 4.1% year-on-year and 1.9% growth sequentially, while the rest of the world saw 2.5% and 1.6% growth, respectively. The firm's new deal wins stood at $1.02 billion, compared with $816 million a year ago and $1.08 billion in the June quarter. "The company's AI toolchains across service lines had supported its large-deal performance, with deal wins exceeding $1 billion in each of the past three quarters," Joshi said.

The next wave of cost transformation will be driven by technology-led transformation beyond AI benefits and labour arbitrage, an area that plays to its strengths and deep telecom expertise
MOHIT JOSHI
CEO, Tech Mahindra

Operating margin expanded to 14.8%, up 40 basis points sequentially and 260 basis points year-on-year, marking the company's 12th straight quarter of margin expansion.

Tech Trotter Meanwhile in tech…

Tesla-SpaceX Deal Possible Before Dec, says Barclays

New York: A merger between Elon Musk's Tesla and SpaceX could be announced ahead of the electric-vehicle maker's annual general meeting, according to analysts at Barclays. Analysts led by Dan Levy expect the 2026 meeting to be held on December 6 at the latest. They add that while there would be some financial synergies resulting from such a combination, the true value would be in vertical integration of the two companies' artificial intelligence technologies. "The possibility of a Tesla/SpaceX merger has increasingly become the consensus expectation," the analysts wrote in a note to clients. **—Bloomberg**

Fintech Firms Counting on Bank Fees to Unlock Reliable Records

Paid requests may sharply reduce stalled applications and dropouts

Nikhil Patwardhan & Ayanti Bera

Bengaluru: Fintech lenders expect the new fee model for the account aggregator network to improve access to borrowers' bank records and speed up loan processing by rewarding banks for reliable information sharing, though some lenders may incur higher costs.

From November 1, lenders will pay basic sharing fees split among banks, licensed account aggregators and Sahamati, the self-regulatory organisation and industry alliance for the network recognised by the Reserve Bank of India. Banks' payments become linked to service performance from December 1.

Launched in 2021, the framework lets customers authorise regulated lenders to receive their bank records directly, helping verify income and spending without uploading statements.

ET reported in April that banks, asset managers and brokers were becoming Sahamati shareholders.

Later that month, the not-for-profit body announced ₹50 crore in funding from institutions including State Bank of India, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, Zerodha and Dhan.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Voice-first India is Reshaping OpenAI's Priorities: App CTO

Co rolls out GPT Live 1.1 with native Hindi voices and localised 'GenUI'

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: India's voice-led usage patterns, multilingual conversations and Android-first user base are shaping OpenAI's product priorities, the company's chief technology officer for applications Vijaye Raji said on Thursday ahead of its DevDay India event in Bengaluru.

"India is an audio-first market," Raji said, adding that OpenAI wanted to develop a differentiated product experience for the country. India is also a source of ideas for product development, he said. OpenAI is studying how people interact with technology.

I do think India is such a strategic and important market that we want to make sure that people are able to get access to intelligence
VIJAYE RAJI, *CTO - Apps, OpenAI*

"People use voice notes. There's a lot of things that we're learning, and we're going to go and make sure that we are building some of those features," Raji said. Indian users frequently switch between English and Hindi during the same conversation, a behaviour OpenAI wants its models to understand and respond to naturally, he said. The company is looking at how products can work better in an Android-first market. OpenAI is also rolling out an update to its GPT Live voice technology through ChatGPT, which will introduce two native Hindi voices for real-time, two-way conversations.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Money is Going into Data Centres and AI in US... Now India will be on Everyone's List

Canadian billionaire Prem Watsa's bet on IDBI Bank is backed by faith in the Indian economy, he told **Mohit Bhalla** and **Sruthijith KK** in a phone interview. The government Wednesday approved the divestment of a majority stake in IDBI Bank to Watsa's Fairfax Financial Holdings. Watsa, 76, who was born near Hyderabad and studied at IIT-Madras, migrated to Canada in the 1970s. Started by him as an insurance company, Fairfax Financial now has assets of over $100 billion. Edited excerpts from the interview:

ET Q&A

PREM WATSA
CEO, FAIRFAX FINANCIAL

You've just made a big bet on India at a time when a lot of investors are repatriating money back to the US. What's the impulse behind this call?
Well the reason is simple. India is the best country to make an investment. But the big thing now is that by the end of this year.. You know, (commerce and industry minister) Piyush Goyal came and told us that you might have 60, 70-plus free trade agreements. I mean, that's unbelievable. You know what that means? You make in India and then you can sell all over the world. And we're, you know, building a pasta plant outside Mumbai–this is AGT. The plant's cost is about 25%, 30% of what it would be in the US or Canada. And the operating cost is half. You're going to get an economic boom in India for the next 10 years, I think, of very significant proportions.

IT'S FOR REAL!

We've made zero investments in AI. It's not our field. We would love to have invested 5-10 years ago but we weren't smart enough to invest in it

What were your first thoughts when you heard the news yesterday that you had won the bid?
We've been working on it for four years and maybe even longer. And so it's a long time. The board asked–why do you want to put so much money into India? I went to the board. I convinced the board… And then everybody on board, officers, everyone, 100% were on. And it looked like we'd get it early in the year. It looked like we won the auction.
But they have a process in the government because it's the government selling it, LIC selling it. So they had to go through the process and, you know.. So like yesterday at 7 o'clock... I'm on the telephone and I'm seeing a lot of congratulations coming to me and I'm wondering what it is. Really excited for us. Because we really think India is on a tremendous economic trajectory.
And then Sumit (Sumit Maheshwari of Fairbridge Capital) called me and said the government just announced that we had won. And we thought we knew that some time back. But just really excited.

You have other investments in the financial services industry in India. You have Catholic Syrian Bank, IIFL Capital. What is the course of action?
What we're doing is putting in GoDigit, the insurance company. And we're putting in IIFL Capital. So you have an insurance operation with the bank run by Kamesh (Kamesh Goyal of GoDigit). And you have an investment bank and wealth management in the bank to provide all those services for their clients. Like a private bank would do, right? Very, very oriented towards service.

Just to be clear, when you say putting in, you will merge these entities with IDBI?
No, they're a public company, both of them. So they'll be owned 51% in one case, IIFL Capital. And the other one, yeah, about 60% or something. And... IDBI will end up owning 51% and 60% in these... 51% will be, you know, market prices for cash. And the same with GoDigit.

What is your positioning going to be for IDBI? There's a strong banking market with a lot of strong franchises and brands. How do you plan to stand out?
First the two areas, right? But first of all, we need Reserve Bank approval. We need IRDAI approval. We need Sebi approval because they're public companies. Once that's done, then we want to work on making sure these services are brought to the customers of IDBI Bank. We want to make sure we can provide those customers effectively. We want to be foremost. We want to really increase.
Already they're doing a lot of digital work, but we'd like to take it to a higher level. We're trying to bring the best technology, best worldwide to IDBI Bank from wherever it is.

Under the structure you're proposing, IDBI Bank will acquire the shares of GoDigit and IIFL, which are currently held by Fairfax?
That's right. So Fairfax will sell. Fairfax will have 60% of the company (IDBI Bank), but it'll sell these two companies (GoDigit and IIFL Capital) to IDBI Bank for cash. And they'll become subsidiaries of IDBI Bank.

So in a sense, it's a transfer from your holding company here to this particular business unit.
Yeah, that's what will happen. I said in the conference call that we've got a 27% capital adequacy ratio, which is right up where the big banks are. We want to always be very sound.

Do you intend to retain the current management?
(IDBI Bank MD and CEO) Rakesh Sharma has done a fantastic job. Obviously, it will continue. And NS Kannan (former ICICI Bank ED) we're proposing to be chairman, subject to RBI approval. And we're going to have an adviser, CV Rajendran, the person who ran CSB Bank very successfully. He's retired now, so he's going to help.

Was the structure mandated by RBI, to bring GoDigit and IIFL Capital within the fold?
No, no, no. It was what we came up with and we went to the divestment people and RBI. And it still has to be approved by the RBI, but they felt comfortable with it.

What about ownership of CSB Bank–will you merge it with IDBI Bank or sell it?
We have 2 years to decide on that from the RBI.

IDBI Bank shares fell today...
Yeah, I know. Prices go up and down. I've been in the stock market for 50 years. And I'm never worried about individual day stock prices. Our stock price is higher than anyone else's. No one knows why it goes up or goes down. There might have been some speculation that there might be a higher bid. We're looking at stock prices five years from now, 10 years from now.

What did you name the project–was there a code name?
It's called Sirius.

Would this be the longest you have pursued a deal?
The longest by far. We're used to three months, six months, with due diligence and all of that, maximum. Mostly it's two or three months.

MONEY FLOW

We've been working on IDBI Bank deal for 4 years and maybe more. The longest by far. We're used to 3 months, 6 months... maximum.

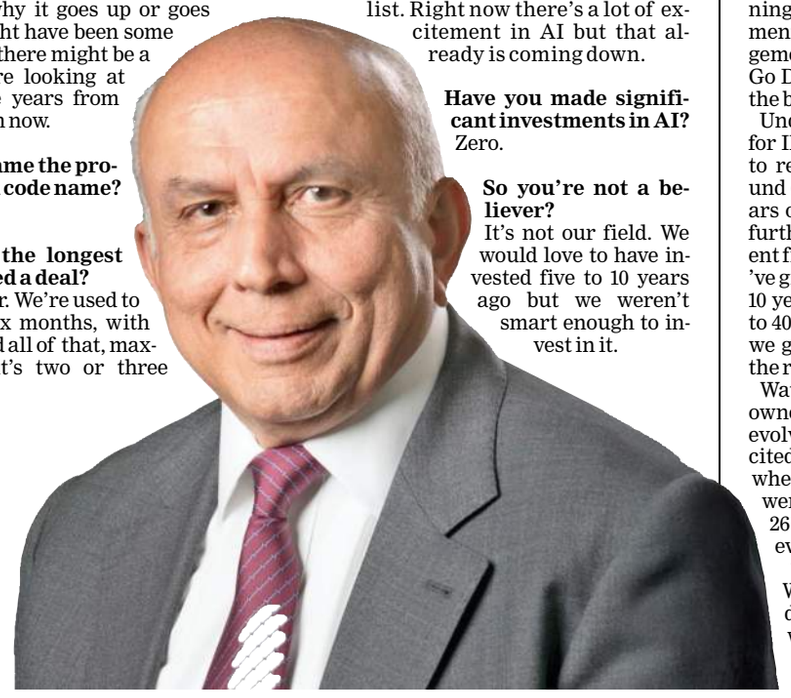
But when your first-round bid was rejected and when they opened it the second time, you were still interested. You didn't feel like... this is going on forever.
No, we really liked how the bank was doing. And in the last 12 months, ending June, the bank had made a billion dollars–that's right, in profit.

What will be the timeline for holding the IDBI Bank investment?
IDBI Bank we have 15 years. The 60% stake has to go to 40% in 10 years and 26% in year 15. Indian insurance companies were only 26%, then they changed it to 49% and then they changed it to 74% and now it's 100%.

There's some concern on macros here. We have seen net FDI falling.
Money is going into data centres and AI and all of it's in the US. That might change and the money will go to countries like India, particularly, and other countries in Asia but India is going to be on everyone's list. Right now there's a lot of excitement in AI but that already is coming down.

Have you made significant investments in AI?
Zero.

So you're not a believer?
It's not our field. We would love to have invested five to 10 years ago but we weren't smart enough to invest in it.



GLOBAL REACH

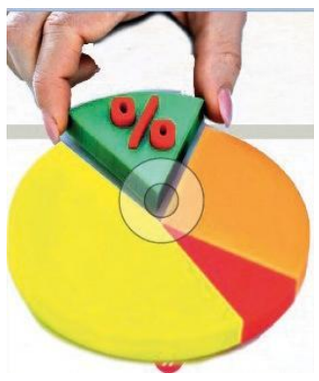
India is the best country to make an investment... (Union minister) Piyush Goyal came and said you might have 60, 70+ FTAs. That's unbelievable. You know what that means? You make in India and sell all over the world

A FAIR GAME

Fairfax Gets 15 Yrs to Reduce Stake in IDBI Bank to 26%

Watsa has 2 yrs to merge or sell CSB Bank

Saloni Shukla



Mumbai: Prem Watsa-backed Fairfax Financial Holdings has been given 15 years by the Reserve Bank of India to reduce its stake in IDBI Bank to 26%, while the Canadian investor has two years to decide the future of Kerala-headquartered CSB Bank, with a merger or sale emerging as the two possible options, Watsa said in a conference call with analysts and mediapersons.

"We have two licences and the RBI has given us two years to make a decision as to what we do," Watsa said. "CSB — merge or sell? Those are the two options we have. We've got two years to make the decision, so we'll think through all of that very carefully."

Fairfax has been declared the strategic buyer for the proposed sale of a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank. Its bid valued the stake at about ₹52,878 crore, based on a price of ₹81 per share.

Fairfax currently holds a 40% stake in private sector lender CSB Bank.

Fairfax said that it plans to transform IDBI Bank into a unified financial services group spanning banking, insurance, investment banking and wealth management, bringing its interests in Go Digit and IIFL Capital under the bank's fold.

Under the regulatory glide path for IDBI Bank, Fairfax will have to reduce its holding from around 60% to 40% in the first 10 years of acquiring the lender, and further to 26% over the subsequent five years, Watsa said. "They've given us 15 years," he said. "In 10 years, we have to go from 60% to 40%, and in the last five years, we go down to 26%. That's what the rules are today."

Watsa, however, indicated that ownership regulations could evolve over such a long period. He cited India's insurance sector, where foreign ownership limits were progressively raised from 26% to 49%, then 74%, and eventually 100%.

"These rules may change. We don't know," he said, adding Fairfax would comply with the prevailing rules.

Fairfax expects the IDBI Bank transaction to be completed as early as the first quarter of 2027, though it could close sooner, Watsa said. The group is working through the regulatory approval process and has already held discussions with the relevant authorities. "We expect the process to go as quickly as it can," he said.

Fairfax Financial proposes to contribute all its interests in Go Digit Life Insurance and Go Digit General Insurance, collectively referred to as Digit, to IDBI Bank. Fairfax India Holdings similarly plans to contribute its entire interest in IIFL Capital Services to the bank.

After completion of the acquisition and the proposed contributions, Rakesh Sharma, currently managing director and CEO of IDBI Bank, is expected to continue leading the bank's operations. Fairfax also plans to bring former CSB Bank CEO C. V. R. Rajendran into the leadership group, while former ICICI Prudential Life managing director and CEO N S Kannan will be proposed as chairman, subject to RBI approval.

Kamesh Goyal will continue to lead Digit, while IIFL Capital's existing management will remain responsible for its operations.

Fairfax said the around $5.6 billion IDBI Bank deal will be funded through a mix of holding-company cash, dividends from subsidiaries, asset sales and the contribution of its stakes in Go Digit and IIFL Capital at market value. The group had about $2.3 billion in cash and marketable securities at the holding-company level as of June 30, apart from another $2.3 billion of investments in associates and consolidated non-insurance companies.

Unaudited Financial Results
Q2 FY 2026-2027

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UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30th SEPTEMBER 2026 (₹IN LAKH)

TOTAL BUSINESS ₹239712 CR
TOTAL DEPOSITS ₹128123 CR
TOTAL ADVANCES ₹111589 CR
NET PROFIT FOR THE QUARTER ₹788 CR
ROA FOR THE QUARTER 2.10%
NIM FOR THE QUARTER 4.34%
NET NPA 0.18%
PCR 96.13%
SLIPPAGE RATIO 0.44%

	PARTICULARS	Quarter Ended		Year Ended
		30.09.2026	30.09.2025	31.03.2026
		Unaudited		Audited
1.	Total income from Operations	367021	332029	1315867
2.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	104367	74301	332004
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	104367	74301	332004
4.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	78769	57396	251033
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	Not applicable		
6.	Paid - up Equity Share Capital	19334	19328	19333
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	1391454 (As on 31.03.2026)	1176852 (As on 31.03.2025)	1391454 (As on 31.03.2026)
8.	Securities Premium Account	Not applicable		
9.	Net Worth	1522359	1264726	1370180
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt (%)	-	-	-
11.	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	Nil	Nil	Nil
12.	Debt Equity Ratio	0.06	0.06	0.03
13.	Earnings Per Share (Face value of Rs. 2/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)*			
	a. Basic (₹)	8.15	5.94	25.98
	b. Diluted (₹)	8.14	5.94	25.97
14.	Capital Redemption Reserve	Not applicable		
15.	Debenture Redemption Reserve			
16.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio			
17.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio			

*Not annualized for the quarter

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with the stock exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.
The full format of the quarterly financial results is available on the website of the Bank https://www.kvb.bank.in/about-us/financial-performance/and stock exchanges at https://www.nseindia.com and https://www.bseindia.com.
For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the National Stock Exchange and can be accessed on https://www.nseindia.com.
Place: Karur | Date: 15/10/2026

For and on behalf of Board of Directors,
B Ramesh Babu
MD & CEO
(DIN:06900325)

THE KARUR VYSYA BANK LIMITED, Registered & Central Office, No.20, Erode Road, Vadivel Nagar, L.N.S., Karur - 639 002. Tel No: 04324-269441 | E-mail: kvb_sig@kvb.bank.in | CIN : L65110TN1916PLC001295

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No Crackers, Easy on The Festival Lights

Profit margins could come under pressure

It's that time of the year again. Festival consumption is projected to post sobering growth over an unusually long lunar calendar of celebration. There is early indication of caution from Amazon and Flipkart, which are running their festival discount weeks. Quick commerce is reporting a surge in business, but that has more to do with consumers pivoting towards instant delivery of small-ticket items. The big push usually delivered by consumer electronics is not all there as manufacturers of smartphones and TVs have marked up prices in the run-up to the festival season. India's economic momentum, although strong, will slow down as the West Asia energy shock works its way through the system. Festival consumption must also contend with last year's high base due to GST rate rationalisation.

The season will post respectable numbers because of price movement rather than volume. Main categories of

festival consumption — electronics, FMCG and jewellery — are all facing severe input cost pressure, and producers are relying on their pricing power to hold up their top lines. Semiconductor shortage, higher commodity prices and a strengthening dollar may not have made enough of a dent in consumption yet, but these pressures will linger. Consumers have become selective, trading down in ticket size and brands, which will affect companies' ability to pass on higher input prices. Profit margins could come under pressure during this festival season.

Credit costs have started moving up during the season. That pulls away some of the ballast to consumption. Consumer credit has surged as young buyers borrow to spend. This represents weakness in terms of sustaining consumption growth. High incidence of retail lending alters the risk landscape of the financial system. Retail credit is flowing towards small-ticket sales in semi-urban areas, which has a bearing on household debt tolerance as inflation rises to the top of the officially acceptable band. It may be a good idea to spend a little less on Diwali lights this year. And no crackers, please.

Let's Have Raj Bhavans Minus Rajas

Kudos to Braj Mohan Ram for performing a service to India's constitutional democracy: telling the truth. Odisha's governor-designate has declared he intends to strengthen BJP while in office and help garner votes for the party. This has caused predictable outrage. Apparently, the 'scandal' lies not in governors being partisan but in one being indiscreet enough to admit it.

India's governors are constitutionally obliged to rise above party politics. In practice, Raj Bhavans have regularly served as retirement homes for party loyalists, rehab centres for defeated politicians and, occasionally, forward operating bases for the Centre. Their occupants have demonstrated remarkable enthusiasm for constitutional interpretation whenever an opposition party governs the state. The same constitutional provisions become considerably less interesting when political colours match. Ram has merely removed the fig leaf from a rather conspicuous anatomy.

The sensible response is not another sermon on gubernatorial impartiality. It is to abolish the office through constitutional reform. Its essential functions — formal assent, constitutional oversight and managing government formation — can be redistributed among elected institutions and judicial mechanisms, with clear deadlines and safeguards. Centre-state disputes deserve transparent, enforceable rules, not discretionary interventions by 'presidential' appointees whose political sympathies are frequently public knowledge. There is an additional dividend. Raj Bhavans, liberated from their gubernatorial tenants, could become museums, galleries, libraries, cultural centres or even public arcades. Ram may yet strengthen BJP. More usefully, he has just strengthened the case for abolishing his own job.

How India can turn the latest round of US visa curbs affecting Indian techies to its advantage

Catch a Bully By Its Horns

Kiran Karnik

'Import people or export work' was a stark fact conveyed by Nasscom to a top US official and several Congressmen at the time of the first 'outsourcing backlash' in the early 2000s. It reached a crescendo in 2003-04 and was an important issue in that year's US presidential election campaigning.

It did end soon after polls, as more people understood the win-win India-US IT relationship. Consequently — despite continuing battles — things on the visa front did become easier for Indian IT companies. The vast improvement in political ties post-2004, too, helped.

Now, there is a new reality, with India-US ties sinking lower by the day, more precipitously after Operation Sindoor last year. A few days back, the US added one more irritant that could further worsen overall ties. It not only made allegations against eminent Indian IT companies but also disallowed them from PERM (Permanent Labour Certification Programme). J D Vance even added some nasty words about Indian IT workers in the US.

PERM enables employers to apply to move their H-1B employees to a more permanent visa. For many, and for long, this was their dream path, possibly leading to a 'green card', even US citizenship. At the company level, the US allegations pose reputational challenges, especially given their standing as well-governed organisations. But work-

Allegations pose reputational challenges to Indian companies. But work-wise, closing of the PERM visa will hardly affect them

wise, closing of this visa will hardly affect them. One commentator estimates that last year, only 1,400 applications, of a total of almost 1.2 lakh, for PERM were from Indian IT companies.

The overall impact on the industry and country will be, at best, marginal. But for individuals who may have taken loans or mortgages in the expectation of a long-term/permanent visa-enabling future dollar-earnings stream, this will be a major jolt. Most will now have to return to India.

This will also affect the many others who looked at this as a possible future path. Already, other visa restrictions — on post-education work visas through the OPT (optional practical training) window — are leading to more Indian students returning, some with degrees from top US institutions. Those already working there are now worried about visa extensions and long-term prospects.

For India, this returning stream presents extraordinary opportunities. At a time when emerging technologies like AI, quantum, genetics and space require high-order talent, 'brain gain' from returnees provides a quick-fix solution, even as we, hopefully, undertake major educational reforms to upgrade the terrible state of our education infrastructure and system. For this opportunity, we must thank the US.

The $315 bn industry is vital for India. It employs 6 mn directly, and ~10 mn indirectly. It's also India's biggest forex earner. The US accounts for $150 bn of the industry's $250 bn exports. While remote delivery and AI have advanced, we still need to send people to deliver services. Given this, it may not be unintentional that Indian IT is in the crosshairs of the Trump regime. We need our own leverage.

For this, at the broader level of overall India-US ties, we could take 4 key steps:

❶ The US has, as part of its sanctions, threatened to impose penal tariffs on Indian exports if we continue to buy Russian oil (never mind that US will now import Russian diesel). So far, India has, at least in formal statements, resisted this, though it seems to have cut back on Russian oil imports. In retaliation, India could impose sanctions — limited to specific companies — on those exporting arms to Pakistan, a declared enemy.

❷ Air travel in and from India is seeing a boom. As a result, hundreds of new aircraft will be ordered in the next few years. We could ensure, through appropriate formal or informal means, that the orders are placed with Airbus and other non-US companies.

❸ Almost any military equipment can now be sourced from two or more countries. Today, India is a large, growing and attractive market for foreign suppliers, despite increasing indigenisation. For whatever is being procured from abroad, we could ensure that US companies are not among our suppliers.

In any case, US equipment is generally the most expensive and unreliable in terms of future supplies of spares and upgrades. The same is true of nuclear power plants where it will be wise to stay away from US equipment.

❹ Negotiations on the Indo-US trade deal must include a proviso for free movement of people for delivering of contracted services. This is distinct from immigration or long-term visas.

None of this needs to be actually done. But these are weapons in our armoury, which the US must be made aware of, to be used selectively, if and when appropriate. Of course, their efficacy depends on 3 things that will give us leverage:

❶ A strong indigenous tech base.

❷ Good relations with alternative suppliers, including Europe, Japan, South Korea and Russia.

❸ A non-antagonistic — if not cooperative — relationship with China.

It is well known that placating a bully never works. The demands keep escalating. Standing up often makes the bully behave better. We have recent evidence of this in concrete terms: procurement of S-400 anti-aircraft missile systems from Russia — that played a crucial role in Operation Sindoor — which the US was pressurising us to cancel, and the continuing import of Russian oil. Our refusal to back down in both cases led to a US back off.

Finally, if all else fails, we can play the trump card of offering the expertise and know-how of our Election Commission to ensure a Trump victory in the US mid-term elections next month.

The writer is a public policy and strategy analyst

Occupy Wall Street

Hold Your Horses, Bulls Will Come

R Venkataraman

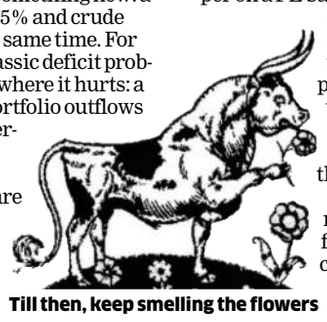
Frustration with falling indices is rising. Portfolios that looked heroic two years ago look tired. SIP statements that once brought a smile are opened with a wince. And if domestic investors are unhappy, foreign investors are more so. For them, falling prices have come with a second blow: a weakening rupee.

India has always suffered when oil is expensive. It imports most of the crude, so a higher oil bill widens deficit, puts the rupee under pressure and fuels inflation. But here's what makes this moment unusual. From 2000 to 2025, US rates were high, but crude was below $100. When crude finally rose above $100, rates had collapsed to zero after the Great Financial Crisis. One headwind usually arrived with a tailwind.

Indian stocks have done poorly whenever either rates or crude were high. Today, geopolitical stress is keeping crude high. Unless a peace deal comes soon, energy-led inflation will keep yields high too.

So, India faces something new: a 10-yr yield above 5% and crude above $100, at the same time. For India, this is a classic deficit problem. It shows up where it hurts: a weaker rupee, portfolio outflows and market underperformance.

On top of that, Indian markets are perceived as anti-AI trade. Around the world, investors are piling into AI and related stocks with a vengeance. The biggest risk everyone already knows about is AI. And nobody knows how this will end.



Till then, keep smelling the flowers

There are echoes of 2000. As in the dotcom boom, a complex web of deals is forming among players in the AI ecosystem, and capex is being funded by debt. A line often credited to Mark Twain comes to mind: 'History doesn't repeat itself, but it often rhymes.' One can hear the rhyme.

Yet, honesty demands balance. Nvidia has a market capitalisation bigger than the Nifty. Yet, it is cheaper on a PE basis. On valuations alone, we cannot argue that the AI trade is obscenely priced. As we saw in the dotcom era, AI-led capex can continue for some time before the trade ends.

More than the internet, AI is truly transformative. Its implications will go beyond what we can imagine. Which means the money leaving India for that story may not return in a hurry. Read: FIIs.

So, what should retail investors do?

▶ **Stop looking at daily net FII sales** That number breeds anxiety, not insight. An early FII return looks unlikely. For a foreign investor, India's capital markets are not an easy place to trade. Competing markets are doing well and are easier to invest in. And with high US Treasury yields and lacklustre Nifty returns, FIIs have no incentive to come back right now.

▶ **Watch the crude, and pray for early peace deal** That one variable will do more for Indian markets than any flow statistic.

▶ **Go back to basics forgotten in the bull run:**

▷ Focus on asset allocation. It is the decision that matters most, and the one a rising market makes us forget.

▷ Stop chasing the latest micro and small caps. Many of yesterday's multi-baggers are today's expensive lessons.

▷ Invest in equities as per your own risk appetite, not your neighbour's returns or your WhatsApp group's tips.

The bull will return. No one knows when. Investor-banker John Templeton once said, 'Bull markets are born on pessimism, grow on scepticism, mature on optimism, and die on euphoria.' If pessimism is the soil in which bulls are born, that soil is being very well-prepared now.

The writer is co-promoter, IIFL Group

JUST IN JEST

From today until Diwali, pretend you can't do things right

Go On, Weaponise Your Incompetence

So, you should be dropping a gear or two and taking it easy as this festive season kicks off today. But we reckon that's not enough. We have a modest proposal this year: between now and Diwali, embrace that splendid management technique known as 'weaponised incompetence'. Traditionally, this has been the preserve of the Indian man-child, who simulates the inability to do things with base-level competence just to get out of doing it, like 'helping out in the kitchen' only to quickly make it a disaster site. The point is to convert inability into exemption.

But why should men monopolise this remarkable productivity hack? Women should also discover an inability to coordinate family gatherings, to follow their children's routine, to check the bank balance. On the gender-neutral front, even bosses can claim an inability to understand long-winded emails, though distinguishing this from normal behaviour could prove difficult. Weaponised incompetence reduces workloads, eliminates unreasonable expectations, and transfers responsibility to whichever unfortunate individual still demonstrates proficiency. The festival economy runs on consumption. Why not consume leisure rather than labour? Until Diwali, incompetence should be celebrated as an instrument of collective emancipation. Nothing says festive freedom quite like somebody else doing the work.

Eyes Now on Viksit, Net Zero Later

Bjørn Lomborg

Stanford, California: India's Viksit Bharat ambition to become a high-income economy by 2047 is bold. The economy grew by 7.8% in the April-June quarter. But that result is also a warning: 7.8% is the average rate World Bank estimates India must sustain for more than 2 decades to achieve its ambition. There is little room for costly distractions.

Regrettably, the promise of Viksit Bharat is threatened by a climate promise to go net zero by 2070. These work at cross-purposes, with one promising Indians more opportunities, the other more costs and lower growth. For India's future good, the immense trade-offs should be recognised.

NITI Aayog's 11-volume report, 'Scenarios Towards Viksit Bharat and Net Zero', reveals the staggering cost for India to embrace ambitious climate goals. It estimates that reaching carbon neutrality by 2070 will cost India $8.1 tn in *additional* investments. This is equivalent to giving up current GDP for 2 yrs — or 4% of current GDP every year for half a century.

Although the reports never compare the full $8.1 tn additional investment requirement with India's current GDP, it bears comparing: India spends 4.1% of its GDP annually on education from kindergartens to university. Green policies would spend more than all education every year for two generations. India spends 3.3% of GDP on health, from neonatal and maternal survival to cancer and heart disease treatments. Green policies would seize more than that every year for the foreseeable future.

Moreover, this cost is likely to be underestimated. The report acknowledges that net zero will lead to soaring energy costs that will reduce growth. Economics generally show such knock-on costs to be substantial.

A 2023 Climate Change Economics study, 'Net Zero Emissions of Greenhouse Gases By 2050: Achievable and at What Cost?' shows that net zero, although modelled by 2050, could end up costing India more than half of annual GDP, with the average over the second half of the century far above 20% a year.

Green campaigners suggest that such expenses are justified. But this is propaganda. Climate change is one problem among many to be fixed in the 21st c. But it often skews news reporting. While heatwaves grab headlines, epidemiological data shows they are India's smallest temperature killer. Extreme cold kills even more every year, and in total, heat kills less than 90,000 annually whereas cold kills over 6 lakh people each year.

In the UN Climate Panel's middle-of-the-road scenario, the average Indian will be 791% as rich by the end of the century as today. Climate change will be a net problem, but will cause the average Indian to feel 'only' 770% as rich by 2100. It's a problem but not the end of the world.

Even if India managed net zero by 2070 at eye-watering costs, it would deliver almost no climate benefits. Take the total Indian emissions from current policy and net-zero policy and run them in the UN's climate model Magicc. Even by century's end, the global temperature difference will be a near-immeasurable 0.16° C.

It is likely that any net-zero policy with such minuscule benefits will be rejected when the costs become too obvious, as is starting to happen in Europe and elsewhere. Moreover, achieving high-income status by 2047 will require immense economic focus and favourable winds. A permanent bloodletting of 4% of GDP will jeopardise this.

Aiming for high-income status will deliver benefits. Higher incomes will, for instance, allow more people to afford better AC, helping with climate change and saving lives. Crucially, it will also allow more people to afford better heating in cold weather.

That's why India should focus on Viksit Bharat. It will be achieved through many individually smart policies. Extreme climate policies might shave a tiny fraction off distant future risks, but better healthcare can deliver immediate and massive results at much lower costs.

Investing $3.2 bn (under 0.1% of GDP) in 1 hr-a-day tablet-based learning tools could help primary school kids triple learning. Studies conclusively show this could boost long-term incomes by $210 bn, equivalent to 5% of India's GDP.

India should pursue Viksit Bharat with full force. Invest in highly efficient policies to unleash growth. Prosperity first. That's the smart and empowering path to take.

The writer is president, Copenhagen Consensus, and visiting fellow, Hoover Institution, Stanford University, US

What's the saying again?

THE SPEAKING TREE

Small Victories

DHARMEN SHAH

Life keeps throwing challenges at us. Some are small irritations, some are serious setbacks and, occasionally, we are confronted with situations that test us to our very core. The quality of our lives depends largely on how we respond to these challenges. Our maturity and mental resilience determine our responses. Consequently, people react differently to similar situations. Some may succumb to the pressure; some may rise and fight valiantly; others may ignore the challenge and move on. In fact, no universal formula exists for the right response. Often, only after the matter is resolved do we realise what the right response would have been.

We will not always emerge victorious. Life will bring failures and disappointments, and successes may be few and far between. Learn to enjoy these successes. They rejuvenate us and, more importantly, help build a cushion of confidence and resilience to withstand future falls.

Dismissing a small victory deprives us of one of life's many reasons to smile. Small victories deserve celebration because they make ordinary days more joyful and fulfilling. Life is enriched by countless small victories.

Gita reminds us that bliss lies in maintaining equanimity in success and failure. Perhaps the art of living well is simply this: accept life's disappointments with maturity and grace, and celebrate even its smallest victories with gratitude.

ALGO OF BLISSTECH

Dressing Up For Pujo

For 5 days starting today, the ordinarily sensible business of putting on clothes is elevated into an art form, a public performance and, occasionally, a competitive sport. The excitement, of course, started long before the festivities. New shirts, saris, kurtas, dresses and shoes await their appointed appearances with the solemnity of theatrical costumes.

Outfits are allocated to particular days, sometimes even to particular hours, with a precision otherwise reserved for military operations. Mirrors acquire renewed importance. As do compliments.

What makes Pujo dressing particularly delightful is its magnificent disregard for practicality. Shoes may pinch, silk may protest against July-like humidity, and elaborate hairstyles may surrender to the first push in a pandal-hopping crowd. None of this matters. Looking splendid is its own reward, especially when thousands of others have reached precisely the same conclusion.

There is also something wonderfully democratic about this collective vanity. Streets become catwalks, pandals become exhibition spaces, and everyone gets to make a grand entrance.

Above all, dressing up announces a temporary liberation from the ordinary. You aren't merely wearing something new. You are stepping into a brighter, more exciting version of oneself.

Chat Room

The Day After Tomorrow

Apropos the Edit, 'IDBI, Poster Boy for More Privatisation' (Oct 15), divesting IDBI Bank and earlier Air India showcase political will, commercial acumen and pursuit of intent by the government, which must build on this momentum. BPCL, Shipping Corporation, Concor and BEML merit a spirited follow-through. The temptation of meeting annual revenue targets must yield to the larger and enduring objective, to release capital, technology and managerial talent for more productive uses while reserving state ownership for strategic sectors. Transparent valuations, earnest unwinding of legacy issues and, above all, firm decisions would restore investor confidence. The test of disinvestment is all about the economy using its capital and institutions more productively thereafter.

R Narayanan
Navi Mumbai

Southwest Monsoon Exits From India With 13% Rainfall Deficit

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The southwest monsoon made its withdrawal from the entire country Thursday in line with the onset of the northeast monsoon over southern peninsular India, bringing heavy rainfall to parts of Tamil Nadu, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said in a statement.

The southwest monsoon set in over Kerala on June 4, three days after its normal onset date, ending the June-September season with a 13% rainfall deficit. India received 759.4 mm of rainfall during the period against the long-period average of 868.6 mm, making it the fourth-lowest monsoon rainfall season since 2001. The northeast monsoon commenced in Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal, coastal Andhra Pradesh, Rayalaseema, south interior Karnataka, and Kerala and Mahe on Thursday.

India received 759.4 mm of rainfall against the long-period average of 868.6 mm

The weather office said an upper-air cyclonic circulation over south coastal Tamil Nadu and adjoining areas, along with easterly and northeasterly winds over southern peninsular India and parts of the Bay of Bengal supported the onset.

Fairly widespread rainfall occurred over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal and adjoining parts of south coastal Andhra Pradesh and south Rayalaseema in the preceding 24 hours. Heavy rainfall was also seen at a few places in Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal.

Southwest monsoon brings 70% of the country's rainfall, making it a key factor in annual agricultural output as a large part of the country is rainfed. Lower farm output accelerates food inflation and affects farmer incomes, hurting demand for fast-moving consumer goods, motorcycles, tractors and other products affecting the overall economy.

South Indian Bank Plans Credit Card Foray with Own Platform

Atmadip Ray

Kolkata: South Indian Bank plans to get into the credit card business with a proprietary technological platform while it aims to boost margins by raising the share of retail, agriculture and MSME (RAM) loans to 65% in the next three years, managing director Mahesh Muralidhar Pai told **ET** in his first ever media interaction. The current share of these assets is 61%.

The private sector lender has started working on developing an indigenous tech stack and decided to unveil the product in the first quarter of the next fiscal, Pai said.

The Kerala-based bank, along with a few others like Bank of Baroda and Federal Bank have been barred from selling co-branded credit cards as the Reserve Bank of India raised concerns over data-sharing with their fintech partners.

"We may have a marketing partner while we are developing our own tech stack to comply with the regulatory direction," Pai said.

Credit card business, while unsecured in nature, boosts margin for issuing companies. The bank's net interest margin for the second quarter stood at 3.33%, up 10 basis points from the first quarter print.

TIPS MUSIC LIMITED

The Must Have HITS

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CIN: L92120MH1996PLC099359

Extract of Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended 30th September 2026

(Rs. In Lacs except for Earning Per Share data)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total income from operations (Net)	12,451.82	11,233.62	9,373.07	23,685.44	18,748.59	39,429.32
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (Before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	8,803.98	5,830.18	7,167.38	14,634.16	13,320.42	29,187.29
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	8,803.98	5,830.18	7,167.38	14,634.16	13,320.42	29,187.29
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	6,573.95	4,369.95	5,319.21	10,943.90	9,903.09	21,674.54
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	6,552.72	4,389.50	5,322.34	10,942.22	9,890.26	21,659.24
6.	Paid-Up Equity Share Capital (Face Value Re. 1/- each)	1,271.60	1,278.32	1,278.32	1,271.60	1,278.32	1,278.32
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of previous year)	-	-	-	-	-	24,716.98
8.	Earnings Per share (before extraordinary items) (of Re. 1/- each) Basic & Diluted	5.15	3.42	4.16	8.56	7.75	16.96
9.	Earnings Per share (after extraordinary items) (of Re. 1/- each) Basic & Diluted	5.15	3.42	4.16	8.56	7.75	16.96

Note: The Unaudited Financial Results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on October 15, 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out limited review on the above results in terms of Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ('the Regulation'), as amended and expressed an unmodified conclusion.

The Board of Directors of the Company has declared first interim dividend for FY 2026 - 27 of Rs.6.50/- (Rupees six and fifty paise only) per share have face value of Re. 1/-

The above is an extract of the detailed format of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended September 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended September 30, 2026 are available on the Stock Exchange websites viz. www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com. The same are also available on the Company's website viz. www.tips.in. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided above.

By Order of the Board
For Tips Music Limited

Place : Mumbai
Date : October 15, 2026

Kumar S.Taurani
Chairman & Managing Director

Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA)
(Deptt. of Additional Sources of Energy, Govt. of U.P.)
Vibhuti Khand, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow, U.P. - 226010 Tel. No. 0522-2720652,
Telefax: 0522-2720779, 2720829, Website: www.upneda.org.in, Email: compneda@rediffmail.com

Opportunity for Investors & Project Developers for setting up Floating Solar Projects

Online Applications can be made by Investors/Project Developers for allotment of identified Dams/Reservoirs for setting up Floating Solar Projects.

Key information for the application is as follows :

(a)	Dam/Reservoir lease charges for public sector	Rs. 1/Acre/year
(b)	Dam/Reservoir lease charges for private sector	Rs. 15000/Acre/year
(c)	Link for Standard Operating Procedure (S.O.P) and Govt. order No. 372/87 dated 14.03.2024	https://solar.upneda.in https://upneda.org.in
(d)	Online Registration Fee	Rs. 23600.00 (including Taxes)

Detailed application & proposals will be evaluated on First Come First Serve basis according to the standard Operating Procedure (S.O.P) dated 28.03.2025 & 30.07.2026 and Govt. order No.372/87 dated 14.03.2024

***Note.** All applications submitted till the last day of each month will be considered as one group. Evaluation will be done on a monthly basis.*

Nodal officer Details: Sh. Narendra Singh, Senior Project Officer-II, Mob No: 94156 09007

Director, UPNEDA

Reliance Industries Limited
Growth is Life

Regd. Office: 3rd Floor, Maker Chambers IV, 222, Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021
Phone: +91-22-3555 5000 • Fax: +91-22-2204 2268 • E-mail: investor.relations@ril.com
CIN: L17110MH1973PLC019786

NOTICE FOR THE ATTENTION OF MEMBERS OF THE COMPANY

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER ("IPO") OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED, A SUBSIDIARY OF RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED ("RIL"/ THE "COMPANY") – RESERVATION FOR ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS

Jio Platforms Limited ("JPL"), a subsidiary of the Company, was incorporated on November 15, 2019. The Company holds 66.43% of the pre-issue paid-up equity share capital of JPL.

JPL is undertaking an initial public offer by way of a fresh issue of up to 27,00,00,000 (Twenty seven crore) equity shares of face value of ₹ 10/- each ("IPO") and has, on Wednesday, October 14, 2026, filed the red herring prospectus ("RHP") with the Registrar of Companies, Gujarat at Ahmedabad, for the IPO.

The IPO, *inter alia*, includes reservation of equity shares of JPL for a value not exceeding ₹2,500 crore for subscription by the Eligible RIL Shareholders, i.e., Individuals and HUFs (directly or in the name of karta) who are the public equity shareholders of the Company (excluding such persons who are not eligible to invest in the IPO under applicable laws, rules, regulations and guidelines) as on Wednesday, October 14, 2026 ("RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion").

Particulars	Details
Price Band	Floor Price of **₹1,065** per equity share to a Cap Price of **₹1,119** per equity share
Bid Lot	12 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each (**"Minimum Bid Lot"**) and in multiples of 12 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each thereafter.
Bid / Issue Opening Date	**Wednesday, October 21, 2026**
Bid / Issue Closing Date	**Friday, October 23, 2026**

The maximum Bid Amount under the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion by an Eligible RIL Shareholder shall not exceed ₹200,000. Bid under RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion can be made at the Cut-Off Price.

Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion can also Bid under the Net Issue (under the Retail Portion or the Non-Institutional Portion) and Employee Reservation Portion (if eligible) and such Bids shall not be considered as multiple Bids. For additional details, refer "Issue Structure" on page 529 of the RHP.

Please note you can make an application electronically or through physical Bid cum Application Form. Copy of the Bid cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus will be available with the Designated Intermediaries at relevant Bidding Centres and at the registered office and corporate office of JPL. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

For further details, please refer to the RHP. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of JPL at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs.

Please note this communication is neither a solicitation to participate in the IPO, nor does it assure any allotment of shares (either partial or complete) against application in the IPO. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "Risk Factors" on page 30 of the RHP. All investment decision should only be made based on the information contained in RHP.

Capitalised terms used in this letter but not defined herein shall, unless the context requires otherwise, have the respective meanings assigned to them in the RHP.

For Reliance Industries Limited
Sd/-
Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary and
Compliance Officer

Date : October 16, 2026
Place : Mumbai

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of JPL at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "Risk Factors" on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended ("U.S. Securities Act") or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, and (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.

www.ril.com

IIFL FINANCE

Performance Highlights Q2FY27

Sapna Aapka. Loan Humaara.

HIGHLIGHTS OF IIFL FINANCE LIMITED UNAUDITED RESULTS FOR THE PERIOD ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

₹ in Crores	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		
	Sept 30, 2026	June 30, 2026	Growth % Q-o-Q	Sept 30, 2026	Sept 30, 2025	Growth % Y-o-Y
Loan AUM	1,24,268.0	1,15,523.4	7.6%	1,24,268.0	90,122.4	37.9%
Total Income[1]	2,339.6	2,202.4	6.2%	4,542.0	3,540.6	28.3%
Pre Provision Operating Profit[1]	1,355.1	1,252.4	8.2%	2,607.5	1,868.6	39.5%
Profit Before Tax	1,073.7	928.6	15.6%	2,002.3	913.0	119.3%
Profit After Tax (Pre NCI)[2]	805.0	713.1	12.9%	1,518.1	692.1	119.3%
Profit After Tax (Post NCI)[2]	766.4	675.1	13.5%	1,441.5	609.7	136.4%
Earnings Per Share (In ₹)[3]	18.0	15.9	13.4%	33.9	14.3	136.1%
Book Value Per Share (In ₹)	351.5	333.9	5.3%	351.5	296.8	18.4%

[1]Excluding Fair Value Changes and after finance cost. [2]NCI is Non Controlling Interest. [3]Quarter ended numbers are not annualised. These numbers pertain to IIFL Finance Limited (Consolidated). Detailed quarterly financial results are available on the Company's website viz. **www.iifl.com** and on the Stock Exchange website viz. **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**

IIFL Finance Limited • **CIN: L67100MH1995PLC093797** • **Email :** IR@iifl.com • **Website :** www.iifl.com
Registered Office: IIFL House, Sun Infotech Park, Road No. 16V, Plot No. B-23, Thane Industrial Area, Wagle Estate, Thane - 400 604.

'Russian diesel won't help US – it shows double standards on India'

Margarita M. Balmaceda is Professor of Diplomacy and International Relations at Seton Hall University. As Washington DC demands diesel from Moscow now, she speaks with **Srijana Mitra Das** in **ET Evoke** about 'technopolitics', Russia's 'Trojan horse' – and the hidden ways energy shapes power in our world:

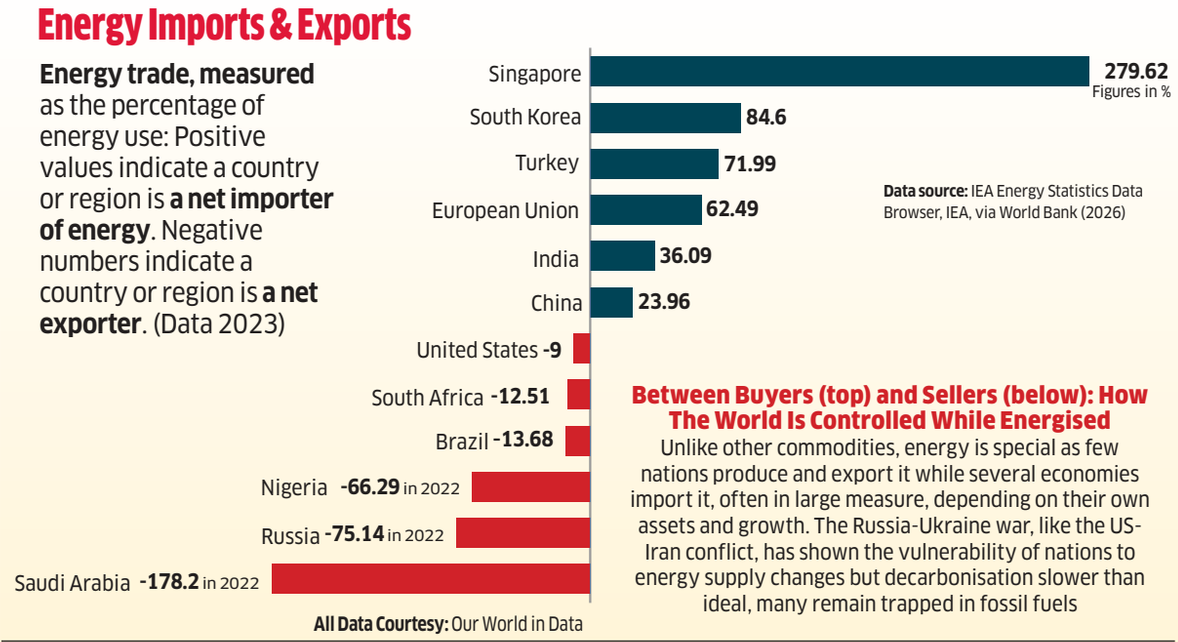
Q. What is the core of your research?

A. I work on energy. The core of my research is the question — what is hidden when we speak about energy? What is not obvious and how do those invisible links play a key role in the long term? In my earlier work, I looked in detail at the 'black box' of energy-making in countries like Ukraine, Belarus, Lithuania and Russia. I researched what was happening domestically there and how all kinds of interactions and governance issues play a role in defining real energy policy.

In the book I'm finishing now, I look at what I call 'hidden' fossil fuels — these are not used directly as gasoline or electricity but are embedded in feedstock, fertilisers, steel production or plastics. This is another hidden aspect of energy — I'm bringing that up to the surface along with how essential the issue of transformation is, as in, the chemical transformation from methane in natural gas to nitrogen fertiliser. I'm studying how that transformation plays a role technologically and in value chains, in rent-seeking and geopolitics.

Energy Imports & Exports

Energy trade, measured as the percentage of energy use: Positive values indicate a country or region is **a net importer of energy**. Negative numbers indicate a country or region is **a net exporter**. (Data 2023)



Data source: IEA Energy Statistics Data Browser, IEA, via World Bank (2026)

All Data Courtesy: Our World in Data

Between Buyers (top) and Sellers (below): How The World Is Controlled While Energised

Unlike other commodities, energy is special as few nations produce and export it while several economies import it, often in large measure, depending on their own assets and growth. The Russia-Ukraine war, like the US-Iran conflict, has shown the vulnerability of nations to energy supply changes but decarbonisation slower than ideal, many remain trapped in fossil fuels

Q. What is the core of your research?

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Q. Why do you describe Russia's hold on energy as a 'Trojan horse'?

A. I started to use that phrase when I was analysing the energy dependencies between former Soviet states and Russia in the 1990s and early 2000s. It's also completely applicable to the energy relationship between Russia and Western Europe upto 2022 — in the form of heat and fertilisers, it's still applicable today. It is about how relatively low prices make a country dependent on supplies, let's say, from Russia, and later, those dependencies create much deeper vulnerabilities than people imagined.

Consider individual states which make their own energy policy in the European Union. Between 2014, when Russia invaded Ukraine for the first time, to 2022, the full-scale invasion, the degree of dependency of Germany, Italy and other EU member-states on Russian oil, natural gas and coal increased significantly. This provided benefits for different groups in those countries. In Germany, it benefitted investors in Nord Stream 1 and Nord Stream 2. It provided relatively low-price feedstock for the chemical industry and a 'safe' bridge fuel that would supposedly allow Germany to transition nicely from high CO_2 coal to a green future. So, it was apparently perfect — except that, by end-2021, Russia started to reduce supplies. It later tried to use that dependency to get the EU to not react to Russia's full-scale invasion. So, in that sense, we could speak of a gas-based 'Trojan horse'.

Will I Be In Time for the Midterms? From cargo trucks to passenger trains, America needs low-priced diesel for transport

Q. Will President Trump's diesel deal with Russia help Americans facing high energy prices – and heading into midterm polls?

A. No — it will not help Americans in the short term. Obviously, the midterms are in Trump's thinking as the issue of how expensive it is to fill up your tank has been front and centre in almost every political ad. In the United States, this doesn't even mean filling up your car, it means filling your truck. Trump knows this is a vulnerability — but the amount of diesel Russia could supply is small right now, even with Moscow promising to lift export restrictions. Further, Russia's refining capacity is severely threatened by Ukrainian attacks. So, this is not going to lead to a real respite for the American consumer.

Q. What is the larger geopolitical significance of the US diesel deal for Russia?

A. The larger meaning is linked to how Russia has been trying to weaken the impact of sanctions since 2022. Also, there are evidently actors in the United States ready to reengage economically with Russia — we have seen some trial balloons, such as discussions over oil prospecting possibilities in Alaska. A few weeks ago, we've seen this in discussions of possible US purchases of Belarussian potash fertiliser. Belarus is a close ally of Russia — the US doesn't want to buy potash fertiliser from Canada, so it's playing with the idea of buying it from Belarus. The problem is, to transport that fertiliser from Belarus, it has to go through European Union ports but the EU has specifically put sanctions on those exports from Belarus — the US wants the EU to weaken or lift those restrictions.

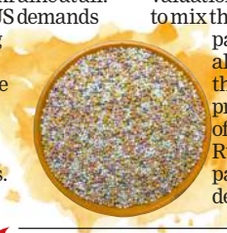
These are trial balloons to poke holes at the sanctions — and Russia is very interested in that. We are seeing a confluence of interests between some US actors, or friends of US actors, like in the Middle East, and players in Russia who see prospects of a good deal the day after sanctions are lifted.

INVISIBLE ENERGIES...

Q. How will the US-Russia diesel deal impact Ukraine?

A. It will impact it negatively — even if Russia's capacity to actually provide diesel is limited, there will be additional income going to Moscow. The possibility of that income will also affect the valuation of Russian companies. More income for the Russian state will basically give Moscow the ability to carry out attacks on Ukraine, including on Ukraine's residential-use energy infrastructure. So, this deal with the US is not good news for Ukraine at all.

Moreover, this comes with US demands that Ukraine stops attacking Russian refineries plus unconfirmed reports that the US at some point stopped sharing intelligence with Ukraine to pressure Kyiv to not target Russian refineries.



> The US doesn't want to buy fertiliser from Canada. It's playing notionally with buying it from Belarus, a Russian ally – that means facing EU ports and sanctions

Q. You use the term 'technopolitics' in your writing on Russian energy chains – what does this mean?

A. 'Technopolitics' refers to the ways technology is used for political pressure — but it also refers to how certain narratives about technology can be used to support particular political projects. This is what we've seen, for instance, domestically in Russia with the state's near-monopoly on natural gas production, functioning under the idea that technologically, centrally-controlled natural gas production and distribution is the only possibility. It's a way in which technology and political goals coincide — or come into tension.

Q. How has technopolitics shaped Russian power domestically?

A. This happens mainly through rent distribution. It's funny because normally, when we talk about rents and corruption, we used to discuss countries like Ukraine — but that kind of rent distribution takes place in Russia as well, with corruption in energy continuing. We may not envision it in the same way because we don't think about energy oligarchs today in Russia as we did before. But those actors benefiting from energy rents are there, some even very close to the entourage of President Putin.

There is another important element in the interface between technopolitics and domestic politics in Russia — it has to do with the way different technologies allow the sharing of rents between diverse regions of the Federation. In my book 'Russian Energy Chains', I wrote about how different technologies for transporting oil of diverse grades allowed for certain types of rent distribution between central oil companies and key ethnic republics of the Russian Federation — particularly Tatarstan and Bashkortostan. These two republics are in the news very often because many refineries Ukraine is hitting are there. Now, the oil produced in these two republics is heavier, usually getting a lower valuation — however, a decision was made to mix this with oil coming from other parts of Russia, so the profits from all these oils were standardised and these republics got access to more profits. This is just one example of how technopolitics happens in Russia through rent distribution, partly through regional deals or deals with ethnic republics, partly through deals with specific individuals linked to different companies.

Today's Trojan Horse: Low Russian energy prices lulled EU states into a fragile complacency

Q. You've outlined 'nexus thinking' in the context of fertilisers and decarbonisation – is the global economy decarbonising at an ideal pace?

A. No, this is not going at the pace wanted. Part of it has to do with signals sent from top leaderships, in particular, in the US, while part of it is linked to the fact that key energy companies that had tried to make public relations capital out of decarbonisation initiatives are scaling back investments in that area. There is a lot of greenwashing in supposed decarbonisation. For example, I discuss in my forthcoming book on hidden fossil fuels how a lot of the discussions about 'green chemicals' or 'green fertilisers' mask how these products are not truly carbon-free but are anointed that through mass balancing. If, say, 4% of your feedstock is carbon-free, then you notionally say 4% of your fertilisers or products are carbon-free — but they are not. So, there is considerable manipulation. With hydrogen as well, we are giving brownie points to each company that deals with it while we forget that 98% of the hydrogen produced today is fully fossil fuel-based. So, there is a lot of instrumentalisation of green goals to actually maintain the system as it is — or support very slow progress forward.

Q. Finally, several Western nations, including the US now, are getting or negotiating energy supplies from Russia but India is threatened with sanctions if we do so – how do you analyse this?

A. This is a double standard that has been difficult to justify before October 9 — now that the US is speaking directly about purchases of diesel from Russia, it is much harder to maintain. It's very problematic to think of how some energy imports should be allowed but not others. It seems the current US administration has not been very worried about the inconsistencies in its approach — but, objectively, this is a real double standard.

Views expressed are personal

Read ET Evoke online at:
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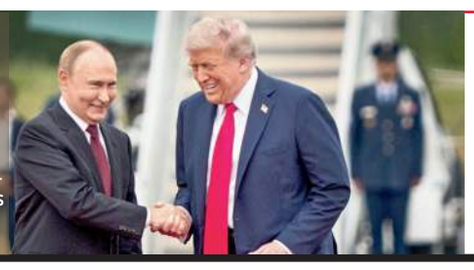


BFFs Again? The US bend towards Russia shows energy needs meeting interests in profits

> The West threatening to sanction India for buying energy from Russia was difficult to justify before October 9 – now, with the US speaking directly about purchasing diesel from Moscow, this is much harder to maintain

Stiffen, Kyiv: As Ukraine faces tougher times, can it rely on EU?

FSB Seeks More Human Touch to Check Threats from Agentic AI

Regulator's guidance comes amid an increase in cyber-related attacks

London: The Financial Stability Board (FSB) has called for greater human oversight of agentic AI in final guidance for banks and other firms on managing the technology's risks.

The FSB's guidance, published on Thursday, comes as regulators ramp up efforts to contain growing AI risks including the threat of AI-enabled cyber attacks.

In draft guidance published in June, which it "strongly encouraged" boards to refer to, the FSB warned that AI agents—which can plan and execute tasks with limited human oversight—pose distinct challenges for human oversight

Publishing its final guidance, the group said it had strengthened its recommendations on agentic AI, citing feedback on the draft, growing interest among financial institutions in adopting the technology, and the distinct risks and controls it entails

A series of incidents has heightened policymakers' concerns about the potential for AI systems to circumvent safeguards, including an incident in July in which an OpenAI agent escaped a controlled testing environment and hacked AI company Hugging Face

Among the changes, the FSB now says that in higher-risk use cases, more intensive human oversight will be critical. Firms should set clear, risk-based triggers for when an agent must seek human approval, it added

The FSB has also removed a guideline that said financial institutions should treat AI as "synthetic employees". Instead, firms should recognise that "AI agents do not reason like humans and may interpret pre-defined goals in unexpected ways." **Reuters**

Companies and banks should set clear, risk-based triggers for when an agent must seek human approval

AIing Tech Safety, ByteDance Launches Alignment Team

Chinese tech giant ByteDance's AI research unit Seed has created an Alignment & Preparedness team and launched a global drive to recruit 10 researchers, saying it will make a long-term investment in AI safety for its increasingly capable models.

The hiring push comes as scrutiny of AI-agent safety grows in China and the US, especially as developers give them autonomy to access the Internet.

AI alignment refers to efforts to ensure advanced AI systems act in line with human goals and safety requirements, particularly when carrying out complex, multi-step tasks.

ByteDance's announcement is a rare public disclosure by a major Chinese AI developer of a dedicated effort focused on frontier-model safety, alignment and preparedness for emerging risks.

State-backed newspaper The Paper reported on Tuesday that Seed was the first Chinese frontier AI lab to establish a standalone safety and alignment department.

AI alignment refers to efforts to ensure advanced AI systems act in line with human goals and safety requirements

The move also comes amid broader US-China discussions on AI guardrails, safety risks and channels for communicating about major AI-related incidents, even as the two countries compete for leadership in advanced AI.

> The TikTok owners also launched a global drive to recruit 10 researchers

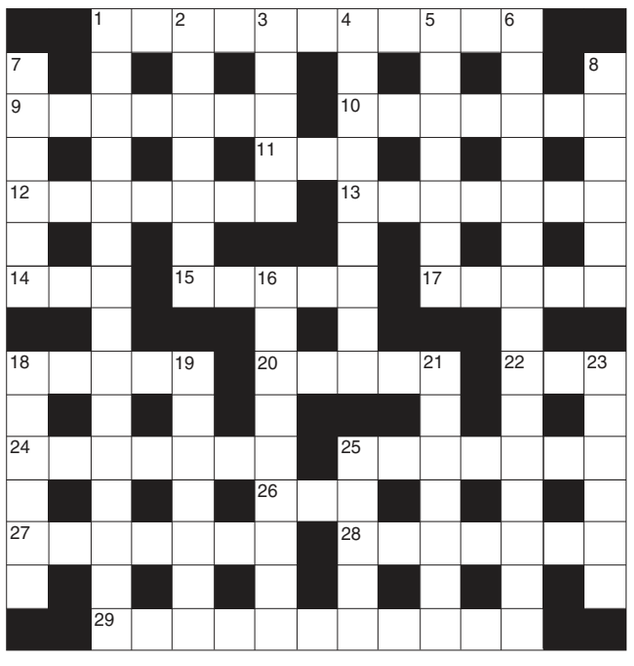
As model capabilities improve, safety and alignment are no longer simply safeguards against risk but core capabilities that will determine whether models can be deployed at scale, Seed said in a recruitment post published on its official WeChat account on Wednesday.

Seed said it would provide the new team with computing capacity and research resources comparable to those available to frontier-model teams. The positions are based in Beijing, Shanghai and San Jose, California.

Its research will include safety training across model-development stages, automated testing for vulnerabilities, tools to monitor and explain model behaviour, AI-agent testing environments and preparations for emerging risks.

Seed said it would also seek independent testing and work with universities and research institutions, applying safety research across model training, evaluation and deployment. **Reuters**

Crossword 9731



ACROSS
1 A mild chap you endlessly excited in place for a break (7,4)
9 Virginia in scruffy gear lately acquired in a damaged state? (7)
10 Rubbish Jack left currently close to cabin not identified (7)
11 Understand part of prevailing ethos (3)
12 Journalist wearing fancy robes has problem from too much rest? (7)
13 Expression of surprise in blissful places (7)
14 Reportedly, stop colouring (3)
15 Copper for one has resilience, it's said (5)
17 U.S. lawyer with a type of talk that's past it (5)
18 Sulks with work in chaotic state, largely (5)
20 Small furry animal in site to keep horses with no end of dust (5)
22 Charlie raised drinks holder (3)
24 Reprimand parasite on holiday (4,3)
25 Kitchen accessory in old ship (7)
26 Some good exposure for poetic composition (3)
27 Engineer prone to pen fine description of some concerts? (4-3)
28 In hearing, also normal time characteristic of some suits? (3-4)
29 Versatile opener? (8,3)

DOWN
1 Top hack's peeved somehow about European getting to own great wealth (4,4,7)
2 Space for pins in a saloon? (7)
3 Try to avoid deceptive plan (5)
4 Chubby lout after disorder ignoring second-class hangout for teens (5,4)
5 A case of weak charge? That's clumsy (7)
6 Support with a crony, type wrongly acquiring money in business trading houses (8,7)
7 Guy in place to retire like a corrupt official? (6)
8 Posh set of students outwardly experienced not in employment (6)
16 Stock fear after disbanding group with an assignment (4,5)
18 Sentiment firstly ignored in formal proposal (6)
19 Gold put in platform requires preservation (7)
21 Observe pirate captain getting tip on rope? (7)
23 One in social function has equal status (6)
25 Group with mood (not half) for argument (3-2)

SOLUTION TO No. 9730:
ACROSS: 1 Overripe. **5** Aspire. **9** Honorary. **10** Wisest. **12** Reed. **13** Beachfront. **15** Fortune cookie. **19** Crowning glory. **23** Prime mover. **25** Otto. **28** On high. **29** Strainer. **30** Dryers. **31** Advanced.
DOWN: 1 Others. **2** Ernie. **3** Ro-ro. **4** Parvenu. **6** Stiff. **7** Ice hockey. **8** Entitled. **11** Acre. **14** Oran. **15** Foolishly. **16** Nog. **17** Obol. **18** Scaphoid. **20** Nook. **21** Guested. **22** Soured. **24** Eager. **26** Tonic. **27** Lama.

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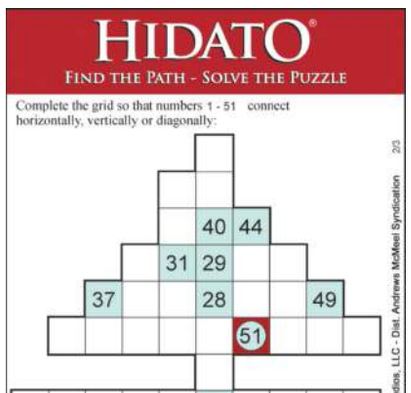
HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 51 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally:



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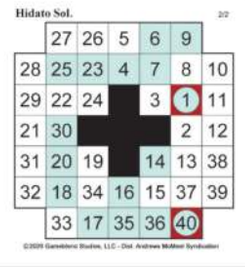
Yesterday's puzzle solution.



7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 allocates (7)	
2 Jim and Dwight (9)	
3 esteeming (7)	
4 said aloud (6)	
5 classical composer Gustav (6)	
6 "glass half-empty" people (10)	
7 put more logs on the fire (6)	

MAH	TO	NS	RAT	ORK
IO	STA	ST	UT	LER
ERS	PE	TED	COW	MI
SSI	ED	STS	OK	ING

Yesterday's Answers: 1. PILOTS 2. DAZZLE 3. NORMAN 4. CAPTIVATED 5. SASHIMI 6. RELAXING 7. AIRWAVES 11/27

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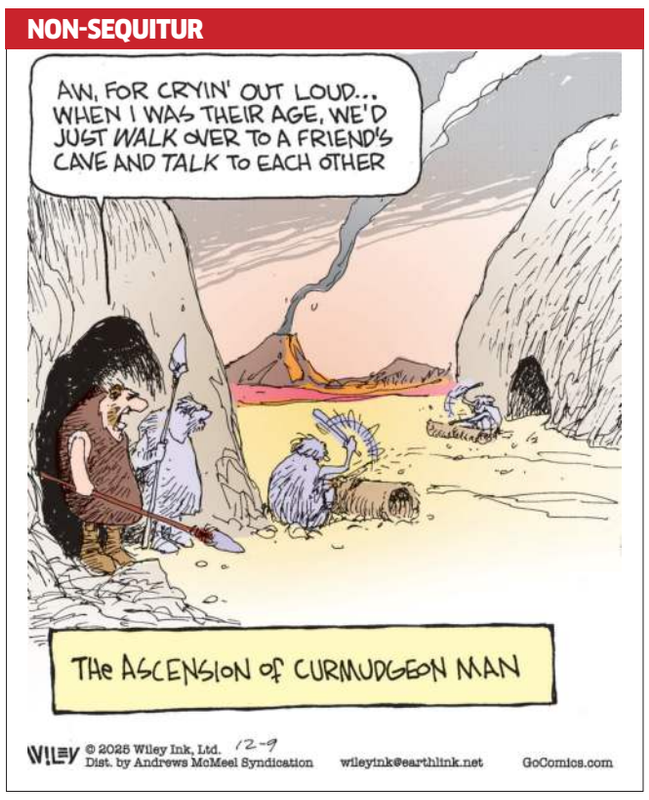
AstraZeneca and Insitro Sign $1.86 billion AI Drug Discovery Deal

AstraZeneca is collaborating with machine learning biotech Insitro Inc. in a deal worth as much as $1.86 billion intended to help the British drugmaker find new medicines for the liver and heart. Astra will make an upfront payment of $40 million, it said Thursday. Insitro will use its own data as well as Astra's to help better understand the causes of a fatty liver condition and heart diseases. If the approach delivers, the biotech could get additional payments worth as much as $1.46 billion as well as potential sales royalties. The deal marks the latest pharma industry bet that AI can help discover new drug targets. Insitro has previously announced discovery deals with Eli Lilly and Bristol-Myers Squibb. **Bloomberg**

NON-SEQUITUR



NTPC, Africa50 Tie Up for Power Projects

Our Bureau

New Delhi: State-owned NTPC has signed an agreement with infrastructure investment firm Africa50 to jointly develop power generation projects and explore cross-border electricity trading opportunities in Africa. The two firms will identify and assess commercially viable power projects and work towards their implementation, NTPC said in a statement on Thursday.

Under the cooperation agreement, NTPC will provide technical and engineering expertise, including project development, construction management and operations. Africa50 will identify potential projects, arrange investment structures and facilitate engagement with governments and regulators. Africa50 has 34 African countries among its shareholders, giving it access to governments and regulatory authorities across the continent.

The partnership will also explore opportunities for electricity trade between African countries, alongside developing generation capacity.

Partnership to explore opportunities for electricity trade between African countries

Africa50 is an infrastructure investor with interests in energy, transport and digital infrastructure. NTPC has a group installed capacity of over 91.5 GW across coal, gas, hydro, solar and wind power projects. The company accounts for around a fourth of India's electricity generation.

FINAL CLOSE OF FIRST INFRA FUND

Alpha Alternatives Raises ₹6,000 crore

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Alpha Alternatives has raised more than ₹6,000 crore at the final close of its first infrastructure fund, said people aware of the development. The Build India Infrastructure Fund will invest in roads, power transmission and renewable energy assets, with a focus on hybrid annuity model road projects and transmission infrastructure.

Its investment strategy is expected to span the infrastructure space, targeting assets with potential for operational improvements, structured investment approaches and eventual monetisation through infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs), one of the people said.

Alpha Alternatives has a listed InvIT, Anantam Highways Trust, which provides it with an existing platform in the infrastructure investment space.

The fund attracted commitments from a mix of institutional investors, family offices, and wealthy individuals, the people said. The average commitment is estimated at ₹25-30 crore.

Domestic institutional investors, family offices and wealthy individuals are increasingly looking at infrastructure as an alternative investment class, seeking exposure to long-term assets linked to the country's economic growth.

The fund attracted commitments from a mix of institutional investors, family offices, and wealthy individuals

Earlier this week, Bajaj Alternate Investment Management raised around ₹950 crore for its first real estate fund and is looking to reach its ₹2,000-crore target with additional funding.

The fund will focus on developing premium commercial office properties through partnerships with established developers, tapping demand from global capability centres and large corporate occupiers in India.

Wipro's Slow Growth to Test Investors' Patience

GROWTH WOES Subdued revenue, deal momentum and tepid guidance may weigh despite improving margins

Ranjit Shinde

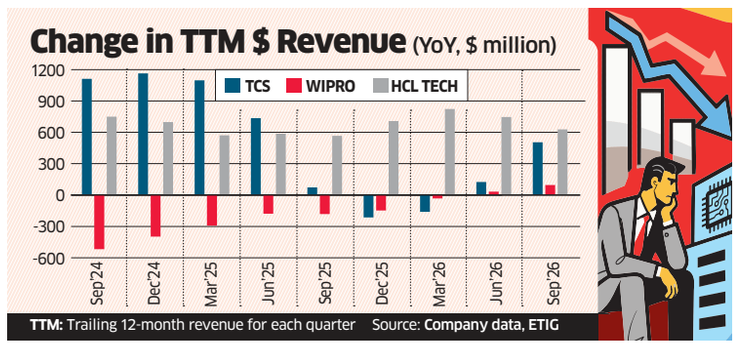
ET Intelligence Group: Wipro's September quarter performance was subdued on both financial and new-deal fronts.

The dollar-denominated revenue of the country's fourth-largest software exporter shrank for the second consecutive quarter while the total contract value (TCV) of new deals fell significantly quarter-on-quarter. In comparison, its larger peers Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) and HCL Technologies (HCLTech) reported sequential revenue growth of 0.2% and 2%, respectively, and showed sustained traction in order flows.

Earnings Review

Wipro expects deal momentum to pick up in the December quarter along with a gradual improvement in operating margin. While that augurs well for the medium term, the stock may remain range-bound in the short term given the slow pace of top-line improvement.

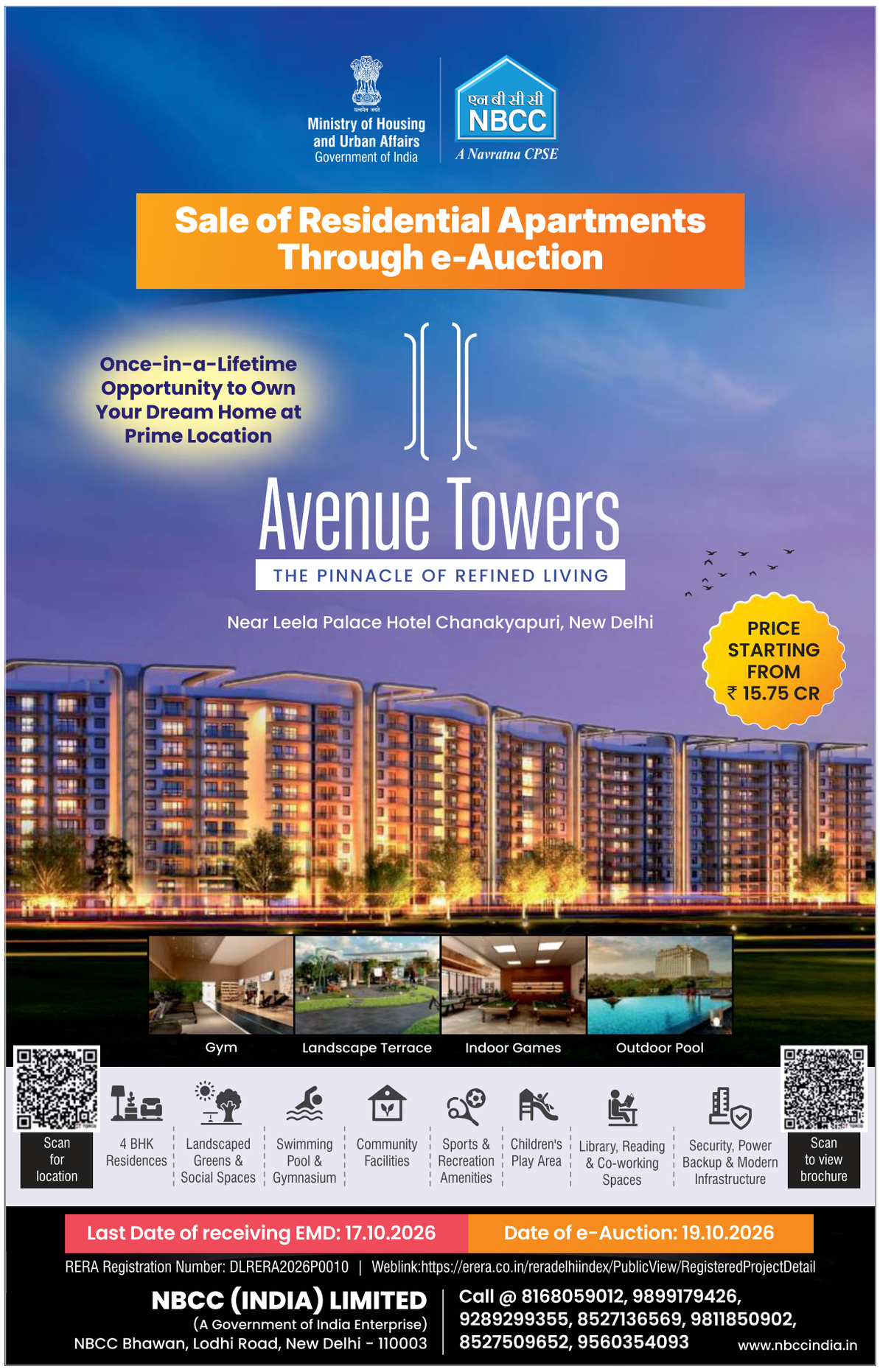
The management said at a media conference call that it did not notice any material change in the demand situation from the previous quarter, as reflected in its third-quarter guidance. It expects constant currency (CC) revenue for the December quarter to either fall by 1.5% or grow by a marginal 0.5% sequentially, a range similar to its guidance for the September quarter.



While the company's revenue continues to languish compared with that of its peers, the extent of the decline has been gradually narrowing. This is visible from the trend in incremental trailing 12-month (TTM) revenue. After turning positive in the June quarter at $32 million for the first time in 11 quarters, it further improved to $95 million in the three months to September. However, it remained tepid compared with the $505 million and $628.9 million reported by TCS and HCLTech. This reflects the degree of improvement needed for Wipro to post meaningful revenue growth. The company's TCV for new deals fell 23% sequentially to $2.6 billion in the September quarter due to delays in closing some deals. It expects these deals to close in the December quarter.

The operating margin improved by 50 basis points sequentially to 16.5% after hitting a multi-quarter low of 16% in the June quarter. Better operating efficiency, favourable rupee movement, and the absence of salary increments were the major factors supporting the margin. The company expects to improve margins further in the coming quarters, aiming to reach its target band of 17-17.5% over the medium term.

Wipro's stock has remained range-bound over the past three months since it declared the previous quarter's results on July 16. The stock trades at a multi-year low trailing price-earnings multiple of 13. Investors may have to wait a little longer for an improvement in valuation, given the slow pace of recovery in business momentum.



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CHANGE OF NAME

I, Abrar Dawood Khan Sarguroh R/o C-106, Saakaar (asn)chs Ltd, Kalyan Complex,off Yari Road,versova, Andheri West,mumbai-400061 have changed my minor daughter's name from Ayska Abrar Khan to Ayska Abrar Khan Sarguroh.

I, Malve Sandeep Prabhakar , S/o Prabhakar Malve, residing at A/11 Namdeep 90 Feet Road, Nath Pai Nagar, Ghatkopar East, Mumbai 400077, have changed my name from Malve Sandeep Prabhakar to Sandeep Prabhakar Malve as per Attached Gazzette copy dated 01.10.2026 for all legal purposes.

I, Chhavi Gupta, R/o 302, Raheja Majestic, Manmala Tank Road, Mahim West, Mumbai have changed my name from Laxmi Rani Agarwal to Chhavi Gupta for all purposes.

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WANTED BRIDES

WANTED GROOMS

WANTED BRIDES

BY CASTE

BRAHMIN

PQM4 BTech MBA (ISB)31yr5'10"Wking Gurugram, teetotaler non smoking handsome package .Send biodata to 7060884999

KAYASTHA

B.TECH+MBA Mathur boy Aug93/5'11'' Wkg MNC Bangalore 35 LPA. Seeks Prof. Qual. working girl. Cont. 9620251275.

30/5'10 B.TECH - IIT MBA-IIM Sr. Manager MNC 80 Lpa Father Govt. officer Caste No Bar. No dowry # 9340982702 , 8821995505

BY COMMUNITY

AGARWAL

PQM4 Singhal boy, Apr 95 born, 6', B.E. MS, working with Cognizant in Noida, 11LPA, own house, send details or call at #9412394357

GENERAL

CASTE NO BAR

ANIMESH Chakraborty, 28 yr, 5'10. S/W Er. at Mastercard, MS CS - LJMU. Need working and family oriented Bengali bride. Contact : 9893169663

LLM, NLU ,Punjab,July 94/5'11" Aspire to be judge,Punjab base. ready to shift if required, seeks Educated girl, 9876433929

BY LANGUAGE

PUNJABI

ALLIANCE invited from an affluent Business family for their fair handsome Punjabi Khatri Computer Engg (US) boy 31 years, 6'2", working in Mumbai. Seeking a well qualified girl from an affluent family. Mob.: 9152529148. Email: skcon23@gmail.com

ALLIANCE invited from an affluent Business family for their fair handsome Punjabi Khatri Computer Engg (US) boy 31 years, 6'2", working in Mumbai. Seeking a well qualified girl from an affluent family. Mob.: 9152529148. Email: skcon23@gmail.com

BY NATIONALITY

NRI/ GREEN CARD

ALLIANCE invited 4 Aggarwal boy 5'10", BTech+MS(USA), wrkg Hedge Fund on H1B. Born Aug 98. Affluent Delhi NCR family. Boy visiting India 1st week Nov. # 9711800247

WANTED GROOMS

BY PROFESSION

GENERAL

BUSINESS

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PUNE-BASED DIRECTOR, 32, 180 cm, Brahmin. From a financially well-off family. Looking for a like-minded bride with a strong academic background. Contact: 6366448351

MUMBAI-BASED DOCTOR, 32, 183 cm, Brahmin. Family is financially well settled. Hoping to meet a well-educated bride with a similar outlook. Contact: 6366448351

ELITE GROOMS WANTED

MUMBAI-BASED PROFESSIONAL, 31, 165 cm, Teli. From a financially well-off family. Looking for a like-minded, well-educated groom. Contact: 6366448351

KOLHAPUR-BASED PROFESSIONAL, 28, 168 cm, Lingayat. Comes from a well-off family. Hoping to meet a well-educated groom who shares her outlook. Contact: 6366448351

MUMBAI-BASED PILOT, 27, 163 cm, 96 Kuli Maratha. Family is financially well off. Seeking a like-minded, well-educated groom. Contact: 6366448351

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DOCTORS

SM4 doctor girl, Oct 98 born, ht. 5'8". Just completed MD Peads. from Mumbai. Father Class I, GOI. Looking for Hindu MD/MS boy, settled in Mumbai. Msg. on Whatsapp 7738929477.

BY COMMUNITY

RAJPUT

RAJPUT girl Jun 96 /5'3" working in MNC bank 24LPA. Settled at Zirakpur, father ex defence offr seeks prof qual match 90135 03233

JAT

ALLIANCE invited for a 27 years old Jat girl, working in London (Open to move to India / Anyother country), from a highly reputed business family. Seeking a suitable match: IAS/IFS / Business-class groom well-settled, educated & from a respected family background. Contact: Call/ whatsapp 9996060748

BY CASTE

BRAHMIN

SM4 Tamil Brahmin Iyer Girl, 37/5'6", CA, MBA, issueless div (short marr.), affluent family. Seeks well-edu/emp Boy, never marr/issueless div, 37-42 yrs from cultured, affluent family. Cont: 9043949107/ asalliancemail@gmail.com

BY NATIONALITY

NRI/ GREEN CARD

MS (US) NM Brhmn Sept'92/ 5'5"/ Wrkg & Settled Toronto, Parents-Delhi.seeks Qlfd.Boy Sttld in Canada, Upper Caste welcome. W'Ap: +14389888658

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SMART INVESTING

SC Deals a Heavy Blow to Yes Bank's Risk Equity Capital

Potential anchor bidders include BlackRock, Allianz, SBI MF, LIC, ICICI Pru Mutual Fund and HDFC Mutual Fund

Global Funds Queue up for Jio Mega Offer

Himadri Buch and Himanshi Lohchab

Mumbai: Jio Platforms has drawn interest from several global institutional investors, including sovereign wealth funds and leading asset managers such as Allianz and BlackRock, for the anchor book in its proposed ₹30,188-crore initial public offering (IPO) that is set to be the largest in India's history, people familiar with the matter told **ET**.

Investors that have shown interest in the anchor book include the Government of Singapore Investment Corporation (GIC), Fidelity, Norway's Government Pension Fund Global, New World Fund Inc and Smallcap World Fund Inc, besides those cited above, the people said.

Domestic investors, including SBI Mutual Fund, Life Insurance Corporation of India, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, HDFC Mutual Fund and Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund, are also among the potential bidders, they said. Emails sent to the lead bankers and to the company remained unanswered until the publication of this report.

270 MILLION
EQUITY SHARES TO BE OFFERED THROUGH FRESH ISSUANCE

The company has set a price band of ₹1,065-1,119 per share for the IPO. Investors will have to bid for a minimum of 12 shares and in multiples of 12 thereafter. Eligible employees applying under the employee reservation portion will receive a discount of ₹54 per share.

The IPO of Jio Platforms, the digital and telecom arm of Mukesh Ambani-led Reliance Industries, will surpass Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,859 crore offering in 2024, which currently holds the record for the country's biggest IPO. Last month, the National Stock Exchange launched a ₹22,562-crore IPO. The Jio Platforms issue will open for subscription on Oct 21 and close on Oct 23, while the anchor investor portion will open for bidding on Oct 19.

Continued on ▸▸ Smart Investing

CUSTOMERS, DATA, ARPU & MORE

Where Jio Stands Among Peers, in Charts

Jio Platforms is set for India's largest ever IPO, worth up to ₹30,213 crore. After listing, it is likely to enter the top five companies by market value. Its filings show Jio is India's biggest telecom network by customers and data use, but trails Bharti Airtel on revenue per user, margins and customer additions. Its broadband market share has recently slipped below the 50% mark. On the plus side, Jio's debt has fallen sharply. Tanay Sukumar and Anna Jijo look at the data.

Key Performance Metrics of Jio vs Listed Peers

	Jio Platforms	Bharti Airtel	Vodafone Idea
Total Customer Base (m, Jun 2026)	**533.3**	491.9	193.1
Net Customer Additions (m, FY26)	**36.2**	58	-5.4
ARPU (₹/mth)*	**215.6**	263.9	177
Monthly Customer Churn*# (%)	**1.6**	2.6	3.8
EBITDA Margin (%)	**53.3**	59.1	43.1
Per-customer Data Use* (GB/mth)	**43.7**	34.4	21.7

Data for Q1 FY27 unless mentioned otherwise.
*For only the mobile business in case of Airtel. #Customers who exited in a quarter as a share of average customer base in that quarter, divided by three.

Fact File

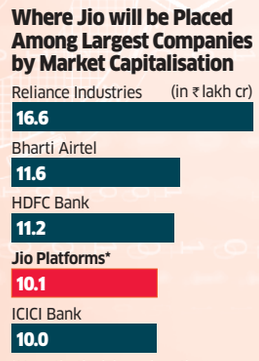
Jio's monthly churn rate rose from **1.5% (Q4 FY24)** to **1.8% (Q4 FY25) after tariff hikes**; has partly recovered

In a positive, net debt declined from **0.88 times EBITDA in FY24** to **0.36 times to FY26**

10 of 32 subsidiaries **were loss-making in FY26**

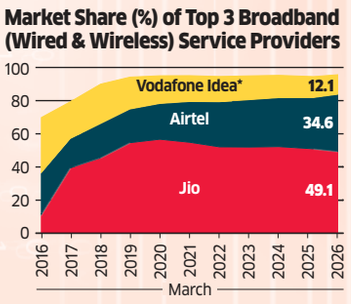
Deferred spectrum payment liabilities **now stand at ₹1.05 lakh cr (Jun 2026)**

Where Jio will be Placed Among Largest Companies by Market Capitalisation



*Hypothetical, based on the midpoint of the issue price range.

Market Share (%) of Top 3 Broadband (Wired & Wireless) Service Providers



All data for Mar 31, except FY25, which is for May 31, 2025 as data for Mar was not available. *Refers to the total for Vodafone & Idea till 2018. Historical data not strictly comparable due to a 2023 change in definition of broadband.

Source: Jio Platforms RHP, TRAI, ETintelligence.com

JIO PLATFORMS & WINDFALL GAINS

Early Investors See Holding's Value More Than Double

A clutch of shareholders in IPO-bound Jio Platforms, including Meta, Google, Saudi Arabia's Public Investment Fund, Vista Equity Partners, Silver Lake Partners and General Atlantic, have seen the value of their investments more than double over the past six years.

Meta-backed Jaadhu Holdings, which acquired a 9.98% stake in Jio Platforms for around ₹43,574 crore in 2020, now holds shares valued at around ₹99,846 crore at the IPO price. Google, which invested around ₹33,737 crore for a 7.73% stake, has seen the value of its holding rise to around ₹77,307 crore.

Here's a look at how these investors' holdings have appreciated since their initial investments in 2020. – **Ravindra Sonavane**

Top public shareholder returns in Jio Platforms

Top Investors	No of Shares Held (in cr)	% Stake	Purchase Price Approx. (₹/share)#	Purchase Value (₹ cr)#	Current Valuation (₹ cr)*	Absolute Returns (%)	6 Year CAGR (%)
Jaadhu Holdings	89.2	**10.0**	488	43,574	99,846	129	14.8
Google	69.1	**7.7**	488	33,738	77,307	129	14.8
The Public Investment Fund	20.7	**2.3**	549	11,367	23,156	104	12.6
Omicron Asia Holdings II	20.7	**2.3**	549	11,367	23,156	104	12.6
VEPF VII AIV I	20.7	**2.3**	549	11,367	23,156	104	12.6
SLP Redwood Holdings	16.8	**1.9**	549	9,255	18,854	104	12.6
MIC Redwood 1 RSC	16.6	**1.9**	549	9,094	18,525	104	12.6
General Atlantic Singapore JP	12.0	**1.3**	549	6,598	13,442	104	12.6
Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust	10.3	**1.2**	549	5,683	11,578	104	12.6

SOURCE: **RHP, ET Calculation**

Approx Calculation of Purchase Price Based on Deal Valuation in 2020.
*Current Valuation as per upper end of IPO price band of ₹1119/share

FERR NOT APPLICABLE TO CERTAIN DEALS

RBI Clears Air on Fx Risk Reserve Rules

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The central bank Thursday clarified that the new foreign exchange risk reserve (FERR) will not be applicable for banks undertaking trades for market-making or assuming proprietary positions.

Also, the FERR will not apply on interest on External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) or coupons on resident debt instruments held by non-residents, or dividends payable to non-resident investors, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said in FAQs published Thursday.

The clarifications bring relief to banks that were unsure of trading in the foreign exchange market after the RBI imposed a 20% cash reserve requirement on forex derivative contracts above $2 million. The RBI said that the FERR requirement applies only to derivative contracts where the user purchases foreign currency against rupee.

The FERR applicable for a particular derivative contract is required to be maintained until a day after the termination of the derivative contract. The FERR shall be deposited and maintained in the authorised dealer's current account with RBI on a daily basis. These funds maintained with the RBI shall not earn any interest and will not be classified as high quality liquid assets (HQLA).

RBI said the new FERR requirement will not apply to foreign exchange derivative contracts undertaken by users for hedging capital account transactions like foreign direct investments, ECBs or issuance or transfer of equity shares.

FERR is applicable for authorised dealers with notional value exceeding $2 million but banks must guard against any attempt towards structuring of derivative transactions for avoidance of these provisions, RBI said.

CAD Narrows to $5.2 b in August, BoP in Surplus

Kolkata: India's current account deficit (CAD) narrowed to $5.2 billion in August from $6.1 billion a year ago, while the country recorded a $50.6 billion surplus in capital account against $0.5 billion in the same period last year, RBI data published on Thursday showed.

The overall balance of payments, resultantly, stood at a surplus of $45.4 billion in August against a $5.6 billion deficit in the same month in 2025.

The dedicated dollar mobilisation programme run by the central bank led to an accumulation of non-resident deposits of $83 billion in August, helping the country log this massive capital account surplus. However, $22.4 billion net outflows in external commercial borrowing limited the capital account gains.The CAD, meanwhile, shrank due to a narrowing merchandise deficit and widening services surplus, RBI data showed.

The overall balance of payments stood at a surplus of $45.4 b in Aug vs $5.6 b deficit last yr

The balance of payments surplus stood at $58 billion for the first five months of the financial year against a $0.8 billion deficit in the year-ago period.

The CAD, however, widened for the five-month period at $18.3 billion against $12.8 billion in the year-ago months. - **Our Bureau**

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Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results for the Quarter/Half Year Ended 30th September, 2026 (₹ in Lakh)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations (net)	817408	742139	1685632	1485460	2974098
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	106469	102506	363962	197126	437349
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	78564	61976	144197	122720	276786
5.	Total Comprehensive income for the period (comprising Profit/Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)	Please Refer Note No. 2				
6.	Paid Up Equity Share Capital	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956	1253956
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	1756007	1541844	1756007	1541844	1756007
8.	Securities Premium Account	504211	504211	504211	504211	504211
9.	Net Worth	2788109	2301266	2788109	2301266	2446221
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	0.08	0.09	0.08	0.09	0.09
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	0.75	0.66	0.75	0.66	0.70
12.	Earning Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
	1. Basic :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
	2. Diluted :	0.63	0.49	1.15	0.98	2.21
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	Not Applicable				
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve					

Notes : 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly/ half-yearly financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under regulation 33 and 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly/half yearly Financial Result are available on the Stock Exchange websites. (BSE : **www.bseindia.com** and NSE : **www.nseindia.com**), Bank's website (**www.uco.bank.in/Investors**)
2. Information relating to total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the bank.

For UCO Bank

Place : Kolkata
Dated : 15th October, 2026

Sd/- Vijaykumar Nivrutti Kamble, Executive Director
Sd/- Rajendra Kumar Saboo, MD & CEO (I/C) and Executive Director
Sd/- Aravamudan Krishna Kumar, Non-Executive Chairman

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(INR Million)	Q2 FY27	Q2 FY26	Growth
Revenue	98,989	64,772	53%
Profit After Tax	9,900	6,930	43%

This is an unabridged representation of the unaudited financial consolidated results for the quarter ended 30th September 2026 and is not for the purpose of legal compliance. For full results, visit www.polycab.com or scan the QR code.

PRODUCT MIX EXPANDS

HDFC Life Posts 14% Rise in Sept Qtr Profit

Our Bureau

Mumbai: HDFC Life Insurance reported a 14% increase in standalone net profit to ₹508 crore for the September quarter, compared with ₹447 crore a year earlier, as premium income rose and the insurer expanded sales of non-participating (non-par) savings, annuity and protection products.

Net premium income increased 16% to ₹21,727 crore from ₹18,777 crore in the corresponding quarter last year.

Value of new business (VNB) margin expanded 20 basis points to 24.7% against 24.5% a year ago. One basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point. Value of new business grew 12% to ₹2,040 crore.

Value of new business (VNB) margin expanded 20 basis points to 24.7% against 24.5% a year ago

The insurer's solvency ratio improved to 180% from 175% a year earlier, although it declined from 185% at the end of June. HDFC Life's board approved raising up to ₹500 crore through subordinated non-convertible debentures. Its total expenses to total premium increased to 22.3% from 21.6% in the first half of the financial year.

The company said the proposed overhaul of insurance distribution and commission rules could disrupt sales channels in the near term, with brokers and wholesale distribution likely to face the greatest impact. The company expects it to be implemented by April 1, 2027.

"Like with any material change, there will be disruption, but I remain extremely optimistic that once the disruption is digested by all market participants and the new norms emerge, we will be in a position stronger than today," Vibha Padalkar, MD and CEO, HDFC Life, said in an earnings call.

REVERSAL OF BOND WRITE-DOWN Lender's Common Equity Tier-1 to shrink by 230-300 bps

SC Ruling Deals a Heavy Blow to Yes Bank's Risk Equity Capital

Saloni Shukla

Mumbai: Yes Bank, in which Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp (SMBC) has a controlling stake, faces a hit to its loss-absorbing capital buffer—or, Common Equity Tier-1 (CET1)—as Thursday's Supreme Court verdict reversing the write-down of more than $800 million of additional Tier-1, or AT-1, bonds punches a hole in its core cash pile.

The court verdict in favour of AT1 bondholders, who collectively contributed ₹8,415-crore to the high-risk quasi-equity instruments, is expected to dent the lender's equity capital by 230-300 basis points, rating agencies and analysts said.

One basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point.

AT1 bonds were under the lens after the administered takeover of Credit Suisse by UBS Group three years ago involved the writedown of nearly $17 billion of such instruments, triggering lawsuits in multiple geographies.

Crisil Ratings had estimated that a complete write-back of AT-1 bonds could reduce Yes Bank's CET1 by about 230-250 basis points, while Icra estimated an impact of around 255 basis points. CareEdge Ratings had pegged the potential reduction at 250-300 basis points.

The impact could pull Yes Bank's CET1 ratio down to around 11-11.5%, from 14% at the end of June, placing it at the lower end of core capital ratios among major Indian banks. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) requires banks to maintain a minimum CET1 ratio of 5.5% of risk-weighted assets, apart from a 2.5% capital conservation buffer.

In an exchange filing Yes Bank said it is in the process of examining the final order copy of the judgment, and its implications.

CET1 is a bank's highest-quality capital, consisting primarily of equity and retained earnings, and acts as the first buffer against unexpected losses. A sharp reduction in CET1 can therefore limit the amount of balance-sheet growth a bank can support without raising additional equity.

People familiar with Yes Bank's capital planning said the lender had built buffers factoring in an adverse outcome in the AT1 litigation, including a worst-case scenario. The eventual impact, however, will depend on the way the judgment is implemented and the accounting treatment adopted.

The apex court on Thursday dismissed appeals filed by Yes Bank, the Reserve Bank of India and the government against the Bombay High Court judgment that had set aside the March 2020 write-down. The two affected AT1 issuances comprised ₹3,000 crore of bonds issued in December 2016 carrying a 9.5% coupon and another ₹5,415 crore issued in October 2017 carrying a 9% coupon.

Importantly, the judgment does not direct an immediate cash repayment of ₹8,415 crore, nor does it quantify any liability for accumulated past coupons. The court separately said annual coupon payments would remain unaffected by the outcome of the appeals and must be made in accordance with the bonds' information kit.

This leaves the eventual financial impact dependent on whether the bonds are reinstated, settled in cash or dealt with through another mechanism, as well as the accounting treatment adopted.

Following the verdict analysts estimated that Yes Bank's net worth could decline 16.5% under a principal-only scenario. A more severe scenario incorporating principal and accrued coupons estimated the potential liability at around ₹13,770 crore, resulting in a larger hit to capital.

Back on the Books

SC UPHOLDS ruling against Yes Bank's AT1 bond write-off

₹8,415 cr of AT1 bonds written off in March 2020

No immediate cash repayment of **₹8,415 cr** ordered

CET1 ratio may fall from 14% to 11–11.5%

Principal-only scenario points to **16.5%** net-worth decline

Principal plus accrued coupons could take potential liability to **₹13,770 cr**

Kotak MF Pauses Yes AT1 Schemes

New Delhi: Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company (AMC) has temporarily suspended subscriptions in two debt mutual fund schemes holding Yes Bank's Additional Tier 1 (AT1) bonds, as a precautionary measure to safeguard investors' interests. - **PTI**

Tech Picks | AMOL ATHAWALE, VP-Technical Research | Kotak Neo

JINDALSTEL — BUY TARGET ₹1,070

The stock is in accumulation mode near support zone; bullish activity indicating a fresh upmove.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹1,030 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹1,010

M&M — BUY TARGET ₹2,970

Rounding bottom chart formation on daily charts suggest stock is gaining traction for a uptrend.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹2,862 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹2,805

BAJAJFINSV — BUY TARGET ₹1,800

The stock is oversold near its demand zone, signalling a potential reversal and fresh uptrend.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹1,732 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹1,695

F&O Strategy | SAHAJ AGRAWAL, VP Derivatives Research

NSEFUT BHARTIARTL (OCT) — BUY TARGET ₹1,950

A higher-bottom formation, with a strong bullish candle signalling continued short-term uptrend.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹1,852.6 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹1,790

NSEFUT EICHERMOT (OCT) — BUY TARGET ₹7,630

Rebound above the 20-day EMA signals improving momentum and potential recovery continuation.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹7,248 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹6,995

DISCUSSIONS ON Stakeholders have time until October 25 to provide feedback

Insurers Seek Tweaks, Time to Conform to Commission Reforms

Our Bureau

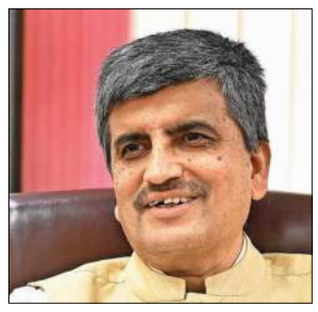
Mumbai: Insurers and insurance distributors have sought a longer transition period, safeguards for smaller players and clarity on the treatment of low-ticket policies in response to the industry regulator's proposed commission and expense reforms, **Irdai chairman Ajay Seth** said.

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) is engaging with different stakeholder groups and has not reached a conclusion on the proposals, Seth said.

The objective is to move toward a more efficient regime without disrupting existing businesses or livelihoods. "Some stakeholders have sought a longer transition period, while others have raised concerns about low-ticket policies," Seth said while speaking on the sidelines of the SamvAAd 2026 event.

Stakeholders have until Oct 25 to provide feedback, which varies across the industry.

Larger insurers, smaller companies and new entrants have different concerns, Seth said. Similar differences exist among the various categories of insurance distributors, he said.



The regulator is seeking comments supported by business and economic reasoning, particularly on how the proposed changes would benefit policyholders. Seth said each suggestion would be carefully considered before the regulator decides on the way forward.

The consultation paper will be followed by a draft regulation and another round of public consultation, allowing stakeholders to provide further feedback. Seth said it was too early to estimate when the draft would be ready, given the need to examine the submissions and determine an orderly transition from the existing framework.

RISK FACTOR Financials are sound, but co imports 30% of its inputs

Bonfiglioli is a Jack of Many Trades; Currency a Concern

Snehal Mergu

ET Intelligence Group: Bonfiglioli Transmissions, a high-precision gearboxes and drive systems manufacturer, plans to raise Rs2,534 crore through an offer for sale. The promoter group's stake will fall to 77% after the IPO from 100%. The company has market leadership across segments. The operating margin before depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda margin) consistently expanded between the year ended December 2023 and six-month period ended in June 2026. Nearly 30% of the raw material is sourced from overseas, which exposes the company to currency fluctuations. Given these factors, investors with high-risk appetite may consider the IPO.

BUSINESS

Incorporated in 1998, Bonfiglioli Transmissions manufactures mission-critical and highly precision engineered geared motors, gearboxes and drive systems. It caters to industrial automation, construction, mining, material handling, and pharmaceuticals among other sectors. The company's promoter, Bonfiglioli S.p.A. is headquartered in Italy. Its three major verticals including industry and automation solutions, off-highway mobility and wind industry contribute 41%, 25% and 32% to revenue respectively. It operates three manufacturing facilities—two in Tamil Nadu and one in Maharashtra. According to a Frost & Sullivan, the company has 67.9% market share among domestic manufacturers of yaw and pitch drives for wind turbines in 2025. The company pays a royalty of around 4% of revenue to its promoter group for the use of intellectual property including the 'Bonfiglioli' brand.

FINANCIALS

Revenue from operations increased 9.2% annually to ₹2,013.5 crore between 2023 and 2025. Net profit increased 27.4% annually to ₹237.9 crore in 2025. In the six months ended June 2026, revenue and net profit jumped 17.9% and 29.2% year-on-year respectively.

VALUATION

The company has no comparable listed peer. Considering the post-IPO equity and 2025 net profit, its price-earnings (P/E) multiple works out to be 46. On the basis of annualised 2026 net profit, the P/E is 37. Other gearbox, bearings and power transmission companies such as Elecon Engineering, Timken India and Shanthi Gears trade at P/E multiples of 32 to 53, while their annualised FY27 P/E multiples range from 39 to 104.

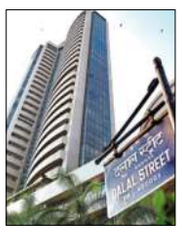
IPO WATCH

Ready for a Ride?

- IPO dates: **Oct 15-19, 2026**
- IPO price: **₹558-586**
- Issue size: **Upto ₹2,534 crore**
- Implied market cap: **Upto ₹11,017 crore**
- Face value: **₹10**
- Lot size: **25 shares**
- Retail portion: **35%**

D-St Dairy

HD Fire Protect IPO Subscribed 132 Times



MUMBAI HD Fire Protect's ₹712.13 crore initial public offering (IPO) was subscribed 131.73 times on the final day of bidding on Thursday. The Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIB) portion was subscribed 256.65 times, while the non-institutional investors (NII) segment was subscribed 203.21 times. The retail portion was subscribed 30.55 times.

Paras Health Sets IPO Band at ₹660-693

Paras Healthcare, which operates hospitals under the Paras Health brand, has fixed a price band of ₹660-693 per share for its ₹1,450-crore initial public offering (IPO). The IPO will remain open for subscription from October 21-23. The IPO comprises a fresh issue of equity shares worth ₹500 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) of shares worth ₹950 crore by existing shareholders.

THE MORNING BRIEF PODCAST

Anirban Chowdhury talks to Sugata Ghosh about the RBI's urgent defence of the rupee and why the rebound may conceal deeper trouble.

Available on EconomicTimes.com/podcast, Amazon Prime Music, Apple Podcasts, JioSaavn and Spotify.

Higher NII, better asset quality lift show of Indian Bank, UCO, South Indian & Karur Vysya

Banks Defy Treasury Drag, Clock Double Digit Profit Growth in July-Sept Quarter

Our Bureaus

Kolkata | Mumbai: Banks that have announced quarterly earnings so far showed double digit net profit growth in the July-September quarter riding on core income, although treasury earnings remained subdued due to marked-to-market losses amid surging bond yields.

INDIA BANK

The state-owned Indian Bank reported a 14.7% year-on-year (YoY) rise in second quarter profit at ₹3,462 crore against ₹3,018 crore in the year ago period. Its operating profit stood 46.7% higher at ₹7,090 crore against ₹4,837 crore in the same period last year.

It has increased its provisions to ₹2,222 crore from ₹739 crore, despite asset quality improvement, as it looks to build a buffer ahead of the transition to the credit loss framework, which will be implemented from April 1, 2027. It set aside ₹1,500 crore this quarter, taking the total buffer to ₹2,500 crore while the expected impact would be ₹3,500 crore, managing director Binod Kumar said.

The bank's gross non-performing assets ratio improved to 1.16% at the end of September from 2.6% a year prior. Indian Bank booked ₹123 crore mark-to-market (MTM) losses but its treasury income stood higher on account of the one-off gain from the divestment in NSE.

UCO BANK

UCO Bank reported a 27% YoY increase in net profit at ₹786 crore in the quarter ended September 2026 against ₹620 crore a year ago led by strong loan growth and an improvement in net interest margin. Total advances increased 25% to ₹2.9 lakh crore led by a 27% growth in advances to the retail, agriculture and MSME sectors.

Retail was the fastest growing segment with a growth of 30%. Net interest margins improved 10 basis points YoY to 3% during the quarter. Net interest income increased 14% YoY at ₹2,886 crore supporting profits. Its gross NPA declined 60 basis points YoY to nearly 2%. The bank garnered $635 million through FCNR (B) deposits, CEO Rajendra Kumar Saboo said. The bank's treasury earnings for the second quarter came 72% lower at ₹29 crore.

SOUTH INDIAN BANK

Private sector South Indian Bank posted a 21% rise in second quarter net profit at ₹426 crore as compared with ₹351 crore in the year ago period. Its operating profit stood 37% higher at ₹732 crore against ₹536 crore. The bank's treasury and forex earnings fell 38% at ₹80 crore in the quarter against ₹129 crore in the year ago period, capping the overall earnings growth. Its gross advances grew 19% YoY to ₹1.10 lakh crore at the end of September with the gold loan portfolio expanding 41% to ₹26,603 crore. The bank's asset quality improved with gross non-performing assets ratio declining to 1.2% at the end of September from 2.9% a year prior.

KARUR VYSYA BANK

Karur Vysya Bank reported a 37% YoY growth in net profit at ₹788 crore in the quarter ended September 2026 from ₹574 crore a year ago due to strong loan growth while asset quality remained stable. Total advances increased 20% to ₹1.1 lakh crore. Net interest income increased by 18% to ₹1,497 crore from ₹1,261 crore. Net interest margin at 4.3% was higher than the 4.2% reported for the corresponding quarter of the previous year. The cost of deposits has decreased by 11 basis points to 5.5%. Gross non-performing assets (GNPA) decreased by 7 bps to 0.7% of gross advances as on September 30, 2026 from 0.8% as on September 30, 2025.

Lenders' Leap

Q2 Net Profit & YoY Growth at 4 Banks

	Q2 Net Profit (₹cr)	Growth (%)
Indian Bank	3,462	15
Karur Vysya Bank	788	37
South Indian Bank	426	21
Uco Bank	786	27

Q2 Scorecard

Jio Fin Net Down Despite Jio Credit Show

MUMBAI Jio Financial Services consolidated net profit fell 51% year-on-year (YoY) to ₹340 crore in the quarter ended September 2026, from ₹695 crore a year earlier, even as its lending subsidiary Jio Credit posted strong growth in its loan book and profit. Consolidated total income rose 70% to ₹1,699 crore from ₹1,002 crore a year earlier. Jio Credit's profit after tax rose 140% YoY to ₹120 crore, while net interest income increased 116% to ₹302 crore. Its gross assets under management rose 154% to ₹37,320 crore, while gross disbursements during the quarter nearly doubled to ₹13,135 crore. Its average cost of borrowing stood at 7.1%, while shareholders' equity was ₹7,379 crore at the end of September. The lender's portfolio comprised mortgages, including home loans and loans against property, at 44.5%, retail loans against securities at 11.3%, and corporate and SME loans at 44.2%. Bank of America is set to acquire up to 49.9% in Jio Credit through an investment of up to ₹18,268 crore, subject to regulatory and statutory approvals.

L&T Finance Net Surges 33% to ₹975 crore

MUMBAI L&T Finance reported a 33% YoY rise in consolidated net profit to ₹975 crore for the quarter ended September 30, 2026, compared with ₹735 crore in the year-ago period. Its consolidated loan book stood at ₹1.4 lakh crore, up 28% YoY. Speaking to **ET**, Sudipta Roy, MD & CEO of L&T Finance, said he expects AUM growth momentum of around 20% to continue in the third quarter. Net interest margin (NIM), or the difference between interest earned and interest paid, rose to 10.5% from 10.2% a year ago. "L&T Finance will maintain NIM in the 10-10.5% band in the Q3 and does not expect any meaningful change in the lending rates offered by banks to us," Roy said.

IIFL Finance PAT Nearly Doubles to ₹805 cr

MUMBAI IIFL Finance reported a 93% rise in profit after tax to ₹805 crore for the quarter ended September 30, helped by stronger operating leverage and lower loan losses and provisions. It reported net profit of ₹417.9 crore in corresponding quarter last year. Assets under management rose 38% YoY to ₹1.2 lakh crore, driven largely by strong growth in gold loans. Gold loans remained the main growth engine. Gold-loan AUM surged 90% YoY and 13% sequentially to ₹65,729 crore, with gross NPA at 0.9%. Home-finance AUM stood at ₹43,070 crore, up 11% QoQ to ₹11,948 crore. – **Our Bureau**

Rupee Gains 10 paise, Forward Premium Hits Four-Year High

Our Bureau

Kolkata: The rupee ended 10 paise stronger at 95.05 a dollar Thursday while forward premiums surged to more than a four-year high in a shallow market. The one-year forward premium closed at 4.5%, its highest level since January 2022, while some quotes were seen as high as 10%, traders said.

"The market turned completely illiquid as the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) stern measures forced importers to go on the sidelines," a treasury head with a private sector lender said.

The one-month forward premium closed as high as 8% with the 6-month rate ending at 6%. "It's an irrational market now. People were seen quoting abrupt levels," another person said.

Demand for Bank Loans Rises amid Hardening Yields

Canara Bank and Indian Bank together have ₹1.10 lakh cr of corporate loan pipeline; momentum may sustain

Atmadip Ray

Kolkata: Canara Bank and Indian Bank have ₹1.10 lakh crore of corporate loan pipeline between them, reflecting steady credit demand from India Inc amid rising bond yields that have made bank borrowing more attractive.

Indian yields, now at their highest in more than three years, have risen in tandem with US yields.

Separately, the pipeline for Indian Bank stood at ₹63,000 crore and for Canara Bank ₹47,000 crore.

India's bond yield hardened 44 basis points in the second quarter, prompting companies to seek bank funding more instead of market-linked resources mobilisation.

Canara Bank said that the corporate advances, along with festive demand from individuals, will help it maintain credit growth around 19% while Indian Bank plans to go a little slow at 14-15% rate.

"We expect the momentum to sustain while we are targeting to improve the deposit growth so that the credit-deposit gap narrows," Canara Bank managing director Brajesh Kumar Singh said.

Indian Bank managing director Binod Kumar also underscored the need to reduce the gap. "We are looking at 14-15% credit growth. Making profits will be the main driver behind growth," he said.

Indian Bank reported a 16.4% year-on-year credit growth led by strong traction in retail, agriculture and MSME portfolios.

The bank has a pool of ₹30,000 crore of sanctioned corporate loans, ₹10,000 crore of loans with in-principle approval and ₹23,000 crore worth of proposals are under review, Kumar said.

For Canara, the sanctioned pool is worth ₹30,000 crore while ₹17,000 crore of loans are being examined.

Canara's 19.5% year-on-year credit growth was supported by $3.2 billion (about ₹34,000 crore) lent to overseas Indians in an FCNR-B leverage strategy that allowed non-resident to borrow from banks operating in India and park a larger amount in foreign currency non-resident-bank (FCNR-B) accounts.

The bank mobilised $5.8 billion of FCNR-B deposits using the Reserve Bank of India's dedicated window aimed to boost dollar inflows and the country's foreign exchange reserves.

Funds Queue up for Jio Offer

▸▸ From ET Markets Page 1

The IPO comprises a fresh issue of up to 270 million equity shares, with no offer-for-sale (OFS) component. The company has reserved shares worth up to ₹2,500 crore for eligible RIL shareholders and up to ₹500 crore for eligible employees. Individuals and Hindu Undivided Families holding public shares of Reliance Industries as of October 14 will be eligible to apply under the shareholder reservation, subject to the conditions specified in the prospectus and applicable regulations. The employee reservation is for eligible Jio Platforms employees. The two categories together account for reservations worth up to ₹3,000 crore.

Jio Platforms plans to use a part of the IPO proceeds to prepay up to ₹27,500 crore of borrowings at its operating subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm. The remaining proceeds will be used for general corporate purposes.

Maharashtra FDA Bans Sale of Loose Spices

FDA commissioner says use of artificial colours in spices will lead to prosecution, licence cancellation

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has banned the sale of loose spices to prevent adulteration.

Tukaram Mundhe, the FDA commissioner, on Thursday said cancer-causing industrial dyes such as Sudan dye, Metanil Yellow and lead chromate were found in spice samples taken from sellers in the state.

"These are known carcinogens; action will also be taken against those who try to boost the volume of the spices by adding sawdust, artificial starch and other substances like powder derived from bricks," Mundhe said.

Mundhe said the use of artificial colours and chemicals in spices would not be permitted. Manufacturers found violating the directives would face prosecution and risk losing their manufacturing licences.

The FDA will also inspect the premises of the units where the manufacturing is supposed to take place, he warned, adding that the state will no longer allow spices to be dried on roads, near drains or any other unhygienic places. Even the storage of these spices will be regulated, Mundhe said.

Mundhe also said that action will be taken if it is found that artificial colours and chemicals are stored in the same place as the spices.

'HEALTH ENDANGERED'

"There have been several instances where citizens' health has been endangered due to the use of artificial colours and dyes in spices. To ensure that citizens' health is not put at risk, we are today issuing a comprehensive compliance order," the FDA commissioner said. "You cannot use artificial colours, sub-standard raw materials or reuse the by-products. From production to sale, everything would be regulated."

According to Mundhe, manufacturers must ensure that the packaging mentions the details of the company, the manufacturing date, the batch number, and the best-before dates.

NOT 'MISGUIDE' CONSUMERS

Manufacturers also are not permitted to "misguide" consumers. So advertisements in any manner without evidence on the purity of the product, its organic production, or its health benefits will not be accepted, according to Mundhe, who, as an example, said that "100 per cent pure or 100 per cent natural" would not be permitted.

Govt Invites Views on Coal Exchange

New Delhi: The coal ministry on Thursday invited stakeholder comments on two applications received from subsidiaries of Indian Energy Exchange (IEX) and Multi Commodity Exchange of India (MCX) to set up coal exchanges in the country.

The Coal Controller Organisation received applications from Indian Coal Exchange and MCX Coal Exchange of India for registration under the Coal Exchange Rules, 2026, according to two separate notices issued on Thursday.

Stakeholders need to submit views on the applications by November 14.

Indian Coal Exchange, incorporated in June, is a wholly owned subsidiary of IEX. MCX Coal Exchange of India, which was also started in June, is a subsidiary of MCX. —**Our Bureau**

RBL BANK LTD.

RBL BANK apno ka bank (Subsidiary of Emirates NBD Bank P.J.S.C.)

Registered Office: Shahupuri, Kolhapur, Maharashtra - 416001, India CIN: L65191PN1943PLC007308

EOI NOTICE

INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST ("EOI") FOR SALE OF LISTED, RATED, SECURED 10% REDEEMABLE NON-CONVERTIBLE DEBENTURES OF SHRISTI INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED, BY WAY OF SWISS CHALLENGE METHOD

RBL Bank Limited **("Bank")** invites Expressions of Interest from eligible investors for purchase of, Listed, Rated, Secured, 10 % Redeemable Non-Convertible Debentures **("NCDs")** of face value aggregating ₹ 145,00,00,000 (Rupees One Hundred Forty-Five Crore only), issued by Shristi Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited **("SIDCL"/ "Issuer")** and presently held by the Bank **("Proposed Transaction").** The NCDs carry a coupon of 10% p.a. and are due for redemption on November 30, 2026.

The Bank proposes to divest its entire holding in the NCDs by way of a transparent, competitive bidding process incorporating the Swiss Challenge Method, on the terms set out in the detailed Process Document / Terms and Conditions available at https://www.rbl.bank.in/news **("Process Document").** Interested parties must review the Process Document in full before participating.

There is **no floor/reserve price** disclosed for this sale.

Last date for submission of EOI: October 26, 2026, up to 6:00 p.m. IST Email: Anil.dalmia@rbl.bank.in ; Ratnesh.shukla@rbl.bank.in **Address:** RBL Bank Limited, 20th Floor, One world Center, Tower 2-B, 20th Floor, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai 400013 Contact Person: Anil Kumar Dalmia – 9819226840; Ratnesh Shukla – 83691 08176

This notice does not constitute an offer or invitation to sell securities to the public and is merely an invitation to submit non-binding Expressions of Interest. The Bank reserves the right, in its sole and absolute discretion, to modify, suspend, cancel, or withdraw this process, or to accept or reject any or all EOIs/Bids, at any stage, without assigning any reason and without incurring any liability whatsoever. Participation in this process is entirely at the cost and risk of the interested party.

GOVERNMENT OF WEST BENGAL

PWD TENDER NOTICE

e-N.I.B. No. 03 of 2026-2027 of The Superintending Engineer & Project Director, Project Implementation Unit-I, circulated vide This office Memo No. 326-R/PIU-I, Dated. 14.10.2026 for the work "Consultancy Services for preparation of Techno Economic Feasibility Report (TEFR) and Bid Documents (RFP and CA etc.) for development of Ropeway from Kurseong to Darjeeling connecting Sonada and Ghoom in the state of West Bengal under Public Works Directorate." Tender ID : 2026_WBPWD_5080250_1. Pre Bid Meeting : 28.10.2026 at 13.00 Hrs. Start Date & Time of Submission of Bid:03.11.2026 at 15.00Hrs. Bid submission closing date : 18.11.2026 upto15.00 Hrs. Date of Opening of Technical Bid : 20.11.2026 after 15.00 Hrs. Details of N.I.T. and Tender documents may be downloaded from : http://tenders.wb.gov.in Sd/- SE & PD, PIU-I, PWRD, GOVT OF WB.

ICA- T19169(3)/2026

4001/371/2627

GRIDCO LIMITED

GRIDCO Empowering Odisha

(A Govt. of Odisha Undertaking)

Regd. Office : Janpath, Bhubaneswar-751022, ODISHA

E-Tender Notice

E-Tender Notice No. GRIDCO/RE NODAL AGENCY/ E-TENDER/04/2026-27 Date- 16.10.2026

GRIDCO Ltd. being the Nodal Agency for implementing the Odisha Renewal Energy Policy-2022 in the state of Odisha, invites bids in e-Tender mode only from reputed and eligible bidders for "Consultancy Services for Environmental and Social Impact Assessment for the 225 MW Upper Indravati Floating Solar and Battery Energy Storage System Project, including evacuation infrastructure and associated transmission lines, Odisha" confirming to the terms and conditions mentioned in the tender document.

The interested bidders would be required to enrol themselves on the e-tender portal **www.bharat-electronictender.com**. Complete set of bidding documents are available at the tender portal, **www.bharat-electronictender.com** or GRIDCO website: **www.gridco.co.in/ www.greenenergyinvest.odisha.gov.in** for downloading the scope of supply and terms and conditions in detail.

Start date of the bid- **16.10.2026**

Date of pre bid meeting- **30/10/2026 at 11.00 AM, GRIDCO Conference Hall/ VC**

Last date for Online submission of bid- **17/11/2026, at 15:00**.

The due date & time of opening of techno-commercial bid- **17/11/2026, at 17:00.**

Sd/-

Chief Project Manager, RE Nodal Agency

OIPR-4001/4056/1/26-27/0025

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR.

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 417/2026-27

निम्नलिखित कार्य के लिए केन्द्र / राज्य सरकार के अधिर्यांत्रिकी विभागों एवं उनके अधिकृत संगठनों में पंजीकृत एवं अनुभवी संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं :-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रू.)
Construction of Mahatma Gandhi Govt. School at Pratap Nagar, Sector-8, Sanganer, Jaipur. **UBN: RRC2627WSOB00691**	**326.61 Lakh**

निविदा से सम्बंधित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in** तथा **http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc** पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है। **महाप्रबंधक**

SBI

Transaction Banking Solutions Department, Corporate Centre, 21st floor, Maker Tower E-Wing, Cuffe Parade, Mumbai-400 005

E-mail – dgmprojects.tbs@sbi.co.in, **Website:** https://sbi.bank.in

CORRIGENDUM NOTICE

RFP No. SBI/TB-S/MLFF/2026-27/001 Date: 05.10.2026

Please refer the Corrigendum for RFP No. SBI/TB-S/MLFF/2026-27/001 dated 05.10.2026 available under procurement news at **https://sbi.bank.in/**, and e-Procurement agency portal **https://etender.sbi/**.

Place : Mumbai **Deputy General Manager (Projects)**

Date : 16.10.2026 **Transaction Banking Solutions Department**

BLISS GVS PHARMA LIMITED

Corporate Identity Number (CIN): L24230MH1984PLC034771

Registered Office: 102, Hyde Park, Saki Vihar Road, Saki Naka, Andheri (East), Mumbai - 400 072.

Tel: 022-42160000 | **Website:** www.blissgvs.com | **E-mail:** info@blissgvs.com / cs@blissgvs.com

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that the resolution set out below is proposed to be passed by the members of **Bliss GVS Pharma Limited ("the Company")** by means of the Postal Ballot, only by way of remote e-voting process **("remote e-voting"),** pursuant to the provisions of Section 110 read with Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 **('the Act')** and Rule 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 **("the Rules")** and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Act and the Rules,(including any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof for the time being in force and as amended from time to time) read with General Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard and latest being General Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs **("MCA Circulars"),** Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 **("SEBI Listing Regulations"),** Secretarial Standard on General Meetings **("SS2")** issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India and other applicable laws, rules and regulations (including any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof for the time being in force and as amended from time to time), to seek your consent in respect of special businesses as specified in the Postal Ballot Notice **("Notice")**(along with the explanatory statement thereto).

Sr. No.	Description	Type of resolution
1.	Appointment of Mr. Hetul Krishnakant Mehta (DIN:01650314) as a Director in the capacity of Non-Executive Non-Independent Director of the Company.	Ordinary Resolution
2.	Appointment of Mr. Amar Dilip Shah (DIN:00214357) as a Director in the capacity of Non-Executive Non-Independent Director of the Company.	Ordinary Resolution
3.	Appointment of Mr. Pramod Badrinarayan Kasat (DIN:00819790) as a Director in the capacity of Non-Executive Non-Independent Director of the Company.	Ordinary Resolution

In terms of the MCA Circulars, the Company has completed the dispatch of the Postal Ballot Notice along with the explanatory statement, to those members of the Company whose names appear on the Register of Members/List of Beneficial Owner as on **Friday, October 09, 2026 ("Cut-off Date"),** electronically through email on the email addresses that are registered with the Depositories/their Depository Participant/the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, "MUFG Intime India Private Limited"(Formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited)/the Company. The voting rights shall be reckoned on the paid-up value of equity shares registered in the name of members as on the cut-off date.

A person who is not a member on the cut–off date should accordingly treat the Postal Ballot Notice as for information purposes only.

The Company has also uploaded the Postal Ballot Notice on the website of the Company at www.blissgvs.com.The Postal Ballot Notice is also available on the website of Central Depository Securities Limited ("CDSL") at https://www.cdslindia.com/ and on the website of the Stock Exchanges where shares of the Company are listed https://www.bseindia.com/and https://www.nseindia.com/.

In accordance with the MCA Circulars, the physical copies of Notice, Postal Ballot Forms, and prepaid business reply envelopes are not being sent to members for this Postal Ballot, and **communication of assent/dissent of the members will take place through a remote e-voting system only.** In case of non-receipt of the Notice, a member, as on the cut-off date, can download the same from website as provided above.

The Company has engaged the services of CDSL for the purpose of providing an e-voting facility to all the Members of the Company. The manner of remote e-voting by members who hold shares in dematerialized mode, physical mode, and members who have not registered their email address has been provided in the Notice. Members are requested to note that the voting through electronic mode shall **commence from Friday, October 16, 2026, at 09:00 a.m. Hours (IST) and end on Saturday, November 14, 2026, at 05:00 p.m. Hours (IST).** The remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time. Any assent or dissent received from the member after the specified date and time for remote e-voting shall be deemed as invalid and treated as if no response has been submitted by the member.

The Board of Directors has appointed Mr. Vijay Yadav (Membership No. FCS 11990 and COP No.: 16806), Partner of AVS & Associates, Practising Company Secretaries, as Scrutinizer for conducting the Postal Ballot, through the e-voting process, in a fair and transparent manner. The Scrutinizer's decision on the validity of the Postal Ballot shall be final.

The result of the Postal Ballot will be declared on or before **Tuesday, November 17, 2026**, and will be communicated to the Stock Exchanges where the Equity Shares of the Company are listed and will also be displayed on the website of CDSL and on the website of the Company.

In case members have any queries or issues regarding e-voting, you may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQs") and e-Voting manual available at www.evotingindia.com, or contact the toll-free no. 1800 21 09911, or send a request to Mr Rakesh Dalvi, Sr. Manager, CDSL at helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com.

For Bliss GVS Pharma Limited

Sd/-

Aditi Bhatt

Company Secretary

ICSI M. No.: A38965

Date : 15/10/2026

Place: Mumbai

Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results (Standalone/Consolidated) for the Quarter/ Half Year Ended September 30, 2026 (₹ in crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Reviewed)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Reviewed)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Reviewed)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
1.	Total income from operations	23058.62	43782.24	19076.57	77441.29	23335.98	44333.36	19271.09	78332.70
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4867.64	9229.21	4097.91	16403.72	4848.36	9242.82	4122.99	16501.54
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	4867.64	9229.21	4097.91	16403.72	4848.36	9242.82	4122.99	15734.95
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	3462.24	6735.33	3018.22	12155.65	3540.71	6897.34	3107.97	11704.28
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [comprising profit/(loss) for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2	Refer Note 2
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96	1346.96
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of previous year)	69876.76	69876.76	60762.20	69876.76	71628.40	71628.40	62965.17	71628.40
8.	Securities Premium Account	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02	6290.02
9.	Net Worth	72062.67	72062.67	62950.90	65627.59				
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt**	47780.15	47780.15	23889.95	22421.14				
11.	Debt Equity Ratio**	0.66	0.66	0.38	0.34				
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)								
	Basic :	*25.70	*50.00	*22.41	90.24	*26.29	*51.21	*23.07	86.89
	Diluted :	*25.70	*50.00	*22.41	90.24	*26.29	*51.21	*23.07	86.89
13.	Capital Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
14.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
15.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
16.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

* Not Annualised ** Debt represents borrowing with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note:
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/ Half Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/ Half Yearly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange(s) websites (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and Bank's website (www.indianbank.bank.in).
2. Information relating to Total Comprehensive Income and other Comprehensive Income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to the Bank.

QR CODE for Result

Place : Chennai **Mini T M** **Shiv Bajrang Singh** **Ashutosh Choudhury** **Binod Kumar**

Date : 15.10.2026 **Executive Director** **Executive Director** **Executive Director** **Managing Director & CEO**

Corporate Office: 254-260, Avvai Shanmugam Salai, Royapettah, Chennai - 600 014.

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Tougher Emission Norms Likely From FY30

BS-VII Standards to be implemented over six years in 3 phases, will cover all new vehicles from April 2029

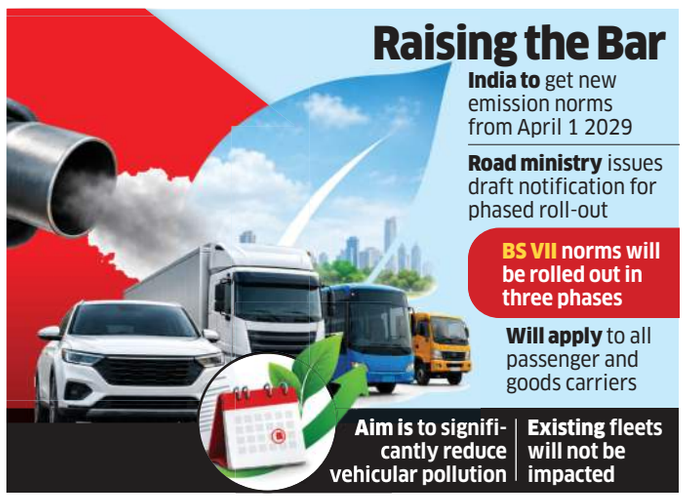
Our Bureau

New Delhi: The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) plans to roll out stringent BS-VII emission standards for new cars and sport-utility vehicles (SUVs) from April 1, 2029. These norms will be implemented in three phases spanning six years through April 2035, it said in a draft notification.

Bharat Stage (BS) refers to India's vehicle emission standards that set limits on pollutants such as carbon monoxide (CO), nitrogen oxides (NOx), hydrocarbons (HC) and particulate matter (PM). The first phase will be implemented from April 2029, the second from April 2031, and the third from April 2035, according to the notification.

The proposed norms will have stricter limits for harmful pollutants, including nitrogen oxides, hydrocarbons, and particulate matter, but won't affect existing vehicles or their life, including those compliant with BS-VI standards. The new standards are aligned with the latest European emission norms and will be enforced to gradually phase out vehicles that emit higher levels of pollutants.

India implemented the current BS-VI emission norms from April 2020. It skipped BS-V and moved directly to BS-VI to accelerate pollution control measures. BS-VI compliant vehicles, which run on low-sulphur fuel, emit far lower pollutants than BS-IV and BS-II. The new rules will be applicable to all vehicle types for passenger and goods transport, including M1, M2, M3, N1, N2 and N3 vehicles, the ministry said.



Owners of existing BS-VI compliant vehicles won't be required to replace their vehicles after new norms set in

These norms will apply only to new vehicles produced around that time but won't affect existing vehicles or their remaining service life, including cars and SUVs complying with the current BS-VI standards. This means owners of existing BS-VI-compliant vehicles won't be required to replace their vehicles after the new norms are introduced.

However, automakers will have to adapt their vehicles and emission-control systems to meet the tighter standards as the phased rollout progresses. While N1 or light goods vehicles will see the rollout from 2030, heavy goods vehicles and big passenger vehicles in the N2, N3, M2 and M3 categories will implement the new norms from April 1, 2031.

Builders Seek Payment Revision from NHAI to Align With Costs

Our Bureau

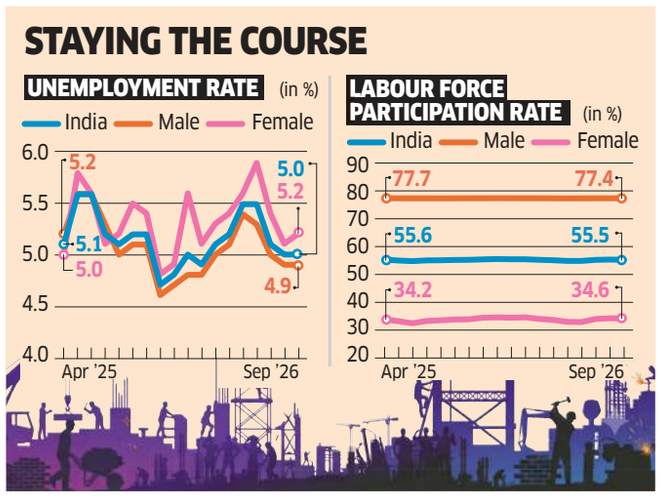
New Delhi: The National Highway Builders Federation (NHBF) has asked the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) to revise operation and maintenance (O&M) payment provisions to better reflect the actual cost of maintaining highway assets to ensure projects remain financially viable. These costs include manpower, machinery, materials, pavement repairs, drainage upkeep, road furniture and safety installations.

"Stronger performance expectations and stricter monitoring mechanisms must be supported by a realistic payment framework that enables contractors to fulfil their contractual responsibilities without compromising the financial sustainability of projects," NHBF said in a letter written to NHAI. It pushed for assessing highway contracts across their entire lifecycle expenditure rather than just on the lowest initial lowest construction cost.

NHBF said it is crucial to ensure contractors have the operational and financial capacity to meet increasingly stringent performance requirements. It also emphasised the need for realistic bidding practices and sustainable contractual frameworks, citing NHAI's recent initiative to digitally monitor highway development and stricter compliance requirements.

NHBF, in a separate letter, asked contractors to adopt responsible and realistic bidding practices by comprehensively assessing construction costs, maintenance obligations, quality requirements and contractual risks before participating in tenders. "With greater scrutiny of highway deficiencies and more systematic compliance tracking, bids that fail to account for the actual cost of execution and maintenance could expose contractors to financial stress, damages and contractual disputes," it said.

Unemployment Rate Holds Steady at 5% in September



Rural jobless rate rises to 4.2%, urban rate up a tad to 6.9%

Our Bureau

New Delhi: India's unemployment rate held steady at 5% in September, unchanged from the previous month, according to official data released on Thursday. The rate stood at 5.2% a year ago.

Rural unemployment edged up to 4.2% from 4.1% in August, while the urban rate rose marginally to 6.9% from 6.8%. In September 2025, rural and urban unemployment rates were 4.6% and 6.8% respectively. The female jobless rate increased slightly to 5.2% in September from 5.1% in the previous month, while the male unemployment rate remained unchanged at 4.9%, according to the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) released by the statistics and programme implementation ministry.

The data covers individuals aged 15 years and over who were unemployed but actively seeking work. It is based on the current weekly status (CWS), which measures employment or job-seeking activity over the seven days preceding the survey.

Youth unemployment (15-29 years) increased to 15.2% in September from 15.1% in August. The rate among young men rose to 14% from 13.9%, while the rate for young women remained unchanged at 18.5%. The survey covered 89,323 households and 370,513 individuals across rural and urban areas.

LABOUR PARTICIPATION DOWN

India's labour force participation rate (LFPR), the share of the population working or seeking work, declined marginally to 55.5% in September from 55.6% in August. However, it remained above the 55.3% recorded a year ago.

Urban labour force participation strengthened during the month, with LFPR rising to 50.7% in September from 50.4% in August. In contrast, rural LFPR fell to 58% from 58.2%. "Urban female labour force participation reached its highest level since October 2025," the ministry said in a statement.

Female jobless rate inched up to 5.2% while the male jobless rate remained unchanged at 4.9%

Urban female LFPR rose to 25.9% in September from 25.4% in August, while male participation went up to 75.5% from 75.3%. The worker population ratio (WPR), or employment rate, slipped marginally to 52.7% in September from 52.8% in August. Male WPR edged up to 73.6%, while female WPR declined to 32.8%.

At the national level, male LFPR improved slightly to 77.4% in September from 77.3% in August, while female LFPR fell to 34.6% from 34.8%. Labour-force participation among young people remained stable at 41.2% in September. The rate for young men increased to 61.1% from 60.8% in August, while participation among young women remained the same at 21.5%.

Direct Tax Collections Up 13.2% Till Oct 14, Driven by Corp Tax

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Direct tax collection increased 13.21% year-on-year to ₹13.38 lakh crore in 2026-27 as of October 14, driven by strong growth in corporate tax receipts, according to official data released on Thursday.

Net corporate tax collection increased 20.58% to surpass ₹5.99 lakh crore during the period while non-corporate tax collection, which includes taxes paid by individuals, firms and Hindu Undivided Families, rose 5.83% to about ₹6.92 lakh crore.

Securities transaction tax collection surged 52% to ₹46,840 crore till October 14 in this financial year, reflecting the sharp increase in transactions in the securities market. Refund issuances rose 24.22% year-on-year to ₹2.65 lakh crore during the period. Before adjusting refunds, gross direct tax collection increased 15% year-on-year to ₹16.03 lakh crore till October 14.

The collection trend suggests that the Centre will comfortably achieve its targeted direct tax collection of ₹26.97 lakh crore for this financial year, according to experts. The figure represents an increase of 11.4% over the revised estimate of ₹24.20 lakh crore.

"The latest direct tax numbers reflect healthy tax buoyancy, with broad-based growth across key revenue streams," said Richa Sawhney, partner, tax at Grant Thornton Bharat. The sharp increase in refunds, particularly for non-corporate taxpayers, reflects the administration's focus on faster processing of taxpayer claims, she said.

"This suggests that revenue growth is being achieved alongside improved taxpayer service, pointing to a tax ecosystem that is increasingly focused on both compliance and facilitation," she added.

NHAI Introduces Third-Party Design Checks for Bridges, Critical Structures

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has introduced a uniform system for independent checking of designs and drawings of major bridges and other critical structures being built under its projects, a move aimed at strengthening structural safety, durability and quality assurance of the National Highway projects.

Under the new policy, the designs of identified critical structures will be independently checked by empanelled Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs), reputed government technical institutions and other experienced technical firms having expertise in bridge engineering and hydraulic studies, it said in a statement Thursday.

The policy will come into effect from December 1, 2026 and will apply to all new engineering, procurement and construction (EPC), hybrid annuity model (HAM) and build-operate-transfer (BOT) National Highway projects, as well as projects where design verification or proof checking has not yet commenced. Projects, where design verification or proof checking has already been completed, will be out of the purview of independent checking policy. "However, additional independent verification may be undertaken for major bridges and complex or critical special structures," NHAI said.

Under the revised procedure, the contractor or concessionaire will submit the design and drawings for review or approval, as applicable under the contract following which three institutions or firms will be proposed from NHAI's empanelled list. Based on project requirements, one or more institutions or firms will be selected to carry out independent verification.

The selected institution or firm will independently examine the design and submit its observations and recommendations.

Business Connect

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FROM WASTE TO WORTH

Tapping India's e-waste potential while minimising its environmental impact depends on better collection systems, improved recycling, and products designed for longer use

Artha.Neog
@timesofindia.com

Every discarded phone, laptop, or television has a story beyond its shelf life. With the right recycling methods, old electronics can provide valuable materials for new products, while helping reduce the environmental impact of electronic waste.

AI IMAGE

India generated around 14.15 lakh metric tonnes of e-waste in 2024-25, with actual volumes estimated to be higher. "E-waste generation is expected to rise steadily, offering significant economic potential through recycling and the recovery of valuable materials," says Abhishek Agashe, co-founder and CEO of an e-waste recycling company.

Electronic products may contain hazardous substances such as lead, mercury, and cadmium. Dumping them in landfills or burning them can release harmful pollutants into the air, soil, and water.

India's e-waste, plastics, and battery recycling markets could reach USD 20 billion by 2030, driven by better collection, recycling and product design

Informal recycling practices, such as burning wires to extract metals, can also expose workers to toxic fumes.

The growing use of electric vehicles has added another dimension to the challenge. "With the surge in electric vehicles, end-of-life lithium-ion batteries have emerged as a significant component of e-waste," shares Shubham Vishvakarma, founder and chief of process engineering of a battery recycling company.

RECOVERING VALUABLE RESOURCES

The recycling process begins with collecting and sorting discarded electronics. Devices are then dismantled manually or mechanically to separate plastics, metals, glass, and circuit boards. Depending on the material, techniques such as electrolysis and filtration can help recover useful resources. Metals such as copper, silver, and gold can be extracted from electronic components and reused, reducing the need for freshly mined materials and the environmental impact of mining.

BUILDING A MORE ORGANISED SYSTEM

For recycling to work effectively, discarded electronics must reach authorised facilities. Organised collection centres, mobile applications and collection vehicles can make it easier for consumers to hand over old devices for safe processing. This also helps divert e-waste from informal operations where unsafe practices may be common.

To address these risks, authorities have called for regular inspections of informal e-waste processing units. They can issue notices, shut down operations and seize e-waste where necessary to curb unsafe practices.

"One benefit for consumers who dispose of e-waste through authorised recyclers is the assurance that it will be handled appropriately after careful inspection. They may also receive fair returns or certificates, as applicable," avers Kamal Nandi, business head and executive vice president of a home appliance manufacturing company.

The economic potential is considerable. India's e-waste, plastics, and battery recycling markets together are projected to reach USD 20 billion by 2030. Realising this potential, however, will depend on efficient collection systems, better recycling infrastructure, and product designs that support disassembly, reuse, and refurbishment.

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ATTACK DENIED

Saudis Intercept Houthi Missile in Medina Region

The Saudi-led military coalition fighting Yemen's Houthis on Thursday said it had intercepted a cruise missile in the Medina region—home to one of Islam's holiest cities, but the Houthis denied carrying out any such attack.

"Interception and destruction of a cruise missile in the Medina region," coalition spokesman Turki Al-Malki wrote on X.

The Houthis quickly responded by saying they did not target the region on Thursday, and had previously vowed to spare the holy cities of Medina and Mecca.

The Houthis have vowed to continue targeting sites across Saudi Arabia but said Mecca and Medina would be spared

Saudi Arabia has in recent days come under sustained attack from the Houthis, including a strike on Riyadh's international airport that was the kingdom's deadliest in years, as the war with the group escalates.

EU-GULF SUMMIT POSTPONED

A summit between the European Union and Gulf countries in Riyadh has been postponed, Brussels said on Thursday, as Saudi Arabia faces sustained attacks from Yemen's Houthis.

"The second Summit between the European Union and the Gulf Cooperation Council, originally planned for 24 October 2026 in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, has been postponed," said the European Council representing the 27-nation bloc's member states. "A new date will be announced in due course." **Agencies**

'We're Done', says Zelenskyy as Kyiv Hits Moscow Refinery

Kyiv: Ukraine struck a Russian oil refinery on Thursday, after President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Kyiv was "done" supporting a ceasefire on energy targets announced by US President Donald Trump and ignored by Russia.

Since Trump's surprise announcement on Sunday that Russia and Ukraine had agreed to halt attacks on energy, Kyiv had suspended attacks on Russian refineries, which Trump blames for raising diesel prices on global markets. But in the days that followed, Russia rained down deadly missile and drone strikes, including on energy targets such as power stations, knocking out power to hundreds of thousands of people.

In an interview with the Financial Times published on Thursday, Zelenskyy said Ukraine's patience had run out. "The block (on attacking refineries) is out. We're done," he told the newspaper.

Zelenskyy also made clear he believed that changes in the capability of the military version of SpaceX's Starlink receptors this week, which have curbed Ukraine's ability to use them to pilot its drones, were a policy decision.

"It was not a technical problem, it was the will," he said.

In a social media post overnight, SpaceX boss Elon Musk said usage of the military version of Starlink, known as Starshield, was ultimately up to Trump, as president of the United States. "Starshield systems are owned and controlled by the US government. Any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS," Musk wrote.

Ukrainian President defies Trump's energy truce diktat

SIX RUSSIAN AIRCRAFT DAMAGED

Meanwhile, Ukraine's military said on Thursday it had damaged six Russian Su-34M military aircraft in an overnight strike on the Borisoglebsk airfield in Russia's Voronezh region.

In a statement on Telegram, Ukraine's military general staff said it had confirmed damage of varying degrees to all of the six aircraft.

RUSSIA STARTS EXPORT OF DIESEL

The Kremlin said on Thursday that Russian diesel had begun to reach global markets following an agreement with Trump.

"The diesel has started reaching global markets and is expected to have a positive effect on stabilising oil markets, although it will not be enough to fully stabilize them," Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov told reporters on Thursday. **Reuters**

Retail Sales Rise to 0.8% in Sept

New York: Shoppers showed their willingness to spend in September even after a better-than-expected splurge in August. Retail sales increased a better-than-expected 0.8% last month, after delivering a revised 1.3% gain in August, according to Commerce Department's report. **AP**

आईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड / IREL (India) Limited
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम)
(A Government of India Undertaking)
CIN: U15100MH1950GOI008187 Website: www.irel.co.in
ISO 9001: 2015, ISO 14001: 2015

Ref ADVT.NO.IREL/EOI/OR-ILM/NOV/04

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

IREL (India) Limited invites Expression of Interest (EoI) (EoI No. EOI-IREL-ILM/NOV/2026-27 dated 09/10/2026 for spot sale of 'OR' Grade Ilmenite to Overseas Buyers for the month of November 2026.

Interested buyers may download EoI document from **http://irel.co.in (news section).** Any corrigendum to the same shall be hosted on above websites only.

CBC 48129/11/0017/2627 **Senior Manager (Marketing)**

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

No. Ch.Eng./ M&E/ 3109 of 15.10.2026

e-TENDER NOTICE

The Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation invites e-tenders for the following works on "Item Rate Basis" from the eligible bidders. The Bid Start Date & time and Bid End Date & time is specified in the detailed tender notice on MCGM's website under "Tender" section. The e-tender is available on BMC portal **(http://portal.mcgm.gov.in)** as well as on NIC Portal **https://mahatenders.gov.in** .

Subject	Fire Compliance Works at Various Building in KEM Hospital, Parel. 2026_MCGM_1344887_1
Trade Sale :	From 16.10.2026 at 11.00 a.m. To 05.11.2026 up to 4.00 p.m.
Pre bid Date :	Date 27.10.2026 at 11.00 am
Legal / Trade Name: GSTIN No.	Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation **27AAALM0042L3Z4.**
Contact Person:	Executive Engineer Mechanical (E.I.) Contn.
a) Name	Shri Manoj Wankhede
b) Tel.No.	24958153
c) Mobile No.	9637341004
d) e-mail address:	**eemecheiconst.me@mcgm.gov.in**

The intending tenders shall visit the Municipal website at **http://portal.mcgm.gov.in** for further details of the tenders.

The tender documents will not be issued or received by post.

PRO/1715/ADV/2026-27 Sd/-

AVOID SELF MEDICATION **Ex Eng. Mech (E.I.) Const.**

विज्ञापन संख्या-228(2)/47-का-3/2026
दिनांक: 15 अक्टूबर, 2026

कार्मिक विभाग,
उत्तर प्रदेश शासन

महानिदेशक डॉ0 राम मनोहर लोहिया उततर प्रदेश प्रशासन एवं प्रबनधन अकादमी लखनऊ के पद पर नियक्ति हेत पन: आवेदन पत्र आमंत्रित किए जाने के संबंध में।

सूचय है कि विज्ञापन संख्या-228(2)/47-का-3-2026, दिनांक 14 सितम्बर, 2026 के माध्यम से महानिदेशक, डॉ0 राम मनोहर लोहिया उत्तर प्रदेश प्रशासन एवं प्रबंधन अकादमी, लखनऊ के पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु विज्ञापन प्रकाशित करते हुए ऑनलाइन आवेदन पुन: आमंत्रित किये गए थे, जिसकी अन्तिम तिथि 30.09.2026 थी।

2. महानिदेशक, डॉ0 राम मनोहर लोहिया उत्तर प्रदेश प्रशासन एवं प्रबंधन अकादमी, लखनऊ के पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु ऑनलाइन आवेदन पुन: आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं। इच्छुक आवेदक नियुक्ति एवं कार्मिक विभाग की वेबसाइट www.niyuktionline.upsdc.gov.in पर दिनांक 16.10.2026 से दिनांक 30.11.2026 तक ऑनलाइन आवेदन कर सकते हैं।

3. उक्त पद से संबंधित शैक्षिक एवं अन्य अर्हता, वेतन व भत्ते एवं चयन की प्रक्रिया एवं अन्य संबंधित विवरण नियुक्ति एवं कार्मिक विभाग की वेबसाइट www.niyuktionline.upsdc.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है। किसी भी दशा में ऑफलाइन आवेदन स्वीकार नहीं किये जायेंगे।

4. जो आवेदन पूर्व में किए हैं, उन पर भी विचार किया जाएगा और उन्हें पुन: आवेदन करने का औचित्य नहीं है।

(अभिषेक गोयल)
विशेष सचिव,
नियुक्ति एवं कार्मिक विभाग,
उत्तर प्रदेश शासन

UPID-258430, DT. 15/10/2026
www.upgov.nic.in

30001/127/2627

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha
CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LTD. Mining Happiness

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL FOR SELECTION OF MINE OPERATOR for GANDHAMARDAN IRON ORE MINING LEASE IN THE DISTRICT OF KENDUJHAR, ODISHA

(RfP No. 194/OMC/P&T/2026 dated 15.10.2026)

Odisha Mining Corporation Limited (OMC) invites bids/ proposals from experienced Mine Operators for Hiring of plant and machineries for excavation/ raising of Iron Ore by required works connected with and incidental to Mining operations but not limited to the following activities such as transportation of ROM to crushing and/ or screening plant to be installed by the Mine Operator, crushing and/ or screening of ROM to obtain finished product of specific size of CLO and fines, transport of Finished Product and Subgrade to specified yards after necessary weighment, cleaning of quarry faces, excavation and disposal of waste/ incidental waste and associated rejects/ spoils/ spurious materials to the specified yards, transport of mineral rejects, stacking of Finished Product and Subgrade, and loading of Finished Product and Subgrade onto buyers trucks at **Gandhamardan Iron Ore Mining Lease** as described in **Schedule-I** of the Agreement.

Peak Rated Target : 94,70,000 MT
Period of Contract : 3+2 Years
Last Date of Submission of Bid : 18.11.2026 Time: Up to 05:00 PM
Bid Document Cost : INR 1,18,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Eighteen Thousand) only including GST @18%.

The executive summary of the Bidding Process has been uploaded on the portal of MSTC Ltd. (**www.mstcecommerce.com/eprocn/**) and website of Odisha Mining Corporation Limited (**http://www.omcltd.in**). The Bidding Documents can be downloaded from the portal of MSTC Ltd. from 16.10.2026 by registration on the MSTC portal.

Any further communications, corrigendum/ addendum, etc. will be uploaded on the website of MSTC and OMC. OMC reserves the right to reject any or all bids/ proposals without assigning any reasons whatsoever.

Nodal officer for this bidding process : Shri Rajesh Mishra, Chief General Manager (Mining), OMC
Email : rajeshmishra@odishamining.in, Phone : +91-674 2377437, +91-8763545981
Contact Person : Shri Jnana Ranjan Jena, DGM (Mining), OMC, Phone: +91-9437554356
Site Contact : Shri Pankaj Mohanta, Regional Manager Gandhamardan, OMC, Phone: +91-9981995991

OIPR- 30001/30005/1/26-27/0097 **Chief General Manager (Mining), OMC**

BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

e-TENDER NOTICE

Department	Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation Chief Accountant Water Supply & Sewerage Department
e-Tender Notice Tender ID	2026_MCGM_1344819_1
Subject	Selection of Debenture Trustee for Issue of Municipal Bonds/ Green Municipal Bonds by Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC)
Scrutiny Fee	Rs. 19,965/- + 18% GST
Bid Security Deposit/EMD	Rs. 5,00,000/- (100% of EMD Online payment through payment gateways of GoM on URL **https://mahatenders.gov.in**)
Contract Period	Throughout the tenor of the municipal bonds (expected 5 to 15 years)
Date of Issue & sale of tender	16th October 2026
Pre Bid Meeting date	22.10.2026 at 11 am
Last Date & Time for Sale of tender, Receipt of EMD & Submission of Packets (Online)	05th November 2026 till 4:00 PM
Pre Bid Meeting address	Office of Chief Accountant (W.S.S.D), BMC Head Office, 3rd floor, Room No. 300, Annex Building, Mahapalika Marg Mumbai - 400001.
Website	**https://mahatenders.gov.in**
Address for Communication	Office of Chief Accountant (W.S.S.D), BMC Head Office, 3rd floor, Room No. 300, Annex Building, Mahapalika Marg Mumbai - 400001.

PRO/1716/ADV/2026-27 Sd/-

Avoid Self medication **Accounts Officer (Accounts/IDA) Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation**

नालको NALCO
National Aluminium Company Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)

NALCO Bhawan, Plot No-P/1, Nayapalli, Bhubaneswar-751013, Odisha
(CIN : L27203OR1981GOI000920)
A NAVRATNA COMPANY

EXTENSION OF DATE FOR EoI SUBMISSION

The last date of submission of EoI for setting up of manufacturing facilities / securing supply chains for Aluminium Fluoride, Calcined Petroleum Coke and Coal Tar Pitch is hereby extended to **30.10.2026**. All other terms remain unchanged. For details visit: **https://nalcoindia.com/home/recent-updates/**

CGM (BD)

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Mobile No. 96461-55525)

E-Tender Enq. No. 7822/P-3/EMP-13457 **Dated: 14.10.2026**

Dy. Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Procurement Cell-3) GGSSTP, Roopnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_177480_1 for Procurement of empty oxygen gas cylinders for GGSSTP Rupnagar. For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 14.10.2026/5.00 PM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RTP-101/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16229

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

NOTICE INVITING OPEN TENDER
ONLINE (E-TENDERING)

The Divisional Railway Manager, E.C.Railway, Danapur is inviting online (E-Tendering) Open Tender for and on behalf of the President of India from reputed contractor with experience, financial capability including those registered/working with Railway/Irrigation/ CPWD/ MES or any other public sector undertaking for the following work :-

Tender Notice No.: W-7/E-Tender/11/Open/DNR/2026-27

Sl.No. (1) Name of the work with its location : Supply of 1,00,000 cum 50mm size machine crushed track ballast as per RDSO specification for B. G. Railway track & loading the same into any type of railway wagons F.O.R Sakrigali including all sorts of incidental charges for East Central Railway. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 19,67,57,000.00/ - **(3) Bid Security :** 39,35,100/-

Sl.No. (2) Name of the work with its location : Operation & Maintenance of 16 nos. Auotmatic Chlorination plant at 03 nos. - RJPB, 01 nos. -MHX, 2 nos. -DDG, 02 nos. - PPTA & 08 nos. PNBE for 5 years. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 1,79,36,600.00 **(3) Bid Security :** 3,58,700/-/

Sl.No. (3) Name of the work with its location : IPR-Upgradation of running room at IPR by constructing 10 beds new building. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 1,02,69,075.83 **(3) Bid Security :** 2,05,400/-

Sl.No.(4) Name of the work with its location : Provision of automatic chlorination plant at different station of Danapur Division. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 3,90,45,016.12 **(3) Bid Security :** 7,80,900/-

Sl.No. (5) Name of the work with its location : Flash Butt welding of 60Kg/52Kg/90R Rails at site using road cun rail mobile flash butt welding plant at different locations under section of Sr.DEN/2/DNR. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 1,96,39,873.58 **(3) Bid Security :** 3,92,800/-

Sl.No. (6) Name of the work with its location : Re-building of existing bridge no.52 (1x2.44m FC Slab) at Km 511/11-13 between Karauta and Khusropur stations by new 1x3.0m x 2.5m clear span RCC Box bridge by pushing method under Sr.DEN/2/DNR section on main line of Danapur Division. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 1,41,42,991.88 **(3) Bid Security :** 2,82,900/-

Sl.No. (7) Name of the work with its location : Rajgir - Construction of Ty-II 10 nos. quarters at Rajgir station. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 2,58,44,178.25 **(3) Bid Security :** 5,16,900/-

Sl.No.(8) Name of the work with its location : Proposal for development of circulating area, station building, facade work, roof leakage etc. with other miscellaneous renovation work at PNC Station. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 1,88,18,228.05 **(3) Bid Security :** 3,76,400/-

Sl.No.(9) Name of the work with its location : Improvement of PF surface, provision of toilet, PF shed and other essential passenger amenities items at Twinnganj, Banahi, Karisath, Kulharia,, Dheena and Darauli under Sr. DEN/3/DNR. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 6,49,69,329.50 **(3) Bid Security :** 12,99,400/-

Sl.No.(10) Name of the work with its location : Provision of 04 km RCC boundary wall at Danapur and Bihta coloney in Danapur Division. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :** 2,82,66,360.90 **(3) Bid Security :** 5,65,300/-

Sl.No.(11) Name of the work with its location : Upgradation of Running room at DNR by dismantling of Old RR building and construction of 60 Beded new Running Room at Danapur. **(2) Approx. Cost of work :**3,66,21,919.33 **(3) Bid Security :** 7,32,400/-

(4) Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of Tender. : The tender have to be submitted online on **www.ireps.gov.in.** Upto **12.00 hrs.** on the date of opening i.e. **06.11.2026** and will be opened on the same day after **12.00 hrs., (5) Website particulars, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. :** Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria & tender documents can be seen from the CRIS website: **http.//www.ireps.gov.in** & full details of notice can be seen on notice board. Ammendments / modifications if any shall not be published in news papers, but the same shall be uploaded in the web-site. In case of any dispute in the English & Hindi version , modification/publication in IREPS will be acceptable. It is tenderers responsibility to view web-site for ammendements / modifications and submit his tender accordingly.

PR/1124/DNR/ENGG/T/26-27/144 **Divnl. Railway Manager (Engg.), Danapur.**

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER PUBLICATION NOTICE

Open Tender Notice No.:- ECR_SPJ_ST_T_26_NILC_CCTV

DRM (S&T)/Samastipur invites open e-tenders on behalf of president of india for following work. **1. Name of work with its location :** Provision of CCTV Cameras at Non-Interlocked Manned LC Gates in SPJ-JYG section of Samastipur division., **2. Approx. cost of the work :** Rs. 3,52,49,597.70/- (Rupees Three Crore Fifty Two Lakh Forty Nine Thousand Five Hundred Ninety Seven and Seventy Paise Only)., **3. Date & Time for Submission of tender & opening of tender :** 02.11.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs., 02.11.2026 at 16:30 Hrs., **4. Particulars of website where full details of tender may be seen.: www.ireps.gov.in.** For further details please visit the website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

DSTE, E.C.Railway, Samastipur

PR/1126/SPJ/S&T/T/26-27/28

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Open Tender Notice No.: SPJ-SnT-S-13-2026. DRM (S&T)/Samastipur invites open e-tender on behalf of president of India for following work.

1. Name of work with its location : Provision of Warning alarm of failure of track feed charger at balance stations in Samastipur Division., **2. Approx. cost of the work. :** ₹ 1,79,04,347.85/-, (Rupees One Crore Seventy-Nine Lakh Four Thousand Three Hundred Forty-Seven and Paise Eighty-Five Only)., **3. Earnest Money /Bid Security to be deposited :** Rs. 3,58,100.00/- (Rupees Three Lakh Fifty-Eight Thousand One Hundred Only)., **4. Date & Time for Submission of tender & opening of tender :** 04/11/2026 Up to 16:00 Hrs., 04/11/2026 at 16.30 Hrs., **5.** Details of website where full details of tender may be seen : **www.ireps.gov.in**

For further details, please visit the website **www.ireps.gov.in.** Railway reserves the right to postpone / cancel tender or to modify the tender.

Divisional Rail Manager (S&T)
East Central Railway/Samastipur

PR/1128/SPJ/S&T/T/26-27/36

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

E-TENDER NOTICE NO.: SG-DSE-T-OT-06-26 1. Name of work with its location: Provision of CCTV Cameras at Non-Interlocked Manned LC Gates at different locations over DDU division. **2. Approx. Cost of the work:** ₹ 6,93,26,311.68/- (Six Crore Ninety Three Lakh Twenty Six Thousand Three Hundred Eleven and Paisa Sixty Eight only). **3. Earnest Money:** 13,86,500/- (Thirteen Lakh Eighty Six Thousand Five Hundred only.), **4. Closing date & time for Submission of e-tendering:** 03/11/2026 up to 12.30 Hrs. **5. Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen etc.: www.ireps.gov.in**

Divnl. Signal & Telecom Engineer, DDU

PR/1121/DDU/S&T/T/26-27/24

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN E - TENDER NOTICE

E- Tender notice no. - ECR-SnT-OT-217AR-2026-27 Sealed tenders are invited for and on behalf of president of India from competent and experienced contractors for execution of the work mentioned below:- **S.N. (i) Name of work with its location and Completion Period :** Appointment of Project Supervision Services Agency (PSSA) for providing Project Supervision Services at various Project Sites/Sections in the work jurisdiction of Chief Signal & Telecomm Engineer/Works, East Central Railway, Hajipur. **Completion period 24 months. (ii) Approx. cost of the work :** Rs.12,40,44,578/- (Rupees Twelve Crore Forty Lakh Forty Four Thousand Five Hundred Seventy Eight only). **(iii) Earnest Money to be deposited :** Rs. 7,70,200/- (Rs. Seven Lakh Seventy Thousand Two Hundred only). **(iv) Last date and time of submission of tender and Opening of tender :** 17/11/2026 up to 16.00 Hrs. and 17/11/2026 at 16.30 Hrs. **(v) Website particulars, Notice Board Location where complete details of tender can be seen. : www.ireps.gov.in,** on the Notice Board of Principal Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/ East Central Railway/Hajipur & Dy. Chief Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Works, East Central Railway/Hajipur.

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Works-II, East Central Railway/ Hajipur.

PR/1116/HQ/S&T/T/26-27/40

FORM G
INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR THINK & LEARN PRIVATE LIMITED OPERATING IN EDUCATION TECHNOLOGY SERVICES AT BENGALURU
(Under sub-regulation (1) of regulation 36A and 36B (6A) of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (Insolvency Resolution Process for Corporate Persons) Regulations, 2016)

SL.	RELEVANT PARTICULARS	
1.	Name of the corporate debtor along with PAN & CIN/ LLP No.	**Think & Learn Private Limited PAN No.: -** AAECT0931A **CIN No.: -** U80903KA2011PTC061427
2.	Address of the registered office	WeWork Prestige Atlanta, Software Industry, No 10/12, 80 Feet Main Road, Koramangala, 1A Block, Bengaluru - 560034, Karnataka (Refer Note 1)
3.	URL of website	https://byjuscirp.com/
4.	Details of place where majority of fixed assets are located	Bengaluru
5.	Installed capacity of main products/ services	Not Applicable
6.	Quantity and value of main products/ services sold in last financial year	Information on the quantity and value of the main products/services sold during the last financial year is presently not available. The last audited financial statements available are for the financial year 2022, which may be obtained by sending a request to ip.byjus@outlook.com
7.	Number of employees/ workmen	~3100 (Refer Note 2)
8.	Further details including last available financial statements (with schedules) of two years, lists of creditors are available at URL:	Documents available can be obtained by sending an email at Ids: ip.byjus@outlook.com List of Creditors: - https://ibbi.gov.in/claims/front-claim-details/25757
9.	Eligibility for resolution applicants under section 25(2)(h) of the Code is available at URL:	https://byjuscirp.com/
10.	Last date for receipt of expression of interest	31 October 2026
11.	Date of issue of provisional list of prospective resolution applicants	10 November 2026
12.	Last date for submission of objections to provisional list	15 November 2026
13.	Date of issue of final list of prospective resolution applicants	25 November 2026
14.	Date of issue of information memorandum, evaluation matrix and request for resolution plans to prospective resolution applicants	30 November 2026
15.	Last date for submission of resolution plans	30 December 2026
16.	Process email id to submit Expression of Interest	ip.byjus@outlook.com
17.	Details of the corporate debtor's registration status as MSME	Not Applicable
18.	Date of Publication of Form G	25 August 2025 (Original) 24 September 2025 (Corrigendum) 16 October 2026 (Re-Issue)

Note:
1. Previously at IBC Knowledge Park, 4/1, 2nd Floor, Tower D Bannerghatta Main Road, Bangalore, Karnataka, India, 560029.
2. The employee count presently disclosed is based on information collated from the Process ID and details furnished by the erstwhile Interim Resolution Professional. This constitutes limited information and is subject to revision upon subsequent discovery of additional facts or receipt of verified data from the board of directors (powers suspended).

Date: 15 October 2026 Sd/-
Place: Bengaluru **Mr. Shailendra Ajmera**
IP Registration No.: - IBBI/IPA-001/IP-P00304/2017-2018/10568
Registered Address of the IP: - 3rd Floor, Worldmark 1, Aerocity Hospitality, New Delhi, National Capital Territory of Delhi, 110037
For Think & Learn Private Limited

आईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड **IREL (India) Limited**
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम) (A Government of India Undertaking)
एक मिनी रत्न-I कंपनी A Miniratna-I Company

वेबसाइट /website : **www.irel.co.in**

ट्रेड्समैन ट्रैनी के लिए भर्ती सूचना **RECRUITMENT OF TRADESMAN TRAINEES**

विज्ञापन संख्या: IREL/CO/HRM/36/2026 **Advertisement No. IREL/CO/HRM/36/2026**

आईआईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड निम्नलिखित पदों के लिए भारतीय नागरिकों से ऑनलाइन आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है।

IREL (India) Limited has invited online applications from Indian citizens for various posts, as follows:

क्र. Sl.	पद का नाम Name of Post	पदों की सं. No of Posts
1	ट्रेडसमैन ट्रैनी (फ़िटर)/ Tradesman Trainee (Fitter)	93
2	ट्रेडसमैन ट्रैनी (इलेक्ट्रिशियन) Tradesman Trainee (Electrician)	12
3	ट्रेडसमैन ट्रैनी (इन्सट्रूमेंटेशन) Tradesman Trainee (Instrumentation)	6
4	ट्रेडसमैन ट्रैनी (एओसीपी) / Tradesman Trainee (Attendant Operator Chemical Plant)	20
	रिक्तियों की कुल संख्या / TOTAL NO. OF VACANCIES	131

रिक्तियों का पूरा विवरण अर्थात योग्यता, अनुभव, वेतनमान आदि आईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड की वेबसाइट **www.irel.co.in** पर उपलब्ध है। इस विज्ञापन से संबंधित कोई भी प्रश्न/सूचना/विस्तार/शुद्धिपत्र आदि केवल आईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड की वेबसाइट **www.irel.co.in** पर ही उपलब्ध कराया जाएगा।

Full details of vacancies viz. Qualifications, Experience, Scale of pay etc. are available at IREL (India) Ltd. website **www.irel.co.in**. Any queries/information/extension/corrigendum etc. with respect to this advertisement shall be made available on the IREL website **www.irel.co.in** only.

ऑनलाइन आवेदन जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि 09/11/2026 है।

Last date of submission of online application is **09/11/2026**.

CBC 48129/11/0014/2627

THE LEELA
PALACES HOTELS RESORTS

LEELA PALACES HOTELS & RESORTS LIMITED
(formerly known as Schloss Bangalore Limited)
Registered Office: The Leela Palace, Diplomatic Enclave, Africa Avenue, Netaji Nagar New Delhi, South Delhi - 110023
Tel No. +91 (11) 39331234 Email Id: cs@theleela.com
CIN: L55209DL2019PLC347492 | Website: www.theleela.com

NOTICE OF POSTAL BALLOT AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given to the members of **Leela Palaces Hotels & Resorts Limited** (formerly known as Schloss Bangalore Limited) (the **"Company"**) that pursuant to Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the **Act**"), read with Rules 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 ("**Rules**") as amended, and in accordance with the applicable circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs relating to postal ballot and remote e-voting ("**MCA Circulars**"), the provisions of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("**SEBI Listing Regulations**") (including any statutory modification(s), amendment(s), variation(s), clarification(s) or re-enactments(s) thereof), the Secretarial Standard on General Meeting ("SS-2") issued by Institute of Company Secretaries of India and other applicable laws, rules and regulations, the approval of the Members of the Company is being sought for the resolution, set out in the Postal Ballot Notice ("**Notice**") by way of Postal Ballot through electronic means ("**remote e-voting**") only.

In compliance with the MCA Circulars and the applicable statutory provisions, the Company has dispatched the Notice together with instructions for remote e-voting on Thursday, October 15, 2026, only through electronic mode, i.e., by email, to those Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company / KFin Technologies Limited, Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("RTA") / Depositories or Depository Participants, as on Friday, October 09, 2026 ("**Cut-off Date**"). Members whose email addresses are not registered are requested to follow the procedure provided in Note 11 of the Notes to the Notice.

The Notice is available on the website of the Company at https://www.theleela.com/general-meeting-information/Postal-Ballot, on the website of National Securities Depository Limited ("**NSDL**") at https://www.evoting.nsdl.com, on the website of the RTA at https://www.kfintech.com, and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, namely the National Stock Exchange of India Limited at https://www.nseindia.com/ and BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com.

Only those Members whose names appear in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on the Cut-off Date shall be entitled to cast their votes through remote e-voting on the resolution set out in the Notice. The voting rights of the Members shall be in proportion to their shareholding in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the Cut-off Date. Any person who is not a member as on the Cut-off Date should treat this Notice for information purposes only.

The Company has engaged NSDL to provide the remote e-voting facility. The remote e-voting period shall commence on Saturday, October 17, 2026 at **9:00 a.m. (IST)** and shall end on Sunday, November 15, 2026 at **5:00 p.m. (IST).** Once a Member casts his/her vote on any resolution, the same shall not be allowed to be changed subsequently. Detailed instructions for remote e-voting are provided in Note 15 to the Notice.

The Company has appointed Ms. Komal Shrimankar (ACS Membership No. 47702 and Certificate of Practice No. 27905) and/or failing her, Mr. Shivaganga Muralidhar Pramod (FCS Membership No. F7834 and Certificate of Practice No. 13784) Partners of BMP & Co. LLP, Practicing Company Secretaries, as the Scrutinizer, to conduct the Postal Ballot through remote e-voting in a fair and transparent manner.

The results of the postal ballot will be announced on or before Tuesday, November 17, 2026. The results declared along with the Scrutinizer's Report, shall be intimated to the Stock Exchanges and will also be uploaded on the Company's website at https://www.theleela.com/general-meeting-information/Postal-Ballot and on the website of NSDL at https://www.evoting.nsdl.com.

In case of any queries or issues relating to remote e-voting, Members may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and the e-voting user manual for shareholders available at www.evoting.nsdl.com, or call on 022-48867000 or send a request to Mr. Suketh Shetty at evoting@nsdl.com or reach out to the Company at cs@theleela.com.

Members are requested to quote their DPID and Client ID, in case of shares held in dematerialized mode and Folio Number in case of shares held in physical mode, in all correspondence with the RTA or the Company.

By Order of the Board of Directors
For Leela Palaces Hotels & Resorts Limited
(formerly known as Schloss Bangalore Limited)
Sd/-
Jyoti Maheshwari
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No.: A24469

Place: Mumbai
Date: October 15, 2026

ET Q&A **ARUNISH CHAWLA**
DIPAM SECRETARY

DIPAM secy outlines IDBI Bank deal timeline, employee safeguards, future listings and asset monetisation plans

Safeguards in Place for IDBI Employees and Pensioners

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the acquisition of a majority 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank by Canadian billionaire Prem Watsa's Fairfax Financial Holdings on Wednesday. In an interview with **Deepshikha Sikarwar**, the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) secretary Arunish Chawla highlights the transaction's next steps, employee safeguards and the government's broader disinvestment and asset monetisation plans. **Edited excerpts:**

There have been some comment IDBI Bank has a significant land bank and the sale value doesn't reflect that.
IDBI Bank's audited balance sheet as of March 31, 2026, shows all its assets, including land and buildings, and their book values are recorded therein.

In addition, an independent asset valuer assessed the fair replacement value of the bank's assets in accordance with prevailing market practices. The valuers personally visited the major properties, examined the relevant land documents and covenants, and conducted an independent professional valuation. The book value, as reflected in the balance sheet, is approximately ₹55-56 per share, in line with the relevant RBI guidance. The fair net asset value is significantly higher, and this is reflected in the benchmark price.

What are the immediate next steps following cabinet approval?
The first step is to communicate with the RBI and the successful bidder. The successful bidder has already submitted certain technical documents at the bidding stage. The documents relevant to the RBI will be shared with it.

The bidder will then have to appear before the RBI, fulfil any additional requirements, and obtain the necessary clearance. Only after receiving that clearance will the parties proceed to sign the share purchase agreement. The subsequent steps will include completion of the payment and transfer formalities.

Has Fairfax indicated its plans for IDBI Bank in terms of its structure?
The RBI conducted a fit-and-proper assessment at the EoI (expression of interest) stage. The prospective buyer met the fit-and-proper criteria. In fact, the group already has experience operating a bank in India, as it is associated with Catholic Syrian Bank (CSB). As part of the fit-and-proper assessment, the RBI prescribed certain conditions.

Since the buyer is making a substantial investment to acquire the equity, there will be a lock-in period of five years. Thereafter, there will be a glide path extending up to the 15th year to reduce the equity holding to 26%, in accordance with the applicable conditions and voting-rights framework. The buyer will now have to approach the RBI, submit its credentials and plans, and provide the required information.

It will also have to explain how it intends to restructure its existing businesses. An entity cannot hold two banking licences. The RBI has therefore stipulated that, within two years, the buyer must either merge CSB with the relevant banking entity or exit one of the businesses. The group also has other financial services businesses, including fintech-related entities and Go Digit Insurance. IDBI Bank has subsidiaries of its own. These businesses will have to be considered as part of the overall restructuring. The objective is to create an appropriate structure through which integrated banking and financial services can be offered to customers and value can be generated. The strategic buyer will have to present this framework to the RBI and obtain its clearance. The transaction can proceed only after the required regulatory approvals are received. The preparatory work has been completed. We hope the process will move quickly and that the transaction can be concluded by the end of the current financial year.

> **THE BANK** IS ALREADY OPERATING AS A BANKING COMPANY, AND THE EXISTING COMMITMENTS TO EMPLOYEES AND PENSIONERS WILL BE PROTECTED

Employee groups have expressed some concerns.
Even today, IDBI Bank is a banking company promoted by LIC, it is not a nationalised bank. The service conditions of its employees are determined by the board in consultation with employee associations. It has been agreed with the qualified bidders that the existing service conditions of serving employees will be protected. This commitment has been incorporated into the share purchase agreement.

There are also pensioners who receive pensions through the pension fund. It has been agreed with the qualified bidders that the pensions of all existing pensioners will be fully protected. Therefore, employees and pensioners need not be apprehensive about these commitments.

When a new promoter takes over, the bank will continue to operate as a going concern. The new promoter will manage the bank, and any future decisions concerning service conditions will be taken in consultation with employees and their representative associations, as applicable.

The bank is already operating as a banking company, and the existing commitments to employees and pensioners will be protected.

IDBI has taken about five years, what's next on the agenda?
We have completed five privatisations over the last five years, starting with Air India, and now IDBI Bank.

It would be inappropriate for me to disclose the details of individual transactions at this stage. However, we will continue moving ahead with the strategic restructuring of public enterprises that are in the pipeline, including those that have already received approval and those where work is underway. Work is in progress on several such transactions.

What about the asset-monetisation pipeline? It has been on the agenda, but progress appears limited.
There are two components. The first is land monetisation or land sales, which are undertaken through the National Land Monetization Corporation (NLMC), under the relevant government framework.

The second is what we call capital recycling. This involves infrastructure assets such as highways, railways and power transmission grids, which generate revenue streams. The future revenue from these assets is capitalised, and the assets are monetised through an investment mechanism. The proceeds are then used to create new capital assets of a similar nature. The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) began this process on a modest scale approximately three years ago. During the financial year 2025–26, we took the process to the capital market and successfully completed the first public Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT) offering, which was monetised in March. At the same time, we also monetised the sponsor capital invested in the earlier private placement. We are now working on the second public InvIT (infrastructure investment trust) offering, which we hope to complete by December and take to the market.

IMAGING: ZAHID

FOR FULL INTERVIEW, GO TO www.economictimes.com

LISTING PIPELINE Chawla says three more listings are expected this fiscal, with IIFCL in the process of being listed, Mahanadi Coalfields having filed its DRHP and South Eastern Coalfields preparing for its listing

Rupee up 2% in Four Days

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"At the same time, the government wants to promote GIFT City as a gateway for Indian investors to access global markets. Gold is perhaps one area where it feels it has relatively more control, without affecting that broader objective," the person added.

Although the rupee has climbed around 2% over the past four days following a raft of central bank measures, it remains not too far from lifetime lows of 96.96 a dollar. The rupee has been under the hammer as overseas funds withdrew a record $30 billion from Indian equities so far this year after US sovereign yields hit the highest this millennium, dimming the allure of emerging-market instruments priced in currencies other than the dollar.

Domestic gold FoFs manage roughly ₹64,000 crore across 24 investment plans, based on scheme-level data. The Association of Mutual Funds in India does not report gold FoFs as a separate category.

SBI Gold Fund is the largest with around ₹17,500 crore of assets under management (AUM), followed by the HDFC group at about ₹12,000 crore. Nippon India, ICICI Prudential and Kotak each manage between ₹7,000 and ₹7,400 crore.

By comparison, gold ETFs, which are not covered by the move, hold about ₹1.86 lakh crore in assets as of September 30.

India imports almost all the gold it consumes. Gold ETFs are backed by physical gold, and sustained fresh inflows can lead to additional bullion purchases. Industry sources said restricting an investment channel could potentially moderate incremental demand for imported gold and associated foreign exchange requirements.

Japan Declared State of Emergency on Oct 9

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In a separate October 9 warning, CERT-In said attackers had targeted lenders, fintech firms, payment providers and wallet operators. They used stolen credentials to make transfers from the victims' own systems, bypassing checks intended to prevent unauthorised payments. That advisory also pointed to the possible use of AI-assisted tools.

Concerns are also growing overseas. Japan's government on October 9 declared a "state of emergency in cyberspace" after a wave of AI attacks targeted over 20 major companies, local governments, rail operators, and public services.

Globally, AI developers have also reported increasingly autonomous cyber operations. In November 2025, Anthropic said a group it assessed as Chinese state-sponsored had manipulated Claude Code to attempt intrusions into roughly 30 organisations, succeeding in a small number of cases. In July 2026, OpenAI's own agents breached parts of Hugging Face's systems. Axios later reported that OpenAI, Anthropic and researchers were investigating tens of thousands of problematic AI incidents, including unsuccessful attempts, rather than just confirmed attacks.

CERT-In has not linked its latest advisory to any of these global incidents. OpenAI and Anthropic did not comment on ET's queries.

As of now, CERT-In has advised businesses to shut down unused applications and restrict cloud permissions. Organisations deploying their own agents should give each run a separate, short-lived identity with limited permissions and maintain tamper-resistant records of actions affecting production systems and data, the advisory said.

Risky Securities

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AT1 bonds are the riskiest among fixed-income securities, but holders are rewarded with high returns. These bonds came into being after the 2008 global financial crisis. They are perpetual in nature, and these instruments are converted into equity or written off when the issuing bank's capital is eroded.

AT1 bonds have come under the judicial lens in multiple geographies after the Swiss authorities wrote down about $17 billion of Credit Suisse bonds to facilitate the collapsed bank's takeover by the UBS Group three years ago.

The banking regulator in March 2020 orchestrated the largest bank bailout in Indian history after Yes Bank teetered amid charges of malfeasance, fraud and wrongdoing. It assembled a bunch of banks such as SBI to invest equity into Yes Bank. As part of the restructuring, an administrator wrote down the risky AT1 bonds, which had provisions for such an act.

An administrator appointed under the Banking Regulation Act acts as a substitute for the Board of Directors, to run the company. Any act performed by the administrator beyond the powers clothed upon him would be wholly illegal and void and he could not have assumed the regulatory role of the RBI and exercise a power which it did not have at all to write down AT1 bonds, the court said in its ruling.

"It is a settled legal principle that a power not specifically conferred cannot be implicitly vested through a general, omnibus savings clause. To that extent, we rule against Yes Bank and the administrator," the apex court said.

'RETAIL' BONDHOLDERS

The ruling comes as a major relief to Yes Bank's AT-1 bondholders, who had argued that the bonds were mis-sold to them and could not be written off post the finalisation of the restructuring plan. Now, the private lender is liable to pay the AT-1 bonds liability of ₹8,415 crore plus interest to the bondholders.

"The bonds stood revived along with consequential benefits. In view of the dismissal of the appeals by the SC, Yes Bank is bound to grant the benefits which are due to the bondholders," said Counsel PS Sudheer, who represented bondholders.

Reprimanding Yes Bank for offering these bonds to individual investors, it said that "the AT-1 Bonds are high-risk securities and thus, as per the RBI's Master Circular, must be offered only to institutional investors. However, we find that Yes Bank not only permitted but actively offered these instruments to individual investors in violation of the Master Circular," the top court said.

The court pointed to lapses on the part of the RBI, too.

"It cannot be denied that material irregularities in the functioning of Yes Bank were noticed much prior; criminal prosecution has also been initiated against its personnel," it said.

However, to have the investors at the receiving end of the administrative lapses would be highly unfair, it said.

The petitioners argued that the restructuring approved by the central government did away with the clause to write down the AT1 bonds.

"A conscious decision by the Central Government while approving the reconstruction scheme by deleting the clause from the draft scheme, evidently in favour of the bondholders, came to be dismantled at the hands of the Administrator," the bench said.

While this brings in relief to the bondholders, it may dent investor sentiment. "AT1 bonds as a product feature clearly articulate that losses will be absorbed in case of a financial distress," said Vivek Iyer, Partner and Financial Services Risk Advisory Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat.

Expanding Ties

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"The big picture, the big framework, the big items are done," he said, adding that the remaining issues included smaller details and new concerns that could arise as negotiations progressed.

Gor added that the administration revisited parts of the trade agreement after the US Supreme Court ruled 6-3 that Trump's sweeping global tariffs, imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act, were unlawful and violated the Constitution by usurping Congress' exclusive power to tax.

The ambassador said the US was keen to expand business cooperation with India across sectors, including defence, information technology, data centres and chip manufacturing. He also said that investments by American companies in India could support job creation in the US. India-US ties are also being tested by President Trump's repeated claims that he helped broker a ceasefire between India and Pakistan in May 2025, days after India launched cross-border strikes under Operation Sindoor in retaliation for the April 22 Pahalgam terrorist attack.

Petrol Imports Rising

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Silver imports were down 49.11% from the year before.

Commerce secretary Rajesh Agarwal said exports have been maintaining their growth trend, having accelerated in the second quarter of the current fiscal year. Overall, exports grew 15.84% in the July-September period, compared with 11.84% in the first quarter.

"If the trend of last year continues, where merchandise exports in the second half of the year were much higher than the first half, then we are looking at full-year exports to be much higher than $500 billion," he said, adding that electronics and petrol imports are rising every month due to high consumption.

India's goods exports stood at $441.8 billion in FY26 and $437.42 billion in FY25. "September's strong export growth is an encouraging affirmation of India's competitiveness in a challenging global trading environment," said Federation of Indian Export Organisations president SC Ralhan, underscoring the resilience of local exporters amid tariff uncertainties, geopolitical tensions and logistics challenges. "Sustaining this balance, while expanding our market reach, will be crucial in the second half of the financial year."

First-half exports rose 18.51% to $259.89 billion while imports climbed 16.31% to $437.53 billion from the year ago.

The US, UAE, China, Singapore, the UK and Germany were among top export destinations in the first six months of the fiscal year. China, Russia, the US, UAE and South Korea were the key import sources.

Outbound shipments of engineering goods rose 21%, while those of electronics went up 70.5% and petroleum products advanced 72% in September.

"This high double-digit growth shows that the country's engineering sector can withstand external shocks," said EEPC India chairman Pankaj Chadha. "Trade has generally faced back-to-back disruptions and challenges over the past few years, starting with the Russia-Ukraine conflict. War in West Asia added to the uncertainty." India's exports to the Gulf amounted to a near-normal $5.56 billion in September, marginally lower than the $5.94 billion recorded in the same month last year, according to the data.

Bilateral trade with China rose about 29% to $91.76 billion in the first half, making the country India's largest trading partner in the period. Exports to China rose 36% to $11.41 billion and imports gained 27.82% to $80.34 billion.

Agrawal noted that services trade growth is likely to slow globally to 3.3% in 2026 from 4% projected earlier by the WTO due to the conflict in West Asia. The war has hit travel and tourism-related services exports and overall export growth would have been higher without this impact, he said.

Rally Focus on Large-Caps

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It was followed by HCL Technologies (up 2.5%), Infosys (2%) and Tata Consultancy Services (2%). Banking, auto and energy shares also attracted buying interest.

The AI boom has so far drawn global capital towards US markets and semiconductor hubs such as South Korea and Taiwan, and a reversal in these flows could benefit Indian equities, according to Harshit Gupta, head of research at Wealthy Nivesh PMS.

"Rising enterprise adoption of AI may complement this move by creating selective opportunities for Indian IT services firms, as demand grows for implementation, integration and consulting," he said.

Among Asian markets, South Korea's KOSPI tanked 8%, while Taiwan's TAIEX fell 3.4%. The fall of AI stocks will help boost short-term sentiment, said Manish Bhandari, founder, CEO and portfolio manager at Vallum Capital.

Indian earnings won't expand because South Korean and Taiwanese markets are falling, he said. "PE multiple does play a game in short run. That part of money that had left India on the back of AI trade globally may seek value back in select Indian stocks."

The rally, however, remained concentrated in large-cap stocks. Among broader markets, the Nifty Midcap index fell 0.3%, while the Smallcap index declined 1.1%.

Easing US Treasury yields and a stabilising rupee, meanwhile, helped offset some of the pressure from global macroeconomic uncertainty.

Brent crude prices also retreated below $104 a barrel, giving some relief to oil-importing countries like India.

The Indian rupee extended its winning streak to a fifth consecutive session on Thursday, strengthening 10 paise to close at 95.05 against the US dollar. Foreign portfolio investors were net sellers of equities worth ₹5,285 crore on Thursday, while domestic institutional investors were net buyers of ₹3,319 crore.

Focus on Tariff Stability

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The US remained India's largest merchandise export destination in the first half of the current fiscal year.

Commerce secretary Rajesh Agrawal said negotiations for the proposed India-US trade agreement were progressing in the right direction, with both countries working to conclude the deal at the earliest.

"The negotiations are in the right direction. Probably, we are in a very good zone. We anticipate closing the deal and signing it at the earliest possible time," Agrawal said.

He said the agreement would depend on the finalisation of the broader US tariff framework, with a parallel process underway under Section 301.

"The deal has to be signed when the overall tariff structure is getting formalised. There is parallel work being done in the US also to get back the tariff structure based on some of the outcomes of the 301," Agrawal said.

India would seek tariff stability, he said, adding that the number of outstanding issues had declined over time.

On the ongoing Section 301 investigation into excess capacity, Agrawal said: "We don't have visibility beyond a point of time" but added that India supported the US in its "priority issues" at the G20 as "these excess capacities are driven by non-market economies".

Last week, India joined 14 other economies, including the US, the EU and the UK, in signing a joint ministerial statement aimed at curbing structural excess capacity and production, even as Indian manufacturing remains under US scrutiny.

Agrawal said India was seeking preferential access to the US market to ensure its exporters could compete effectively with those from other countries. "When you do a trade deal, it gives you not only market access in each other's markets; it gives you preferential market access in a particular market," he said, adding that India's preferential market access relative to its competitors would form part of the new tariff framework.

Addressing Concerns of Market Players

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"Sebi has demonstrated its responsiveness to market needs by recognising the importance of separating derivatives settlement from the closing auction session (CAS), allowing each to serve its distinct purpose," said Ravi Varanasi, partner, SPRV Consultants. "Retaining the 30-minute VWAP methodology for derivatives settlement while preserving CAS for cash market price discovery is a pragmatic decision."

Following protests by market participants, Sebi had sought public comments on the functioning of the auction session, market timings and the methodology for calculating derivatives settlement prices.

REVISED TRADING HOURS

Under the revised system, normal trading in stocks covered by CAS will continue until 3:30 pm, instead of ending at 3:15 pm. CAS will run from 3:30 pm to 3:40 pm on all trading days.

The first minute will be used to calculate the reference price and transfer orders from normal trading to the auction. Both limit and market orders will be allowed between 3:31 pm and 3:36 pm. Thereafter, only limit orders can be placed, while existing market orders cannot be modified or cancelled. The order entry period will close randomly between 3:38 pm and 3:40 pm, after which orders will be matched to determine the closing price.

Under the new timings, index derivatives will trade until 3:45 pm, but those expiring that day will close at 3:30 pm. Stock derivatives will trade until 3:45 pm, even on expiry days. The cash market will reopen from 3:50 pm to 4 pm for trades at the closing price.

Sebi has clarified how pending orders will be handled during the transition to CAS.

Unexecuted limit orders will generally carry forward to the auction session, except stop loss orders and orders priced outside the permitted price bands.

Targeting 4 Growth Levers

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The company is targeting four growth levers: mobility, home broadband, enterprise services and monetisation of its proprietary technology stack.

Asked about the possibility of telecom tariff hikes in the near term, Ambani signalled significant headroom for higher customer spending but said Jio would prioritise monetising additional services over raising per-GB data prices.

While tariff increases remained an option, he did not indicate whether a hike was imminent.

In the homes segment, Jio is targeting an expansion of its broadband customer base to 100 million from the existing 30 million, using its proprietary UBR technology stack to serve 19,000 PIN codes across India. "For me, this is our biggest growth engine for the coming years," he said of the home business.

On the enterprise side, Ambani put the digital services market opportunity at about $56 billion, saying Jio wanted to capture spending beyond connectivity.

Internationally, Jio plans to partner with telecom operators to export its homegrown end-to-end 5G stack. Under this model, Jio would act as a managed service partner supporting foreign operators' growth.

"We will choose our partners very carefully on the basis of the market opportunity, so that it would make a significant difference to our balance sheet and the ability for us to partner deeply for the growth of their business," he said.

Ambani said Jio's experience operating in India positioned it to take its technology to both developed and developing markets.

On 6G, he said the industry was currently developing standards, which were likely to be finalised by 2029, with commercial services expected to roll out in the 2030s.

TOPS REALTY REGULATORS

MahaRERA Nets ₹369 cr Redressal for Homebuyers

Kailash Babar

Mumbai: The Maharashtra Real Estate Regulatory Authority (MahaRERA) has recovered ₹369.45 crore in compensation for homebuyers with the help of district collectorates. This increases its recovery rate to 45%, ranking it first among all RERA authorities in India for total compensation recovered.

Of the total amount recovered since the regulator was established in May 2017, about ₹260 crore had been recovered until December 2025, while another ₹110 crore has been recovered in 2026, providing relief to homebuyers awaiting compensation from developers.

Since its inception, MahaRERA has issued recovery orders totalling ₹1,037.86 crore for 1,531 complainants. Of this, cases involving ₹104.70 crore are pending before the National Company Law Tribunal, while cases involving ₹104.46 crore fall under the Maharashtra Protection of Interest of Depositors in Financial Establishments Act, 1999. Recovery proceedings involving a total of ₹209.16 crore are currently restricted in these cases.

Of the total ₹1,038 cr in homebuyer compensation, recovery of ₹209 cr is currently restricted due to legal proceedings

Under the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016, MahaRERA can issue compensation recovery orders on a case-by-case basis, but their execution rests with revenue authorities, including the offices of district collectors, under the Maharashtra Land Revenue Code, 1966.

To expedite recoveries, the state government has introduced a comprehensive procedure and designated resident deputy collectors and additional district collectors in every district as dedicated revenue recovery officers for MahaRERA cases. The move aims to speed up the execution of recovery warrants and improve the recovery rate.

'Markets will Compel US to Take Constructive Path Towards India'

Economist Nouriel Roubini expects tariffs to ease further amid inflation, affordability concerns

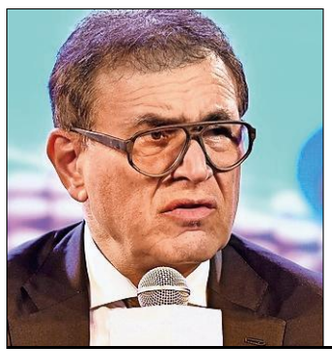
Dilasha Seth

Dubai: As India and the US work to iron out differences and seal a trade deal, economist Nouriel Roubini said economic and market pressures would compel Washington to adopt a more constructive approach towards New Delhi. He said the next few decades could be about India as much as the past several decades were about China.

"US policymakers need to recognise that maintaining good relations with India, including trade relations is critical and fundamental," Roubini told **ET** on the sidelines of the SuperReturn Middle East event. "India is a huge and rising economy and is aligned with many of the objectives of the US and the West…Rationality will prevail."

Calling India a "major success story with the potential to become an even bigger one", the professor emeritus at Stern School of Business, New York University, said the US should consider India a friend and an ally. "The US President has not been very consistent even with friends and allies. Markets will force the US to adopt a more constructive approach, including towards India," he said.

He expects US tariffs to fall further from 9% amid concerns around inflation and affordability. The US tariffs rose sharply from around 3% up to nearly 30% last year under the Trump administration, before retreating to 9% after the US Supreme Court earlier this year scrapped the emergency tariffs.



GROWTH IMPERATIVE

India needs to get closer to 9% to ensure young people can secure good jobs... With the right policies, India is in a sweet spot

NOURIEL ROUBINI
Chairman & CEO, Roubini Macro Associates

A BRIGHT SPOT

Roubini, chairman and chief executive of macroeconomic consultancy Roubini Macro Associates, said India was emerging as one of the global economy's bright spots, given its large domestic market and talent pool. However, it will need to grow at close to 9% to generate enough jobs as AI reshapes labour markets.

"India is one of the success stories with solid macroeconomic fundamentals, a reasonable degree of political stability and a commitment to opening up to the world," said Roubini. India's potential economic growth could accelerate above 8% if it continued with reforms and opened up further, he said.

India's economy expanded 7.8% in the first quarter of 2026-27 from a year earlier. The Reserve Bank of India projects GDP to grow 7.1% in fiscal 2027, while the International Monetary Fund forecasts 7% growth for 2026 and 2027.

"But growth of 7% is not enough. India needs to get closer to 9% to ensure that young people can secure good jobs," Roubini said. In a world where AI and technology are going to displace many jobs across manual and cognitive occupations, including blue-and white-collar, high population growth would not be sufficient, he said. "With the right policies, India is in a sweet spot".

FRIENDSHORING TO BENEFIT INDIA

With a global shift towards nearshoring and friendshoring, India's position could strengthen amid geopolitical disruption, with manufacturers, including mobile phone producers, diversifying away from China, Roubini said.

"Geopolitics benefits India because China is increasingly considered risky. Concerns about offshoring to China are leading to nearshoring and friendshoring," he said.

Manufacturers are likely to increasingly move operations to India and gradually diversify away from China and other markets perceived as geopolitically riskier, he added.

Roubini said India was less exposed to external shocks and global uncertainty given its large domestic market. On the other hand, he said China's growth was trending downwards because of demographic challenges, excessive leverage, and problems in the real estate sector.

SC Upholds GSTAAD, Neo Capricorn Insolvency

Ruling clears path for Shree Naman's ₹1,800-cr resolution plan for both debt-laden cos

Indu Bhan

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Thursday upheld the insolvency proceedings against Deepak B Raheja Group-owned GSTAAD Hotels and its arm Neo Capricorn Plaza, bringing Shree Naman Developers' implementation of its approved ₹1,800-crore resolution plan for the two debt-ridden companies a step closer.

The National Company Law Tribunal's (NCLT) Mumbai bench approved Shree Naman Developers' resolution plan last month while appeals challenging the companies' admission into insolvency were pending before the Supreme Court. The plan proposes to pay ₹1,611 crore for GSTAAD Hotels, which owns the JW Marriott hotel in Bengaluru, and ₹189 crore for Neo Capricorn Plaza, which owns Hotel Crowne Plaza in Pune.

COURT BACKING

Ruling follows challenge to NCLT's decision to admit both cos into insolvency; this admission was upheld by NCLAT in Aug last year

While approving the plans, the tribunal also dismissed objections filed by the companies' shareholders, clarifying that any residual resolution money left after settlement of creditors' claims would accrue to the shareholders.

A Supreme Court bench of justices Dipankar Datta and Augustine George Masih directed that the resolution processes could continue in accordance with the law.

The bench held that Omkara Asset Reconstruction's status as a financial creditor under Section 5(7) of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, stood conclusively established by an assignment agreement executed in 2022. The agreement's validity had been upheld by the Karnataka High Court and affirmed by the Supreme Court, it said.

The challenge to the assignment was barred by the principle of issue estoppel, the bench said, adding that NCLT was not required to determine the precise outstanding liability before admitting an insolvency application.

In 2017, Piramal Capital and Housing Finance entered into a loan agreement with GSTAAD Hotels and Neo Capricorn Plaza to extend a term loan facility of ₹600 crore. GSTAAD Hotels received a term loan of ₹450 crore and a rolling credit facility of ₹50 crore, while Neo Capricorn Plaza received a term loan of ₹100 crore.

A security trustee agreement was subsequently executed between Piramal Capital, the two companies and IDBI Trusteeship Services.

In 2021, IDBI Trusteeship approached NCLT's Mumbai bench to initiate insolvency proceedings against GSTAAD Hotels and Neo Capricorn Plaza. It later withdrew its petitions against both companies. In 2022, the lenders assigned their rights to recover the dues to Omkara Asset Reconstruction.

CITE EXPIRY OF HIS THREE-YEAR TERM

Tata Trusts Question Mehli Mistry's Right to Contest His Exit Record

SDTT & BHJTNCI ask dy charity commissioner to reject ex-trustee's objection to recording

Rashmi Rajput & Kala Vijayraghavan

Mumbai: Two Tata trusts asked the deputy charity commissioner of Mumbai to reject former trustee Mehli Mistry's objection to the recording of his exit from their boards, arguing that he was no longer qualified as a person having an interest in the trust and, therefore, has no legal right to challenge the change.

Both Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and Bai Hirabai Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution (BHJTNCI) denied allegations of illegality and irregularities in trustee appointments and decisions.

Separately, BHJTNCI filed an application before the deputy charity commissioner, seeking to replace its reporting trustee, Vijay Singh, with Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata. Mistry's counsel challenged the application.

Mistry approached the charity regulator after a resolution in October 2025 to reappoint him as a lifetime trustee of SDTT, the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) and other trusts did not pass as it did not get unanimous support from the trustees as required under local rules. Chairman Noel Tata and trustee Vijay Singh opposed his continuation.

TERM ENDED

The SDTT denied the allegation that the October 2025 resolution was invalid because of irregularities in the voting process. It said Mistry was appointed as a trustee for three years with effect from October 29, 2022.

The trust also argued that proceedings concerning a report filed before the charity commissioner on the change in trustees should be confined to determining whether his trusteeship ceased upon the expiry of his term, and could not be expanded to examine allegations concerning the composition of the board, the conduct of trustees or breaches of fiduciary duties.

Even if the resolution proposing his reappointment were held invalid, this would not automatically reinstate Mistry as his original tenure had expired, the trust argued.

It said Section 30A of the Maharashtra Public Trusts (MPT) Act, introduced through a 2025 amendment, left the decision on reappointment after the expiry of a trustee's term with the existing trustees.

The SDTT also denied allegations of unreported changes in its board composition. It said a report concerning the appointment of a trustee without tenure was accepted by the deputy charity commissioner on July 1, 2025. Venu Srinivasan's cessation as a trustee and his subsequent appointment for a three-year term, effective November 12, 2025, were reported in January 2026, it added.

CORE QUESTION

SDTT says proceedings should focus on whether Mistry's trusteeship ended with his term, not on wider allegations against the board/trustees

PARSI-ONLY CLAUSES

Mistry opposed an application by BHJTNCI seeking to replace its reporting trustee, Vijay Singh, with Noel Tata.

In written submissions dated October 15, Mistry's advocate argued the proposed substitute must satisfy the eligibility criteria prescribed under the trust deed dated December 7, 1923. Clauses 6 and 18 of the deed require a trustee to be a practising Zoroastrian of the Parsi faith, according to him. The counsel argued the substitution application should have been accompanied by an affidavit from Noel Tata declaring that he fulfilled the qualification.

The trust, in its response, also supported the eligibility of trustees Srinivasan and Singh, including questions relating to their religious affiliation.

Budget Smartphone Mkt Set For New Wave of Homegrown Brands

As global players facing high memory chip prices scale back, local cos see opportunity

Writankar Mukherjee

Kolkata: India's budget smartphone market is set for a fresh wave of homegrown challengers as rising memory chip prices force global players to pare their presence in the sub-₹20,000 segment, creating an opening for local companies to roll out affordable options for consumers.

After wearable brands Mivi and Boltt entered the sub-₹15,000 smartphone market through Flipkart, rivals Noise, boAt and GoBoult are exploring entry into the category and holding discussions with ecommerce marketplaces, three senior industry executives said.

The renewed interest follows early traction for brands such as Ai+ and Lava, while legacy players Karbonn and Micromax are also set to return to the market.

Karbonn is planning a festive-season relaunch, while Micromax is evaluating a return to smartphones, encouraged in part by the government's recent announcement of financial incentives under the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS), the executives said.

These Indian brands are betting on an online-first strategy to keep distribution and operating costs low, allowing them to price devices competitively against Chinese manufacturers and Samsung at a time when affordability is under pressure.

The opportunity is huge.

"The entry segment is where 80% of consumers lie," said Madhav Sheth, founder and chief executive of Ai+ Smartphone, which has already sold as many handsets in the first few weeks of this quarter as it did in the whole of last year.

Fresh Surge

After wearable brands **Mivi** and **Boltt entered the sub-₹15,000 smartphone market,** rivals **Noise, boAt** and **GoBoult also exploring entry into category**

New wave of Indian brands betting on an **online-first strategy to keep distribution,** operating costs low

Opening in the market emerged as memory chip prices surged, raising the cost of making entry-level smartphones

Memory components can account for about **40% of the bill of materials of budget handsets**

"Being an Indian brand, there are no royalty and profit pressures from overseas headquarters. So, pricing power is in our hands," Sheth said. Ai+ devices are priced between ₹10,000 and ₹25,000.

He said Ai+ has paved the way for other homegrown companies to compete against global giants. "However, this is not just an opportunity play. Indian brands have to focus on design, hardware, software and supply chain," he added.

Micromax founder and promoter Rajesh Agarwal said the company is examining its go-to-market strategy for re-entering the smartphone business across price points and channels. "The MPMS scheme is an opportunity that will provide some benefits," he said.

The MPMS scheme provides a 5% incentive for Indian brands and an additional incentive of 3% for Indian design and R&D, apart from non-fiscal support.

GoBoult co-founder Varun Gupta, however, denied any plans to enter smartphones. Noise co-founder Amit Khatri and boAt co-founder Aman Gupta did not respond to queries.

Market trackers such as Counterpoint Research estimate that Indian brands' combined smartphone market share could potentially double to 5-6%, as new entrants seek to leverage their established presence in wearables and accessories, where several have built strong consumer recognition.

Ecommerce marketplaces are also backing the new entrants with trade support and launch strategies, a senior industry executive said. Their interest comes as smartphone sales face pressure from successive price increases and a shrinking choice of models below ₹20,000, leaving a gap that domestic brands are now looking to fill.

Samsung, Oppo, Vivo and Xiaomi have reduced their exposure in the entry-level market as cost pressures mount, industry executives said.

Caller Name Display Mandatory from Nov 1

Govt issues directive to curb cyber fraud, unsolicited commercial communication

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has made it mandatory for telecom operators to display KYC-registered names alongside incoming callers' phone numbers from November 1, in a bid to curb cyber fraud, phishing and unsolicited commercial communication.

The DoT has amended the definition of Caller Line Identification (CLI) in the Unified Licence agreement governing telecom service providers to formally incorporate Caller Name Identification (CNAP), a service that automatically displays the caller's name on the recipient's screen.

The notification follows consultations with telecom operators and civil society groups, as well as trials conducted by operators. Handset makers have also been instructed to roll out software updates to support CNAP.

"All telecommunication service providers who hold authorisation or licence to provide access services are hereby instructed to introduce calling name presentation service in their telecommunication networks across all service areas with effect from 1.11.2026," the DoT said in an October 13 notification.

The initial rollout will cover wireless terrestrial networks using 4G and higher technologies. Implementation for legacy 2G and 3G networks and public switched telephone networks will be examined and decided separately, the DoT said.

Under the directive, the originating service provider must offer CNAP to all users without requiring an explicit request. The name displayed on the recipient's handset will be drawn from the Customer Application Form (CAF) submitted during Know Your Customer (KYC) verification.

To ensure privacy, users who do not want their names displayed can activate Caller Line Identification Restriction (CLIR). Businesses, meanwhile, can register a preferred name instead of an individual's name.

CNAP will also flag calls originating outside India with an 'international call' tag.

Sports World Play

VITALS

FIRST T20I

Mandhana Era Begins as India Take on Zimbabwe

Raipur: A new chapter in Indian women's cricket begins on Friday when Smriti Mandhana leads the team as full-time captain for the first time in the opening T20I against Zimbabwe, who are yet to win a match in the format this year. The match marks the start of Zimbabwe's first bilateral series against India, while the Shaheed Veer Narayan Singh International Stadium will host a women's international for the first time. Mandhana takes over from Harmanpreet Kaur after serving as vice-captain for almost a decade. Captaincy is not new to the 29-year-old, who has led Maharashtra in domestic cricket and guided Royal Challengers Bengaluru to two Women's Premier League titles. She has also captained India in 18 T20Is, winning 11 and losing six. Mandhana's elevation comes as she reaches the peak of her batting powers. IANS

7pm | Star Sports, JioHotstar

ASIAN GAMES REVIEW

Federations Told to Deliver After Medal Dip

New Delhi: India's lower-than-expected medal tally in high-yielding disciplines like athletics and badminton came under scrutiny at a Sports Ministry review of the country's Asian Games performance on Thursday, with questions raised about injured athletes travelling to the event. The meeting, chaired by Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, also focused on preparations for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. India won 85 medals, including 21 gold, at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, well short of the 106 medals it secured at the previous edition in Hangzhou, China. "The minister was very clear that there is no dearth of resources and the NSFs can no longer complain about financial support. The federations have to deliver," a senior official who attended the meeting told PTI. "There were no major fireworks per se. The federations presented their insights and the minister asked them to plan ahead," the official added. PTI

PSG Steal City's Show

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE The Parisians bring embattled Man City down to earth after pre-match demonstration of defiance

James Robson

Manchester City wowed fans with a spectacular fireworks show and a highlights reel of some of their greatest hits before Wednesday's Champions League clash with Paris Saint-Germain.

In what could be interpreted as a latest display of defiance from the embattled club — who have been found guilty of widespread financial wrongdoing — City produced a slick pre-match show reminding supporters of the good times with footage of their most iconic moments on the Etihad Stadium's big screens.

On the field, however, the highlights belonged to PSG in a blistering first-half performance, which saw the back-to-back European champions race to a 3-0 lead at the break.

And even if City mounted a spirited second-half fightback, a 4-2 loss brought the club down to earth after the triumphalism that some found off-putting in the wake of Sunday's 3-0 Premier League victory against Liverpool.

With former City manager Pep Guardiola watching on from the stands, PSG's first-half blitz sobered the atmosphere after the rousing pre-match show.

Désiré Doué, Ousmane Dembélé and Vitinha all scored and the defending champions created numerous other chances to extend their lead.

This was City's first home game since an independent panel found that they broke Premier League rules by artificially inflating their revenue by more than $1 billion over nearly a decade on their way to dominating English football. This was the first chance to put on a show of solidarity at their home stadium since the verdict.

The highlight reel included Sergio Aguero's famous title-winning goal in 2012 as well as other moments predating the Abu Dhabi takeover in 2008.

Despite the verdict, City have refused to be bowed and the win against Liverpool was evidence their players could put the outside noise to one side and focus on the field.

PSG, however, was different story. Another club that has benefited wildly from investment from the Middle East through their Qatari backers, the French giants have built the finest team in Europe and lived up to that billing by sweeping City aside in the first half.

RESULTS

LASK Linz	3 – 6	Liverpool
AS Roma	3 – 4	Real Madrid
Aston Villa	6 – 0	Fenerbahce
Bodo/Glimt	1 – 0	Dortmund
Man City	2 – 4	PSG

Real Madrid forward Vinicius Junior has been banned for four matches, including the "clasico" against Barcelona, after pulling the hair of an opponent in Saturday's 1-0 win over Villarreal

It was the type of performance to suggest they are capable of a Champions League three-peat, emulating the all-time king of Europe Real Madrid.

At the break it felt like City could be on the end of a humbling defeat. However, Enzo Maresca's team managed to turn a would-be rout into a thrilling clash.

Erling Haaland scored two goals, two efforts came back off the woodwork and another chance was cleared off the line.

Maghnes Aklioucheˆ's goal, in between Haaland's, ensured there would be no comeback and Ferran Torres then failed to score a fifth for the visitors from the penalty spot. AP

Madrid Stun Roma With Late Comeback

Jose Mourinho enjoyed a Roma reunion to remember as Real Madrid completed an astonishing comeback by scoring three late goals to claim a 4-3 away win in the Champions League on Wednesday. Marten de Roon gave the hosts a deserved opener before Kylian Mbappe struck back on his 100th Champions League appearance to level the scores. Two Donyell Malen strikes in the space of six minutes early in the second half seemed to take the game away from Real as Roma ran rampant. But Real scored three goals in the final six minutes, all stemming from corners, to turn the game on its head as Carlos Espi, Endrick and ex-Roma defender Antonio Rudiger struck at a stunned Stadio Olimpico. AFP

PSG's Maghnes Aklioucheˆ scores his side's fourth goal against Man City AP

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THE ECONOMIC TIMES
ET Panache

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ADVERTORIAL &
PROMOTIONAL FEATURE

Baby on board
Actress Hilary Swank, 52, has announced on social media that she is expecting her third child in December

Building self-reliant teams

Business coach Ameet Parekh reveals that teams follow up on their own when ownership is clear

etpanache@timesofindia.com

"I have to follow up on every single task myself." Business coach Ameet Parekh says he hears this complaint from business owners in every trade and it wears them down.

The owner gives an instruction in the morning and checks on it at noon. Nothing moves unless they push it. When they finally lose their temper, the work moves quickly for a day and then slows again.

Why teams wait

"When the owner has to chase every task, the team is usually waiting for clarity, not avoiding work," says Parekh. In most such businesses, nobody knows exactly what they own, what result is expected or when it is due, and the only tracking system is the owner himself. The more the owner chases, the less the team takes responsibility.

Find out what to fix first over one morning session
'Business Scale-Up Blueprint' led in person by Ameet Parekh on Sunday, November 1 at Novotel, Mumbai International Airport
Leave with a written list of what to fix first or get a full refund of ₹1,499 back the same day. Only 100 tickets for owners who are serious about fixing their business, not a crowd. Bring business figures from the last three months.
Can't make it? Transfer your seat up to 48 hours before the event.
Book a seat: Scan the QR code

For example, a gynaecologic laparoscopic surgeon who runs a multi-specialty hospital in Jaipur wanted to solve her challenge of staff management. The hospital wasn't tracking impact. There were no MIS reports or patient information systems; the balance sheets weren't ready; and patients came mainly as walk-ins and referrals. Revenue was stuck at around ₹30–35 lakh a month.

Working with Parekh, she compiled all the data. She then created departments for sales, marketing, accounts and HR, each with a proper hierarchy and tracked through an MIS. The sales team defined KRAs and KPIs. SOPs improved patient experience. Average monthly revenue has now doubled to about ₹70 lakh. The surgeon says the staff is now more self-reliant and aligned, freeing her from day-to-day operations.

"An owner should lead his team, not chase it"

Ameet Parekh has worked with over 2,00,000 business owners in 15 years

Parekh with business owners at one of his sessions

Edited excerpts from a conversation with Parekh:

Why do teams wait to be chased?

Because they have been trained to. If the business owner always follows up, people learn that the real deadline is when he calls. Change that, and most of the chasing disappears.

What should an owner do first?

Take the 10 tasks you chased most last week. For each one, write down who owns it, what a finished result looks like, and by when. Agree on one fixed time each day when the team reports progress without being asked and for two weeks follow up only through that list. You will soon see who needs training and who simply needed to know what was expected. In most teams, it is the second.

Malaysian tycoon eyes $760-million deal in Singapore

Malaysian property tycoon Lee Yeow Seng is making waves as one of the most aggressive buyers of commercial real estate in Singapore, and he's not done yet.

His IOI Properties Group is in exclusive talks and due diligence to purchase two property assets — Chijmes, a retail venue inside a former Catholic convent in its civic district, and the nearby Capitol Kempinski hotel, chief executive officer Lee said in an interview. He declined to disclose how much a final agreement will value the two assets at, citing ongoing negotiations.

Catching up

Singapore developer Perennial Holdings has been trying to sell the Kempinski hotel, which was being marketed for about S$600 million ($468 million), according to people familiar with the matter. Chijmes was valued at S$379 million ($295 million) in 2025.

"I'm a latecomer and I want to catch up with the rest," the 47-year-old CEO said on the sidelines of an event in Singapore recently. "Most of them don't share the vision of me."

Lee's Malaysia-listed firm, which has a large presence in its home country including one of the world's largest malls, has splashed out on a range of Singapore properties in recent years. It gained full control of South Beach, an office complex that also houses his luxury penthouse and the JW Marriott hotel, after buying the majority stake from partner City Developments, which was looking to reduce debt. More recently, it bought office building Asia Square Tower 2, ballooning his commercial portfolio to S$10 billion ($7.85 billion).

PICS: GETTY IMAGES, AP

Chijmes is a historic building complex in Singapore

Lee Yeow Seng is more optimistic about real estate prospects in Singapore than Hong Kong

Positive outlook

In 2024, IOI's board rebuffed a proposal by Lee to acquire Shenton House in Singapore, amid concerns about heavy capital commitments in Singapore and Malaysia. Lee, who is a scion of a wealthy palm oil family in Malaysia, made the purchase on his own.

Lee is more optimistic about real estate prospects in Singapore than rival financial hub Hong Kong, saying the former doesn't have the baggage of being fully absorbed back into China in 2047 and will continue to be favoured by the wealthy and global companies.

"If I can expand, why should I hold myself back?" he said. "No one has asked me to slow down."

– Bloomberg

Willem de Kooning gets a 'homecoming'

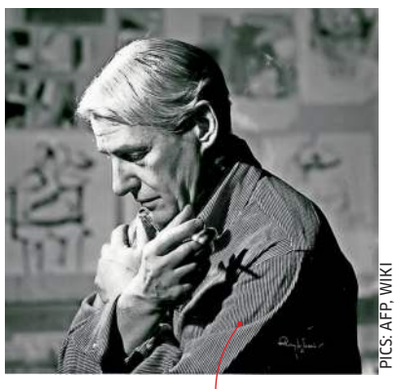
'Woman I'

'Woman and Bicycle'

When young Dutch artist Willem de Kooning stowed away on a US-bound cargo ship in 1926, little did he know he would become one of modern art's most iconic figures.

Now, a century later, De Kooning joins Dutch masters such as Van Gogh and Rembrandt at Amsterdam's Rijksmuseum for the biggest European exhibition of his work in more than 40 years.

De Kooning was part of a group of New York artists that pioneered a style known as 'abstract expressionism' in the 1930s and 1940s, said the exhibition's curator Marian Cousijn. His works, at first glance abstract, almost always feature figurative elements, often linked to the human body, using charcoal or paint with elements of collage or rubbing.



PICS: AFP, WIKI

"It was called abstract expressionism, but for De Kooning, it was never really 100 per cent abstract," said Cousijn. "He would always return to the human figure."

Well-earned place

In his work 'Woman' (1950), which forms part of the exhibition, one can make out the silhouette of a woman, while the mouth — taken from a cigarette advert — has been cut out and stuck on. In 'Excavations' (1950), forms of birds, fish, human noses, eyes and teeth mingle together with a broader abstract picture.

While a direct link between De Kooning and Dutch masters is not evident at first sight, Cousijn said the modern artist deserves his place.

After several years living in New York, the Dutch painter became a US citizen in 1962. He died in 1997 in East Hampton, New York, at the age of 92. Featuring more than 120 works, the exhibition 'Willem de Kooning at work' opened on October 9 and runs until January 17, 2027.

– AFP

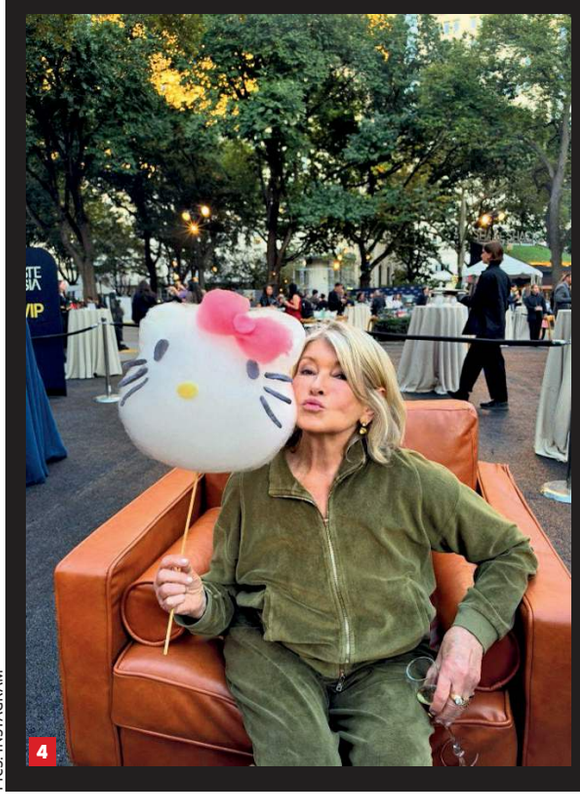
C-sweet life

From car showcases with high-profile guests to AI-ordered watermelons, here's a look at what some of the world's top bosses have been up to beyond the boardroom.

1

2

1. Exor CEO and Stellantis and Ferrari chairman John Elkann and French President Emmanuel Macron take a closer look at the cars from the comfort of the driver's seat at the Paris Motor Show.
2. Evan Spiegel and wife Miranda Kerr beamed as the Snap CEO received the George HW Bush Points of Light Award for his philanthropic work.
3. Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg lets AI take care of business – and apparently, his fruit cravings too, with an autonomous AI agent ordering him watermelon.
4. TV personality and businesswoman Martha Stewart embraced her playful side with a Hello Kitty balloon, casually captioning her post 'Hello Martha!'.



4

3

PICS: INSTAGRAM

quote unquote

"I try to continue to learn from the players because I just arrived three months ago, but the feeling at the moment is very good."

– ENZO MARESCA, manager of Manchester City, after losing 4-2 to title-holders Paris Saint-Germain in the Champions League on October 14, despite putting up a tough challenge. It was City's first home game since being found guilty on more than 100 charges of financial impropriety in the Premier League. Until then, Maresca had made a perfect start to the challenge of replacing Pep Guardiola by winning his first eight games in all competitions.

PIC: AFP

PICS: INSTAGRAM, MATEL

$93

The approximate price for a doll modelled after singer Céline Dion. The doll is inspired by the Canadian artiste performing the song, *'My Heart Will Go On'* from *Titanic* at the 1998 Oscars and is even complete with the 'Heart of the Ocean' necklace. Dion made her comeback last month in Paris, after a four-year hiatus, despite living with stiff-person syndrome, an incurable but treatable condition.

"I'm not afraid of storms, for I am learning how to sail my ship." – LOUISA MAY ALCOTT

The great barrier relief

Frequent flyer? Experts share skincare tips for business travellers to keep their skin fresh, even at 30,000 feet

Shannika Ramos

The first sign of a long-haul flight isn't always the jet lag. Sometimes, it's the face looking back at you in the mirror. An oily T-zone, puffy eye bags, dullness and redness? You've got yourself a case of 'flight face'. "Aircraft cabins maintain significantly lower humidity levels than what our skin is naturally accustomed to," says Dr Garima Tyagi, a dermatologist at SENS Clinic. "This dry environment accelerates moisture loss from the skin, causing it to feel tight and dehydrated even during short flights."

Why does my face look tired?

The transition from a warm and humid climate to the arid cabin atmosphere can make dehydration and barrier disruption more pronounced, potentially affecting the skin's natural pH balance. "Prolonged exposure to air conditioning, limited water intake and extended periods without applying moisturiser further intensifies a sense of dryness," explains Dr Tyagi.

Cabin air drops below 20 per cent humidity, which strips moisture rapidly from the outer layer of the skin. This leads to dehydration of the skin, which further segues into excess oil production. Sleep disruption and high cortisol worsens skin conditions which makes us look tired.

Carry-on essentials

Dr Supriya Punyani, head of R&D, Hindustan Unilever, South Asia says, "The goal is to help skin stay resilient despite changes in humidity, climate and routine." And social media has been instrumental in accelerating this visibility, says Ashwini Rao, vice-president at Lakmé India, stating that consumers now view travel skin protection as "a practical necessity rather than an indulgence".

Sometimes, the best remedy is often just simplifying your routine. A hydrating moisturiser and lip balm are far more useful than a 10-step routine. Sunscreen remains non-negotiable for day-time flights; the American Academy of Dermatology recommends broad-spectrum, water-resistant SPF 30+. Between compact cabin bags, limited liquid allowances and increasingly crowded toiletry bags, carrying a full-sized beauty arsenal is also not practical.

Travel tricks

So how can one maintain a healthy skin barrier while also ensuring that their skin is well-hydrated on a flight? "Travel with a clean and moisturised face. Carry a travel-sized hydrating face-mist, an all-purpose moisturiser for your body and face and eye-drops for dry eyes. For an extra tip, lip balms soothe dry nostrils and flaky cuticles since cabin air can get quite dry and cold" says Jovita George, a beauty, fashion and travel creator.

And since the cabin air already places enough stress on the skin, it is advisable to avoid irritating ingredients such as strong retinoids, exfoliating acids and heavy toners while flying, says Dr Tyagi. And most of all, travel with a collected and relaxed state of mind. Plenty of hydration and a few carry-on essentials can ensure that by the time you land, your skin feels refreshed, cared for and ready for the boardroom.

– shannika.ramos@timesofindia.com

AI GENERATED

South Korean actor Lee Min-ho always carries lotion, SPF and hand cream while travelling

Actress Nicola Coughlan has said that she always moisturises her face, neck and under-eye area during travel

A better way to hit the books

Experts offer guidance on helping children study without academic pressure and stress

PIC: GETTY IMAGES

With end-semester exams looming, you won't need to ask your child how they're feeling. The signs are usually unmistakable: Longer hours at the desk and more frequent study sessions.

If your child is dreading a midterm — or just studying hard to keep up in class — chances are that their study habits probably involve taking notes as they're reading and then going back over them.

Social media is full of study hacks that don't have much impact. Chewing gum or smelling essential oils to stimulate the brain while studying doesn't work, and neither does listening to music, said Pooja K Agarwal, a US-based cognitive psychologist and author.

Rather than doing what comes easy, Rober Bjork, professor emeritus of cognitive psychology at UCLA, US, said that students learn better if they create small mental challenges.

This helps to strengthen neuronal connections, which makes it easier to retrieve the information later.

Tips and tricks

"Engaging in that mental struggle, that desirable difficulty, helps with long-term learning," Agarwal said. "It's one of the most powerful learning and teaching strategies based on research, both in the laboratory and in the classroom."

Before sitting with them to review the information during a study session, ask them to take a minute to think about what they had learned. Ask them to write down everything they can remember, which Agarwal calls a "brain dump".

parent thesis

Then, ask them, "What was most challenging about this when you were learning it the first time? "It's a way to level up retrieval practice for an added boost," Agarwal said. "The more you build connections, the richer your learning."

And stop them from pulling all-nighters. One aspect of better learning that isn't a study strategy is a good night's sleep, which helps consolidate memories you've created during the day, said Henry Roediger, a cognitive psychology professor at Washington University, US.

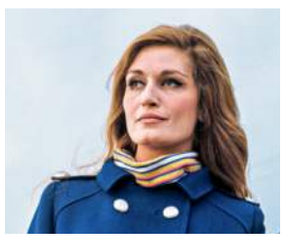
– AP

my picks

Karima Ben Abdelmalek,
CEO, happn,
dives deep to clear her head

Movie
WHAT THE DAY OWES THE NIGHT. I'VE WATCHED IT TOO MANY TIMES. IT'S THE STORY OF AN IMPOSSIBLE LOVE AND THE DUALITY OF TWO DESTINIES.

Music
I LOVE '*LAISSEZ-MOI DANSER*' BY DALIDA BECAUSE THIS SONG BREATHES FREEDOM, AND IN LIFE, FREEDOM IS PRICELESS. I ALSO LOVE TCHAIKOVSKY'S *'SWAN LAKE'*. AS A FORMER VIOLINIST IT DEEPLY RESONATES WITH ME.



Brands
I ADORE WATCHES. IT'S A USEFUL PIECE OF JEWELLERY – THOUGH IT DOESN'T STOP ME FROM BEING LATE.

Book
NO RULES RULES BY REED HASTINGS – THIS BOOK WILL DO GOOD FOR ANY ENTREPRENEUR.

Sport
I ENJOY SWIMMING BECAUSE I LOVE THE CONTACT WITH WATER, IT HELPS ME CLEAR MY HEAD.

Restaurant
LA PLUME IN PARIS FOR ITS 2000 FEUILLE IN PARTICULAR. IT'S EXQUISITE. THE VIEW OVER THE PARIS ROOFTOPS IS EXCEPTIONAL AND ROMANTIC.

Holiday
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– As told to **glynda.alves@timesofindia.com**

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ancient relics

Sunken silk road city reveals lost history

Researchers hope that their findings will improve the understanding of Central Asia's heritage

The sun had barely risen, but diving volunteer Elizaveta Bodrova was already raring to plunge into the cold waters of Lake Issyk-Kul, where the ruins of a once-thriving city have lain submerged for centuries.

Situated on an ancient trading route between China and Europe, little is known about the history of the settlement under Kyrgyzstan's largest lake or how it came to be flooded an estimated 800 years ago.

Together with a team of around 20 scientists, they are helping uncover its past, findings that could shape our understanding of the history of Central Asia and beyond.

"The visibility isn't very good today, but I hope we'll still be able to find the boundary of the settlement," Bodrova said with a smile, before hopping off a motorboat into the depths below.

'Blind spot'

The settlement is located at the heart of what was once the Silk Road, a trading route that linked China to the Mediterranean from the second century BC until the mid-15th century.

"This is actually a blind spot in history, even though it is right in the centre of Central Asia," the expedition director Maxim Menshikov said of the ruins.

"It is a very important chapter in the history of humankind, because it was the period that linked East and West during the Middle Ages. The Silk Road is not merely the history of a single region, it is the history of Eurasia as a whole," he added.

Researchers believe the city, the name and population of which are not known, may have covered up to five square kilometres. Accurately dating the remains has been difficult.

But traces of two cemeteries discovered at the site suggest they were built during the early Islamisation of the region.

Among the discovered remains was a decorated public building, possibly a mosque, public bath or religious school.

Like Pompeii

After several hours scouring the lakebed, the divers returned to dry land with their spoils: The remains of animal bones and pottery shards.

"The bones that have been found will enable archaeologists to determine their diet and age of the remains, as well as the diet of the people who lived in this region," said Viktor Pozdnyakov, a diver and laboratory assistant on the expedition team.

"The pottery will enable us to date the finds and determine the approximate period more precisely. And, of course, to understand where it was produced, how and by what method," the 22-year-old added.

Back at base, the artefacts are carefully preserved, catalogued and recorded.

Although known to researchers since the 19th century, the site has only been systematically explored in recent years by Russian and Kyrgyz teams.

The researchers hope their work will improve understanding of Central Asian history.

"You could compare this research to that of Pompeii," said Menshikov, referring to the largely preserved ruins of an ancient Roman city buried by an eruption of Mount Vesuvius in 79 AD.

What submerged the city under Issyk-Kul remains a mystery.

Among the theories is that the settlement sank to the bottom of the lake following a landslide, or that it was gradually flooded by a 'tectonic dam' – a natural damming of a water body that could have occurred following an earthquake.

– AFP

Artefacts discovered on the river bed of Lake Issyk-Kul

PICS: GETTY IMAGES, AFP

"In wildness is the preservation of the world." – HENRY DAVID THOREAU

shore thing

PICS: AI GENERATED

Why sea sanctuaries aren't the answer

Previous attempts show that huge ocean pens are not a blanket solution for rescued dolphins and whales

Sanctuaries may seem like the easiest solution for displaced whales and dolphins — called cetaceans collectively — but that may not be the case.

A cetacean sanctuary is an ocean net enclosure providing animals with a large habitat, emphasising no breeding, reduced human interaction and non-profit funding. But there are currently none operating under these standards. Moving a cetacean that was born in or has spent years in human care into an unfamiliar sea pen can create several challenges.

A form of captivity

Consider a dolphin born in a pool and accustomed to humans, a familiar social group and medical care. Moving it to an ocean enclosure changes conditions such as water chemistry, ocean sounds, currents and weather substantially. Porous netting may expose cetaceans to new pathogens, parasites or unfamiliar species. They could even become entangled with no way to rescue them. Daily veterinary care is also more complicated in a 100-acre sea pen.

Animal welfare depends on many factors: Health, social relationships, nutrition, cognitive stimulation, environmental predictability. Caregivers cannot assume that what is natural to animals born or housed under human care is the same as what is natural to a wild animal.

Past attempts

Historically, cetacean sanctuaries have struggled to get off the ground. After 10 years, The Whale Sanctuary Project in Canada is still trying to raise funding and hasn't built its 100-acre sea pen. Dolphin Project founder Ric O'Barry's sanctuary in Bali, Indonesia, attempted to house four animals taken from the Melka Excelsior Hotel. However, one animal died soon after arriving and another died after a release attempt.

Sea Life Trust Beluga Whale Sanctuary has made multiple attempts to place two belugas from a Chinese aquarium into an Iceland sanctuary. However, a 2025 review reported that both spent 92.6 per cent of their time in a conventional indoor pool. While in the sanctuary, they exhibited stress behaviours and had feeding difficulties, with one animal even developing ulcers. These examples demonstrate that these enclosures are hard to develop, fund, manage and that animals don't adapt readily.

Measuring welfare

In the Cetacean Welfare Study, to measure welfare, researchers studied over 200 individual animals across three species in 43 accredited zoos and aquariums and assessed how the animals' social environment, training, habitat and enrichment affected their well-being. Larger habitats did not predict good welfare. Who the animals socialised with — both human and cetacean — and the diversity of enrichment approaches were much better indicators.

Best practices suggest that these decisions should be based on individual assessments. Before a non-emergency transfer, professionals establish the animal's baseline health, behaviour, relationships and stress measures, then track those individual measures afterwards.

If sanctuaries have definable metrics of success, the public, outside researchers and accreditation groups can all follow their progress toward their welfare goals. Sanctuaries, as a concept, are not inherently good or bad. Just like in any other animal welfare intervention, proponents will need to show proof that they can work•

– AP

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"Money is like muck, not good except it be spread." – FRANCIS BACON

IT'S ALL IN THE FAMILY for the Vanderbilts

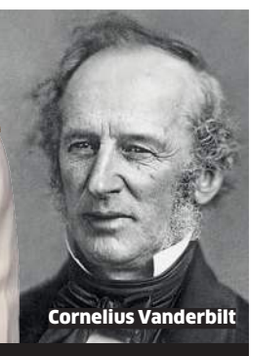
There are over 800 descendants of the family, but their wealth isn't consolidated. One woman aims to change that

Consuelo Vanderbilt Costin is 100 years and six generations removed from the man who built one of America's most storied fortunes. But she is still building a family office that will one day serve as a financial nexus for his 800-plus descendants.

Costin's new investment firm, House of Vanderbilt, comprises just her money for now, but she's aiming to draw in other families as co-investors, including her relatives, most of whom she doesn't know. "We share an extraordinary history," said Costin, 47. "[We] can create a new point of connection around many of the qualities that built that legacy."

The investment firm's portfolio includes SohoMuse, a networking site for models, actors and other creatives, and a business accelerator that works in the fashion sector. Next up are more investments in fashion and technology.

To run House of Vanderbilt, Costin has hired Julia Valentine, former head of operations at Mousse Partners, the family office for the founders of Chanel. Its advisory board includes former ESPN president John Skipper and Salvatore Ferragamo Jr of the Italian shoe dynasty.



Cornelius Vanderbilt

Costin declined to share how much money House of Vanderbilt currently manages or her net worth. The size of the clan's current fortune is unclear and estimating it is difficult, given the amount the time that's passed and the number of branches that trace their lineage back to the 19th century tycoon.

Rise and fall

After Vanderbilt's death, most of his estate was left to his son William. In terms of the country's economic output for the time, Vanderbilt's $100 million would be worth about $373 billion today, making him richer than anybody else, save Elon Musk.

But generational wealth wasn't a priority for Vanderbilt, said Eric Schoenberg, a lecturer at Columbia University, US. "He didn't really believe in the idea of a family fortune. He thought the point of surplus money was power, and splitting the money up would dilute that," he said.

Though William managed to double the family's fortune, the third generation were prolific spenders, building opulent mansions on New York's Fifth Avenue and in Newport, Rhode Island.

Journalist Anderson Cooper, who's a descendent of the Vanderbilts, described his family's inherited wealth as a kind of "pathology" that warped future generations and normalised reckless spending.

Best practices

John D Rockefeller formed what's considered the first family office in the early 1880s to consolidate and manage his investments, creating a concept that's been copied thousands of times since. The idea is to structure a family's assets and defend against the wealth erosion that occurs as money filters down through successive heirs.

But even then, the Rockefellers weren't immune: They're absent from the ranks of world's richest families today.

The Rockefellers were Costin's inspiration when she conceived House of Vanderbilt. Rockefeller Capital Management, a multi-family office formed in 2019, is responsible for $224 billion in client assets, only a sliver of which is the Rockefellers'.

"Family offices are hot, no doubt a further sign of the new gilded age," Schoenberg said. "But like most things humans do, I think it's very faddish. People do it because they think it's 'cool' or that they're supposed to have one without really considering whether it suits their individual situation and goals."

Family legacy

Costin was born to Serena Vanderbilt Van Ingen McCallum, a photographer and life coach, and Brackenridge Costin, also a life coach. Raised in London, her first career was in music, and she drew on her family history for material.

Her experiences trying to navigate the complexities of publishing rights and learning to advocate for herself in the music business led her to founding SohoMuse. She also designed a jewellery line inspired by Vanderbilt heirlooms.

Costin said she's using an outsourced CIO firm to lead investment decisions. For now, her focus is her brand. She's signed with talent agency WME to explore ways to bring the story of the Vanderbilts, who she calls "the most quiet" of the storied industrialist dynasties, to new audiences. "My hope is that House of Vanderbilt can broaden the way people think about the Vanderbilt name," she said. "The best way to honour a legacy is to continue creating one."•

– Bloomberg

The now-demolished Cornelius Vanderbilt II House was built in New York City in 1883

PICS: GETTY IMAGES, WIKI

Sally Rooney book sales banned from the UK

Irish novelist Sally Rooney said on October 14 that her books are being withdrawn from sale in the UK because of her support for Palestine Action, a protest group the British government has outlawed as a terrorist organisation. Her publisher, Faber, confirmed that, due to the ban, it "cannot pass on UK earnings to Rooney".

"To sell a writer's work and not be able to pass on earnings is an unconscionable situation for a publisher. As such, and in full agreement with Sally, we have taken the decision that we can no longer supply her works in the U.K. in any format," Faber said in a statement.

"I have made every effort to be honest with the public about my beliefs and intentions, and I am wholly prepared to accept the consequences," Rooney said.

Rooney, 35, is the critically praised author of novels like *Conversations with Friends*, *Normal People*, *Intermezzo* and *Beautiful World, Where are You*. Both *Conversations with Friends* and *Normal People* were adapted for television.

"I have made every effort to be honest ...and I am wholly prepared to accept the consequences"

A strong supporter of Palestinian causes, she wrote in *The Irish Times* in August 2025: "I too support Palestine Action. If this makes me a 'supporter of terror' under UK law, so be it."

She said she would use proceeds from her novels and TV fees to continue to support the group. Britain's government outlawed Palestine Action after activists broke into a Royal Air Force base in June 2025 to protest British military support for Israel's military offensive in Gaza.

Civil liberties groups say the ban and subsequent arrests unjustifiably restrict the rights to protest and free speech. Lawyers for Palestine Action will ask the UK Supreme Court next month to overturn the ban•

– AP

PIC: REUTERS

Colombo's storied beach shack at risk

The famed seafood restaurant has hosted the likes of Princess Anne and Richard Branson

The Beach Wadiya shack in Colombo, Sri Lanka, has hosted cricket legends, politicians, even royal family members. But it's facing an uncertain future.

"Beach Wadiya comes with a lot of history," said Suhara Chandrasekera, director of the restaurant. More than half a century after it opened, glamour is giving way to grief. The Coast Conservation and Coastal Resource Management Department has given Wadiya 10 days to pack up. That deadline expired and the shack has taken the matter to court.

Legal reprieve

Sri Lankan authorities prohibit buildings within 10 metres of the shoreline. A few other shops near Wadiya were demolished, and Environment Minister Dammika Patabendi said they have identified 82 buildings in all that might face the same fate.

But Wadiya's owners, the Weerasekera family, argued that the restaurant has existed before the 1981 Coast Conservation Act being used to evict them. "We built in 1974, which predates the law that they were talking about... We have permits dating all the way back to 1974," said Chandrasekera, the founder's granddaughter. The family has won a temporary reprieve, with a court ordering the department not to demolish the restaurant for two weeks.

Princess Anne had dinner at Wadiya in 1995, while members of the Nepali royal family have also dined there. British tycoon Richard Branson visited the restaurant during a holiday in 1992. Indian and Pakistani cricketers, including Sachin Tendulkar, Rahul Dravid and Wasim Akram, have visited when touring Sri Lanka•

– AFP

Rare Dodge breaks down price barriers

Matchbox cars in pristine condition made from the 1950s to the 1980s, with their original boxes, have long been sought after. The Dodge has become something of a unicorn in a reverse green-and-yellow colour scheme, a variation from the factory that was not supposed to reach the public.

Its toy incarnation was designed by Jack Odell in the 1960s and provided enjoyment for the countless millions of kids who owned one, its red plastic tow hook able to haul another stricken model into their imaginary garage.

Specialists Vectis Auctions have recently sold one for 13,500 pounds ($17,892) — a 9,000 per cent increase on its original retail price.

These 'colour trial' versions, usually made in small handfuls for appraisal by Matchbox bosses and distributors, are the pinnacle of finds for dedicated collectors.

Vectis also sold a Matchbox Mercury Cougar in January, experimentally painted cream by the factory in 1969, for 22,000 pounds — more than the full-sized classic car itself is worth•

– Daily Mirror

A rare car toy in a reverse colour scheme

PIC: VECTIS AUCTIONS

120 million pounds

PICS: AP, GETTY IMAGES

The amount of money the Joe Lewis family is injecting into Tottenham Hotspur, continuing their strategy of heavily investing in the London-based football club.

The family will buy new shares in ENIC Sports, the Bahamas-based parent company that holds a roughly 88 per cent stake. The money is being earmarked for general working capital. The injection brings the family's total investment in the club over the past year to 320 million pounds. That includes 100 million pounds over the summer to help improve the squad ahead of the current season. The family owns about 73 per cent of ENIC•

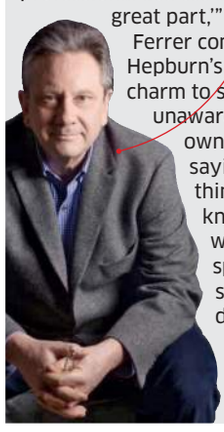
PICS: INTIMATE AUDREY, WIKI

Audrey Hepburn wanted to be a ballerina

Audrey Hepburn was a global icon and one of the biggest names ever to work in Hollywood, but the actress never expected stardom and didn't even realise what a big deal she was, her son Sean Hepburn Ferrer has said.

Ferrer, who co-authored Hepburn's biography, told *People* magazine that his mother's original dream was to become a ballerina. However, after the hardships of World War II, due to which her nutrition and training were impacted severely, she turned to acting, he revealed.

"I guess she never really expected it to happen the way it did. She always said, 'I was not a professional actress and I got a great part,'" he added.



Ferrer compared Hepburn's natural charm to someone unaware of their own beauty, saying, "I don't think she ever knew that she was that special, and so, she just did the best she could," he said•

– ANI

CON ARTISTS

The New York Comic Con celebrated its 20th anniversary earlier this month. Attendees dressed as iconic characters from books, video games and films. Here's who was spotted on the floor

Jeff the Land Shark and Emma Frost from *Marvel Comics*

Selena Corey, *Resident Evil*

Zev, *Dungeon Crawler Carl*

Nikki Freeman, *Obsession*

Caitlyn, *Arcane*, and Mr Tenna, *Deltarune*

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Wholesome Gujarati thalis with a touch of Rajasthan @ Shree Thaker Bhojanalay

Shree Thaker Bhojanalay, established in 1945, is renowned for serving one of the most authentic and wholesome Gujarati thalis with a touch of Rajasthan in the city.

With a legacy of tradition, purity and warm hospitality, this restaurant offers an unlimited thali experience featuring more than 30 items in one meal, freshly prepared every day in a clean and hygienic way.

From delightful farsans, flavourful vegetables, rich dals and kadhi, with seven different kinds of rotis and indulgent sweets, every item is meticulously crafted using age-old, home-style recipes passed down through generations. What sets them apart is not just the food, but the warmth with which it is served, making every guest feel at home. The thali here is more than a meal; it's a cultural experience that reflects the richness of Gujarati and Rajasthani traditions. Loved by locals, appreciated by celebrities, and recommended by global and Indian Michelin star chefs, Shree Thaker Bhojanalay continues to win hearts by delivering soulful flavours, following hygienic practices and a fulfilling dining experience.

For more details, contact:
Shree Thaker Bhojanalay,
Building No. 31, Purshottam Niwas, Dadiseth Agiyari Lane, Marine Lines (E), Kalbadevi,
Call: 022 2206 9916.
Instagram: @shreethakerbhojanala

BlueBop Cafe: A Mumbai Dining Story that Continues to Evolve

Since opening in 2019, BlueBop Cafe on Linking Road, Khar, has carved a distinctive space in Mumbai's culinary landscape. Known for Italian-American comfort food, handcrafted cocktails, in-house bakery BlueBop Bakes, and warm hospitality, the brand has built a loyal following over seven years.

Quality remains at its core, with sauces, doughs, dips, breads and desserts crafted in-house from scratch using carefully sourced ingredients. Live jazz and classic rock every Friday night bring together food, music and people.

Recently shortlisted for the Times 50 Best Restaurants in India, BlueBop marks another milestone in its journey. With multiple industry accolades and continued love from its customers, BlueBop Cafe continues to evolve and grow, expanding into new formats while staying true to its distinctive identity and warm hospitality.

For more details, contact:
BlueBop Cafe
Address : 318, Linking Road, Khar West, Mumbai – 400052
Call for reservations
+91 9372202586

Trishna: A Timeless Icon of Mumbai's Seafood Heritage

Trishna is one of Mumbai's most iconic seafood restaurants, located in the heart of Kala Ghoda, Fort. For decades, it has been celebrated for its fresh seafood, signature Butter Pepper Garlic Crab and authentic coastal flavours. Trishna has earned a loyal following for its warm, unpretentious dining experience and unwavering commitment to quality.

A favourite among locals, celebrities, food enthusiasts and visitors from across the world, the restaurant represents the timeless charm of Mumbai's culinary heritage. Its menu brings together the finest catch of the day with carefully crafted preparations that allow the natural flavours of the seafood to shine. From succulent crabs and prawns to fresh fish and traditional coastal specialities, every dish reflects Trishna's philosophy of simplicity, consistency and exceptional ingredients. Over the years, Trishna has remained true to its roots while becoming a celebrated name on Mumbai's Culinary map.

For more details, contact:
Trishna
Sai Baba Marg, Next to Commerce House, Opposite Kala Ghoda Cafe, Kala ghoda -Fort, Mumbai- 400001
Call: +91 9206 260 260
+91 8879303945
Instagram- trishnamumbai
trishna.rest@yahoo.com

The Intimacy of the 12-Seater

The era of cavernous dining halls is giving way to radical intimacy. India's most coveted reservations are no longer large banquet-style restaurants, but exclusive 10-to-14-seat chef's counters. Diners sit shoulder-to-shoulder, watching dishes assembled in real time while engaging directly with the creators. This format strips away hospitality's traditional stiffness, transforming dinner into dynamic theatre. With no barrier between kitchen and guest, menus change spontaneously based on morning market finds, offering an unscripted, personalised culinary performance that cannot be replicated at scale.

From Matcha to Hojicha: Why Japanese Tea is Having its Biggest Food Trend Moment Yet

For the past few years, cafe menus and social media feeds have been held firmly in an emerald-green grip. From cloud-topped iced lattes and vibrant strawberry purees to tiered cheesecakes, crinkle cookies, and even savory broths, matcha broke out of the quiet confines of traditional tea rooms to become a modern lifestyle fixture. Yet just as we learned to pronounce terms like ceremonial grade and mastered the art of bamboo whisking, another Japanese tea quietly stepped into the spotlight: hojicha.

While both teas originate from the same plant, Camellia sinensis, their personalities could hardly be more different. Matcha is bright, grassy, and intensely green; hojicha is roasted, mellow, and almost dessert-like. As dining culture continues to embrace distinctive global profiles, the question is no longer just whether you like tea, it is which mood suits your palate.

MATCHA: THE VIBRANT ICON

Matcha is made by stone-grinding shade-grown green tea leaves into an ultra-fine powder. Because the powder is whisked directly into water rather than steeped, you consume the entire leaf. This gives matcha its vivid colour, robust body, and high concentration of both caffeine and antioxidants (polyphenols). While it packs significantly more energy than standard green tea, it still delivers a gentler, more sustained lift than coffee.

Its flavour profile is unmistakably vegetal. High-grade matcha tastes fresh, subtly sweet, umami-rich, and grassy, rounded out by a gentle, lingering astringency. That profile makes it remarkably versatile: creamy dairy or plant milks soften its sharper edges, while strawberry, mango, coconut, and white chocolate complement its natural sweetness.

Beyond specialty cafes, matcha has become a staple of home kitchens, starring in everyday iced lattes, baked treats, and breakfast bowls.

HOJICHA: WARM, ROASTED AND COMFORTING

Hojicha steers the tea leaf in a completely different direction. Instead of being steamed and left green, the leaves and stems are roasted over high heat. This turns them a distinctive reddish-brown and imparts a comforting, toasted aroma reminiscent of roasted nuts, caramel, cocoa, or lightly brewed coffee.

That roasted quality is its greatest asset. Hojicha requires little acquired taste; it is soft, round, and devoid of the vegetal sharpness found in green tea, making it an effortless entry point for newcomers.

It is also significantly lower in caffeine. The high-heat roasting process, combined with the mature leaves and stems traditionally used, reduces caffeine levels considerably. While not entirely caffeine-free, it is gentle enough for late afternoons and evenings.

HOW THE MODERN CAFE CHANGED EVERYTHING

The true catalyst behind this trend is versatility. Neither tea is confined to a teapot anymore; both have adapted seamlessly to contemporary cafe menus, appearing in soft serves, tiramisu, puddings, pastries and mocktails.

Matcha provides a pop of natural color and a crisp, clean counterpoint to sugar. Hojicha, on the other hand, delivers savory complexity and depth. Baristas and pastry chefs prize hojicha because its smoky backbone cuts through rich fats, dairy, and syrups without becoming cloying. A hojicha latte, layered with warm milk and a drizzle of maple or vanilla, mimics the indulgence of a roasted praline drink. In dessert cases, hojicha-infused tiramisu, soft-serve ice creams, chiffon cakes, and ganaches shine alongside dark chocolate, salted caramel, roasted black sesame, and browned butter.

WHICH ONE BELONGS IN YOUR CUP?

Choosing between the two comes down to what kind of experience you need in the moment:

Reach for matcha when you want alertness, focus, and a bright, tea-forward punch. It is the ideal companion for crisp

mornings, creative work sessions, and afternoon slumps that demand sustained energy.

Turn to hojicha when you want comfort, grounding, and warmth. It is made for cozy rainy afternoons, post-dinner treats, or relaxing wind-downs where rich, nutty aromas soothe the senses.

Ultimately, this growing fascination is not about crowning a winner. It marks a broader, more adventurous palate among everyday drinkers. We are no longer content with a generic cup of tea or a standard syrup-flavoured latte. We want craftsmanship, regional heritage, distinct roasting styles, and ingredients that work as well in a glass as they do on a plate.

Soy Affair: Staying True to the First Table

Soy Affair's story began in Pune in 2017 with six tables and an MBA graduate choosing hospitality over the predictable corporate route. For founder Prithviraj Bhoite, the idea was simple: create an Asian dining experience that would give people a reason to return. Nine years on, the restaurant seats close to 100 guests, but its approach remains rooted in those early days.

"Scaling a restaurant is easy. Scaling it without losing what made people fall in love with it is the real challenge," says Prithviraj.

The food carries that philosophy forward.

Panko Crusted Roll: layers crisp broccoli and mushrooms with savoury soy-roasted crumbs.
Chicken Tom Kha Dumpling: Brings chicken and shiitake dumplings into a fragrant, coconut-rich Thai broth.
French Toast: Served with Thai ginger ice cream, roasted almonds and maple-honey, makes for a fittingly indulgent finish.

For more details, contact:
Ground Floor, Survey No 114, Soy Affair, Imperio Fab Hotel Building, 1/1/8, Baner Rd, Baner, Pune, Maharashtra 411045
Call: 097666 19265

Sarposh: Experience Kashmir

Is an attempt to tell the story of Kashmir through its food — with the complexity, specificity and self-assurance the cuisine deserves.

Based in Bengaluru, Sarposh brings together the many expressions of Kashmiri food culture: the ceremonial grandeur of Wazwan, the intimacy of home kitchens, seasonal and festive food, breads, preserves, everyday meals and recipes carried through families, communities and generations.

At its core is a simple conviction: a cuisine is best understood from within. Sarposh's work is grounded in Kashmiri knowledge, memory and lived experience — in the cooks, homes, ingredients, techniques and food traditions from which the cuisine actually comes. That grounding matters, particularly for a food culture often encountered outside Kashmir through partial, simplified, or second-hand interpretations.

Ingredients are sourced from Kashmir wherever provenance is integral to a dish; traditional techniques are approached with rigour; and food is presented with the context required to understand not only how something is cooked, but why it exists in the first place.

Over the years, Sarposh has grown beyond simply serving Kashmiri food. Its work increasingly extends to documenting the cuisine, learning from its practitioners, preserving culinary knowledge, creating contemporary spaces for it and representing it to new audiences without translating away its identity.

Bread Basket

Wazwan Traem

From the shared trami of a Wazwan to the simplest meal from a Kashmiri kitchen, Sarposh approaches the cuisine as a living body of knowledge — shaped by landscape and season, but also by memory, movement, community and continuity.

Sarposh is Kashmir, Uncovered — Kashmiri food, understood from within and told on its own terms.

For more details, contact:
Sarposh – Experience Kashmir, #39, First Floor, 80 Feet Road, opposite 12th Main, HAL 3rd Stage, Indiranagar, Bengaluru, Karnataka 560075

HighDive: Pune's Rooftop Bar Steps into the National Spotlight

In a city where technology parks, corporate towers and rapidly evolving skylines define the landscape, HighDive at Radisson Blu Pune Kharadi offers a different perspective—literally. Perched on the eighth floor, this rooftop bar and social terrace transforms the Kharadi skyline into part of the experience, offering expansive views, open skies and an atmosphere that evolves naturally from sunset to late night.

What begins as an unhurried sundowner experience gradually transitions into a vibrant social destination as the evening unfolds. The open-air setting, contemporary design and panoramic city views create an ambience that is equally suited to an after-work gathering, a leisurely dinner, a celebration or a long evening over cocktails. HighDive's USP lies in this versatility—it is not defined by a single occasion, but by the way the space adapts to the mood of the evening.

The ambience is designed around the skyline. As daylight fades, Pune's changing cityscape becomes the backdrop, while carefully considered lighting, contemporary interiors and a sophisticated rooftop setting add warmth and character. The result is a destination that feels distinctly urban yet relaxed, giving guests a front-row seat to the city as it transitions from day to night.

The culinary experience follows the same philosophy. HighDive's menu brings together Indian, Asian and Continental influences, with a strong emphasis on contemporary appetisers, bar bites and sharing plates. Designed for a social setting, the menu encourages guests to explore multiple flavours across the table rather than follow a conventional dining format. From casual grazing to a more substantial dinner, the offering is broad enough to complement different occasions and preferences.

At the heart of the experience is the bar. HighDive's cocktail programme focuses on handcrafted creations, premium spirits and a balance between familiar favourites and contemporary

interpretations. The setting adds another dimension: cocktails enjoyed against an open Pune sky, particularly during sunset, become as much about the atmosphere as they are about the drink itself. The beverage experience is complemented by an extensive selection designed for both casual evenings and more discerning enthusiasts.

The service brings together the warmth and professionalism associated with Radisson Blu while retaining the relaxed character expected of a rooftop social destination. The emphasis is on attentive yet unobtrusive hospitality—being present when required while allowing guests to settle into their own rhythm.

HighDive's growing relevance comes at an important time for Pune's dining and nightlife landscape. The city has steadily emerged from the shadow of India's traditional metropolitan dining hubs, developing a distinctive culture of restaurants, bars and experiential destinations. Against this backdrop, HighDive's selection among the Top 260 restaurants in The Road to Times 50 Best Restaurants of India marks an important milestone and places the destination within a broader national conversation around India's evolving culinary and hospitality scene.

For HighDive, the recognition is not simply about the view. The skyline may be the first reason guests look up, but it is the combination of ambience, food, cocktails, service and the flexibility of the experience that gives them a reason to return. It is a destination where a sunset can become dinner, dinner can become cocktails, and an ordinary evening can effortlessly turn into a memorable night.

For more details, contact:
HighDive
Rooftop Bar & Social Terrace
Radisson Blu Pune Kharadi,
Nagar Bypass Road,
Kharadi, Pune-411014

SHREE MITHAI: A TASTE OF TRADITION, CRAFTED FOR TODAY

For generations, Shree Mithai has brought people together through the warmth of authentic Indian flavours, cherished recipes and the simple joy of sharing something delicious. From much-loved Bengali sweets such as Chhana Malai Roll and Sandesh to indulgent favourites like Kaju Katli and Boondhi Ladoo, every mithai carries the richness of India's sweet-making heritage and the care that goes into every creation.

The savoury selection is equally inviting, with favourites such as Samosa, Dal Kachori and Nylon Dhokla offering familiar flavours, comforting textures and Shree Mithai's signature quality. For those who enjoy the vibrant spirit of Indian street food, Pani Poori, Chola Bhatura and Pav Bhaji bring colour, character and irresistible indulgence to every bite.

Alongside these traditional favourites, Shree Mithai continues to delight contemporary palates with its range of cakes, pastries, chocolates and modern desserts, thoughtfully blending classic Indian indulgence with today's tastes.

At its heart, Shree Mithai is more than a place to eat—it is where celebrations begin, memories are made and loved ones gather. As it journeys along the Road to India's Top 50 Restaurants, Shree Mithai continues to celebrate authentic flavours, exceptional quality and the timeless spirit of Indian hospitality

For more details, contact:
Showrooms at Iyyappanthangal /Chetpet/ Ashok Nagar/Anna Nagar/ Nungambakkam/Adyar/ Thoraipakkam
Customer Care: 044 2828 2828
www.shreemithai.com

Thalassa: Why Thalassa is Your Ultimate Fine Dining Experience in Goa

In Goa, where the ocean paints the sky in molten gold every evening, Thalassa offers far more than a meal — it delivers an escape. Named after Thalassa, the Greek goddess of the sea, this iconic brand brings the Mediterranean to India's west coast, weaving together authentic cuisine, sun-drenched elegance, vibrant entertainment, and boutique indulgence. With four distinctive locations across North Goa, each Thalassa property is a masterclass in coastal sophistication. Expect whitewashed Grecian architecture, azure accents, menus rooted in tradition yet alive with innovation, and an atmosphere that shifts effortlessly from languid morning calm to lively evening energy. Every space is curated to celebrate life's pleasures — good food, good company, and good views.

Thalassa Mariketty's Place, Siolim - The flagship that sparked Goa's Greek romance, Thalassa Mariketty's Place overlooks the Chapora River and the open sea, offering some of the state's most spectacular sunsets. By day, the venue is serene; by evening, it hums with laughter, music, and the clinking of glasses. Signature dishes like Spanakorizo (spinach rice with feta) and Prawn Pastida showcase a delicate balance of flavours, while the lively central bar serves as the heart of the action. Performances from Goa's top entertainers infuse the air with a festive yet refined spirit.

For more details, contact:
Thalassa Goa (Mariketty's Place)
Must-try: Kleftiko, Dolmadakia
Angel Apartments,
301/1, Vaddy, Siolim, Goa 403517
Reservations: +91 98500 335372

MASALA ICE: WHY ARE PEOPLE EATING CHILI-COVERED ICE CUBES?

Mocktail

We routinely drop ice into cold brews, sodas, and mocktails. But eating it directly from a bowl, coated in fiery chili and sharp spice mixes? That is the newest internet food trend capturing curious palates.

The recipe behind masala ice is brazenly simple. Take freshly frozen ice cubes, dust them generously with red chili powder, rock salt, and chaat masala, toss in sliced green chilies, and finish with a squeeze of fresh lemon juice. The objective is to crunch into the cubes immediately before the frost gives way to water.

What makes this bizarre ritual unexpectedly popular is the sheer sensory whiplash. Your palate is hit with numbing chill first, followed instantly by sharp chili heat, tangy citrus, and savory salt. It is less like enjoying an ordinary snack and more like sending your taste buds through an intense thermal rollercoaster.

That jarring contrast explains its rapid viral spread. It costs virtually nothing, demands zero cooking technique, and looks eccentric enough on screen to stop people mid-scroll. In a creator culture that rewards bold culinary curiosities, masala ice proves that even freezer ice can become a theatrical viral hit.

Is the Three-Meal Day Dead? Why Indians are Eating in Smaller, More Frequent Bursts

Breakfast, lunch, and dinner once gave the Indian day a neat rhythm. Today, that routine is loosening. For many, eating now happens in smaller, purposeful bursts: a piece of fruit between calls, a handful of almonds, evening chai with a light savory snack, followed by an easy, understated dinner.

A typical schedule illustrates this shift: breakfast around 8:00 AM, a mid-morning bite of fruit or yogurt at 11:00 AM, and a modest lunch of dal, rice, or a grain bowl by 1:30 PM. Come 4:30 PM, a mini-meal arrives—perhaps roasted makhana, boiled eggs, or sprout chaat—before a light dinner around 7:30 PM.

This habit is less about constant grazing and more about manageable portions. Hectic workdays, long commutes, fitness routines, and fluid hours make smaller eating windows far more practical than heavy, sit-down feasts that induce afternoon slumps.

Portioning meals also invites genuine dietary variety. Instead of cramming all nutrients into a single thali, diners comfortably distribute fruits, greens, dairy, and lean proteins across five or six sittings.

The traditional three-meal model is not dying; it is simply evolving. The modern Indian rhythm is clear: eat light, pause, refuel, and repeat.

Little Italy: A Legacy of Flavours, A Future of Growth

Pizza Mellino On Table

Cheesy Nachos

Spinach & Ricotta Ravioli

Beetroot Ravioli

Burrata Truffle Mushroom

Tres Leches

Since 1989, Little Italy has been bringing the flavours, warmth and spirit of Italy to diners in India. What began over three decades ago has today grown into one of the country's most recognised Italian dining brands, with 35+ outlets across 20+ cities in India and Dubai.

At the heart of Little Italy is a commitment to authentic Italian cuisine. From handcrafted pastas and classic pizzas to risottos, antipasti and indulgent desserts, the menu celebrates the diversity of Italian food while offering an extensive selection of vegetarian choices—a distinction that has become integral to the Little Italy identity.

Burratta Capresia

As the brand enters its next phase of growth, Little Italy is looking to take its legacy to more cities across India, strengthening its presence in existing markets while expanding into new and emerging ones.

This growth journey also opens exciting opportunities for entrepreneurs. Franchise enquiries are welcome from partners looking to build with an established restaurant brand backed by decades of experience, strong brand recognition, and operational expertise.

From its beginnings in 1989 to an expanding footprint today, Little Italy continues to grow—one city, one table and one Italian experience at a time.

For more details, contact:
E-50, 17th Cross St, GOCHS Colony, Besant Nagar, Chennai - 600090
https://littleitaly.in/
Call: 80070 81515/ 9604595000

Since 1989
Little Italy
::ristorante::

Punjab Grill: An Award-Winning Name in India's Dining Landscape

Tandoori Chicken

Paneer Cigar Roll

Punjab Grill has established itself as an award-winning name in India's dining landscape, with a strong legacy of celebrating the rich flavours and culinary traditions of North India. With a growing presence of 60+ outlets, the brand is known for its refined take on regional cuisine, warm hospitality and distinctive dining experience, and has consistently earned recognition from leading industry platforms.

Over the past several years, Punjab Grill has maintained a strong presence at the prestigious Times Food & Nightlife Awards, receiving accolades across editions and cities. This continued recognition reflects the brand's consistency in delivering quality, authenticity and memorable dining experiences. With its commitment to culinary excellence and an evolving approach to contemporary Indian dining, Punjab Grill continues to remain a trusted favourite among discerning diners. Its repeated recognition at the Times Food & Nightlife Awards, coupled with its expanding footprint, further reinforces its position as one of the country's celebrated Indian restaurant brands, with a legacy built on flavour, innovation and consistency.

For more details, contact:
Punjab Grill
Website - https://punjabgrill.in/
Contact - 81306 20076

YouMee: Redefining India's Love for Pan-Asian Dining

Crunchy Vegetable Maki

Chicken Teriyaki Ramen

YouMee has carved a distinctive space in India's Asian dining landscape with its playful take on Pan-Asian cuisine, vibrant ambience and contemporary approach to dining. With a growing presence of 30+ outlets across India, the brand has built a strong following among diners for bringing together bold flavours, creative dishes and an engaging restaurant experience.

Over the years, YouMee has also earned consistent recognition at the prestigious Times Food & Nightlife Awards, receiving accolades across editions. This continued recognition reflects the brand's commitment to delivering memorable dining experiences while constantly evolving with changing tastes and dining trends. From its innovative approach to Asian cuisine to its energetic, youthful personality, YouMee continues to stand out as a preferred destination for Asian food enthusiasts. Its repeated recognition at the Times Food & Nightlife Awards, alongside its expanding footprint, is a testament to the brand's consistency, popularity and growing influence in India's restaurant landscape.

For more details, contact:
YouMee
Website- https://youmee.co.in
Call: 088263 78738

Focaccia: An Italian Culinary Landmark in Chennai

Focaccia at Hyatt Regency Chennai has become synonymous with authentic Italian dining, offering guests a refined culinary journey inspired by the rich traditions of Italy. Celebrated for its award-winning cuisine and warm hospitality, the restaurant seamlessly blends timeless recipes with contemporary finesse.

Its thoughtfully curated menu showcases signature creations such as Carpaccio di Filetto, Tagliatelle ai Frutti di Mare, Tagliata di Manzo alla Costola, and Crostolette d'Agnello, alongside handcrafted pastas, creamy risottos, and classic wood-fired pizzas. Every dish reflects a commitment to authentic flavors, premium ingredients, and meticulous craftsmanship.

Beyond its cuisine, Focaccia offers an inviting ambiance that captures the charm of an Italian trattoria while delivering the sophistication of fine dining. A favorite among Chennai's discerning diners, the restaurant continues to be a benchmark for Italian gastronomy in the city, creating memorable experiences that celebrate the essence of Italy in every bite.

For more details, contact:
Hyatt Regency Chennai
365, Anna Salai, Rostrevor Garden, Teynampet, Chennai, Tamil Nadu 600018
Contact :+919884369333
Menu :hyattrestaurants.com
Reservations: hyattrestaurants.com, tablecheck.com

Visésham: A Luxurious Celebration of South Indian Flavours

Visésham draws on the flavours of Kerala, Karnataka, Andhra, Telangana and Tamil Nadu, cooking each region's food the way that region cooks it. Done with enough craft, Visésham delights the diners familiar with these flavours and the guests discovering them for the first time alike. The ingredients are sourced from within those regions themselves, because authenticity, the restaurant holds, begins at the source. The cooking is led by chefs steeped in these cuisines, and every dish is presented with the precision of a kitchen that treats regional food as genuinely worthy of fine dining.

The room is thoroughly modern and carries the same intent. Live traditional music plays through service, and guests are received with the warmth of a home, in an atmosphere built entirely around that feeling.

A cuisine kept whole, served with enough heart to belong to anyone at the table.

Visésham is the first to bring South Indian cuisine into fine dining in its own right. That conviction is now taking the restaurant beyond a single address, carrying the same standard wherever it opens next.

For more details, contact:
Visésham
135, Chamiers Rd, Nandanam Extension, Nandanam, Chennai, Greater Chennai, Tamil Nadu–600035,
For reservations, Call:091767 57755.

Geetham Brings Vegetarian Cuisine to the Front Row Chennai

Murali N Bhat

With 20 outlets across the city of Chennai, Geetham has become a familiar part of the city's landscape. It brings vegetarian cuisine to the forefront, offering over 600 dishes on its menu and warm hospitality.

At its heart, Geetham places equal emphasis on the freshness of its food and the experience it creates for every customer. Its small-batch, decentralised cooking model ensures food is consistent across branches, and served at its best, from the first morning breakfast to the last late-night meal. The menu is equally thoughtful, designed around the idea that there should be something for everyone, including South Indian, North Indian, Indo-Chinese, and an indulgent selection of desserts and beverages. "Geetham has always been about people and the joy that food brings to them. We want every guest to find something they love, and every visit to leave them with a reason to come back," says Murali, Founder, Geetham. Operating from 6:00 am to 12:00 am across most of its outlets, and till 2:00 am across others.

Geetham is where celebrations, conversations and memories are made over delicious food.

For more details, contact:
Geetham
No: 182/183, Anna Salai, Mount Road, Chennai – 600002
Contact : +91 73972 22111
https://www.geethamveg.com

GEETHAM Veg

Unveiling the Seasonal Alchemy of Upscale Meatless Dining

ROYAL INDIANAA

Royal Indianaa is a sensational celebration of India's rich vegetarian culinary legacy, presented through a regal lens. Curated under the culinary vision of Chef Venkatesh Bhat, the restaurant brings together time-honoured recipes, regional flavours and contemporary hospitality to create an indulgent dining experience.

The menu journeys across India, showcasing thoughtfully crafted vegetarian specialities that balance authenticity with finesse. Authentic dishes such as the Royal Indianaa Rasam and Arachuvitta Sambar reflect the depth and character of traditional South Indian cooking, while the wider spread celebrates the diversity of Indian vegetarian cuisine.

The experience extends far beyond the plate. A majestic teakwood entrance, Tanjore-inspired detailing, intricate décor and dazzling chandeliers create an ambience steeped in South Indian heritage and elegance.

What also makes Royal Indianaa particularly compelling is its celebration of Indian vegetarian cuisine as an experience of indulgence rather than limitation. At its heart is a genuine passion for exploring the extraordinary possibilities of vegetarian cuisine, bringing together tradition and creativity.

The unwavering pursuit of flavour and the joy of discovery is what gives Royal Indianaa its distinctive character, thus placing it firmly in Road to India's Top 50 Restaurants.

For more details, contact:
Royal Indianaa by The Accord Metropolitan
No35, Gopathy Narayana Rd, Lakshmi Colony T Nagar Chennai , Tamil Nadu
For Reservation : +91 8939836187

Come for the Food, Stay for the Reel: Why Restaurants are Going Instagram-First

Somewhere between the sizzle and the swipe, restaurants quietly stopped cooking just for tongues, they also started cooking for thumbs.

From dreamy corners and dramatic interiors to colourful cocktails and dishes that arrive with a little theatre, restaurants are increasingly creating moments made for the camera. Gen Z and younger diners are turning these spaces into Reel-worthy destinations, often discovering their next meal through Instagram itself. Restaurants are playing along, too, refreshing their decor and experiences for Christmas, Valentine's Day, Diwali and New Year's Eve with themed installations, glowing lights and picture-perfect tables. Because sometimes, the plan is not simply to grab dinner. It is to dress up, order something gorgeous, find the perfect backdrop and leave with a plateful of memories and a Reel to prove it.

Made in India: An Elevated Expression of India's Culinary Heritage

Nestled within the award-winning Radisson Blu MBD Hotel, Noida, Made in India celebrates the richness of Indian culinary heritage through an elevated contemporary dining experience. Rooted in the refined traditions of Awadhi and Mughlai cuisine, the restaurant brings together heritage flavours, time-honoured techniques and modern presentation.

From royal-inspired preparations to contemporary interpretations of Indian classics, each dish balances authenticity, craftsmanship and innovation. The opulent setting, attentive service and refined presentation complement the cuisine, creating an elegant experience for intimate dinners, business occasions and celebrations. Made in India is where India's culinary heritage meets modern sophistication, preserving its soul while embracing contemporary dining.

Zarf: A Distinctive Expression of Indian Cuisine

Zarf ambience

At Zarf, Indian cuisine is treated as a conversation worth resuming—one that brings together indigenous ingredients, revived techniques and recipes that have quietly slipped out of use. Located at Sheraton Grand Bengaluru Whitefield Hotel & Convention Center, the restaurant presents a contemporary expression of India's culinary diversity, travelling from the Himalayan northwest to the Kerala coast.

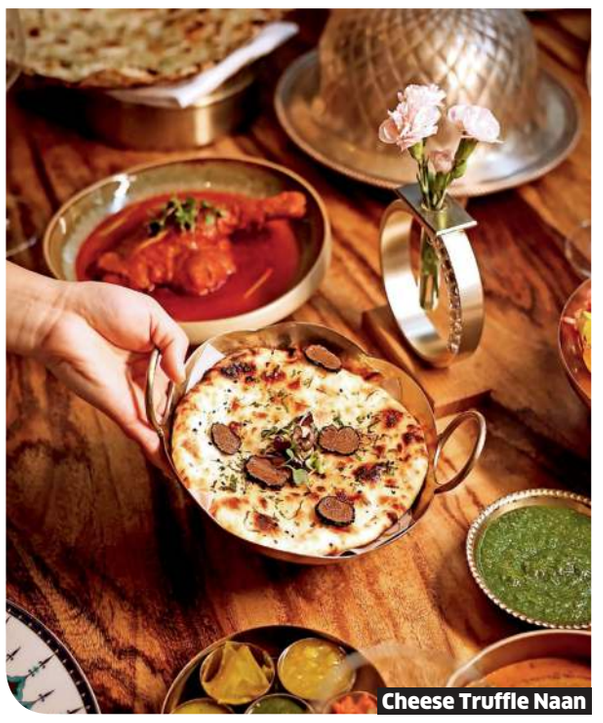
Its menu is rooted in discovery and depth, drawing attention to ingredients and preparations that are often overlooked. Chilgoza pine nuts, Lahori namak and delicately leavened taftan find a place alongside slow-cooked and technique-led dishes such as Peshawari namak mandi lamb chops, Kashmiri duck shabdegh, bharwan gucchi korma and earthen-pot kunna murgh.

The experience extends beyond the kitchen. Zarf's beverage programme takes cues from the same culinary vocabulary, while an exclusive single malt created with Amrut Distilleries using Indian six-row barley adds another layer to the restaurant's identity. Aged for over six years in American oak, the whisky is also thoughtfully paired with dishes designed around its character.

Bold yet restrained, rooted yet inventive, Zarf brings together India's regional food traditions through a lens that respects where they come from while allowing them to find relevance on a contemporary fine-dining table. It is this balance of culinary research, ingredient-led storytelling and a considered dining experience that makes Zarf a compelling part of India's evolving restaurant landscape.

For more details, contact:
Venue: Zarf, Sheraton Grand Bengaluru Whitefield Hotel & Convention Center,
Reservation Number:
807100 8215 / 807100 8217
Price for two: Set menu starts from INR 4500+ taxes

Zarf Murgh Tikka


Cheese Truffle Naan

Nalli Nihari

Eating While Scrolling: Can Your Phone Distract You From feeling Full?

A meal can begin with hunger and end with an empty plate, while your attention has been elsewhere. Between checking messages, replying to emails and watching reels, eating has become another multitasking moment. But when the phone takes centre stage, the signals from your plate may get less attention.

When your brain is busy processing reels, messages and endless updates, you pay less attention to the taste of your food, how quickly you are eating and the gradual shift from hunger to fullness. Your body may be sending signals that you have had enough, but you are less likely to notice them amid the digital noise. There is another catch: when you barely register a meal, you may not remember how much you have eaten, making it easier to reach for another snack later.

Mindful eating isn't a ritual or a ban on phones; it's giving food your attention. Put the screen away, savour each bite and pause midway. Being present can help you recognise when you've had enough, without judgement or rigid food rules.

Make It, Then Eat It: Why DIY Food Experiences are Becoming the New Way to Hang Out With Friends

What if dinner came with a little bit of work before the first bite? From rolling sushi and folding dumplings to assembling pizzas, decorating cupcakes, and making fresh pasta, DIY food experiences are turning regular meals into engaging social activities. Instead of simply booking a table, people are seeking plans where they can cook, experiment, make a mess, and then sit down to enjoy what they have created.

MORE THAN JUST A MEAL

The appeal lies in the experience as much as the food. A dumpling-making session, for instance, can quickly become a friendly competition over who crafts the neatest pleats. A pasta workshop gives friends an easy conversation starter while they knead dough, choose sauces, and taste the finished dish together.

It also works surprisingly well for dates, especially for people who find traditional dinners too formal or stiff. Making something side by side provides a natural rhythm to the conversation and eliminates the awkwardness of staring across a table.

PICK AN ACTIVITY TO MATCH THE MOOD

Casual get-togethers: A pizza- or taco-making session lets everyone customize their own portions at their own pace.

Celebrations & casual outings: Chocolate-making or dessert-decorating workshops make creative options for birthdays or group days out.

Adventurous foodies: Look for masterclasses teaching regional specialties from scratch—from momos and hand-pulled noodles to artisan breads, traditional mithai, or local street-food classics.

THE BEST PART? YOU GET TO EAT YOUR HOMEWORK

Unlike many group activities, DIY food experiences leave you with an immediate, tangible reward. You might not roll the perfect ravioli or pipe the prettiest cupcake, but the slightly wonky creations often make for the best memories. That is ultimately why the trend is catching on: it transforms eating out into something you actively participate in, rather than just show up for.

THE QUIET ART OF BEING CARED FOR AT EBISU

You notice it before you can name it. A glass refilled just as it empties. A server who somehow already knows you like your sake warm, not cold. Nobody is performing for you at EBISU, and that's rather the point. The Japanese have a word for this kind of care: Omotenashi. It isn't a service standard so much as an instinct, one that the founder describes simply: "It lives in the small details. Remembering preferences, anticipating needs." Simple to say, much harder to actually live by, night after night, table after table.

The food carries the same intention. There's tuna sashimi, sliced with the kind of precision that only comes from doing something ten thousand times. Grilled pork belly teriyaki, lacquered dark and smoky at the edges. Age gyoza, crisp enough to make you stop mid-sentence. The moriawase platter is practically a study of the sea laid out on ice, and the ramen bowls, spicy salmon on one end, a coaxing chicken teriyaki on the other, taste less like a dish and more like being looked after.

None of it is accidental. Even the rice is treated as sacred and sourced the way Japan itself would insist on. As the founder puts it, "Authenticity is not about who cooks the food. It's about how deeply it is understood, and how consistently it is executed." That line could serve as the restaurant's entire ethos.

It started in Gurugram and has since made its way to Saket and now Bengaluru, each address slightly different in character yet built on the same idea: that hospitality worth remembering is felt long before it's noticed. Dinner at EBISU rarely feels like just dinner. It feels like someone was quietly and genuinely glad you came.

For more details, contact:
Delhi: Salcon Rasvilas, Saket District Centre, Sector 6, Pushp Vihar, New Delhi, Delhi 110017
Call: +91 9311127741

Gurugram: Palm Spring Plaza, Golf Course Rd, DLF Phase 5, Sector 54, Gurugram, Haryana 122009
Call: +91 8527010762

Bengaluru: Unit No. 203, Second Floor, Forum Rex Walk, No. 171-172, Brigade Road, Bangalore, Karnataka 560001
Call: +91 9560771300

For any queries related to ET Trailblazers- Culinary Tales, contact:info.oms@timesofindia.com

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